The Australian National University

School of Computing

# JHQ-GPU: Representation-Aware GPU ANN Search and Workload-Level Refinement Calibration

Rui Luo

Supervisor: Dr Mengxuan Zhang

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# Abstract

Compact vector representations reduce storage, but efficient GPU approximate nearest-neighbour search also depends on how scores are computed, candidates are selected and refinement effort is allocated. This thesis presents JHQ-GPU, a GPU implementation and evaluation of JHQ's inherited Cartesian primary/residual hierarchy for high-dimensional squared-L2 search.

The system combines GPU training and batched index construction with representation-aware query execution. Cartesian structure decomposes each 256-entry primary distance table into two 16-entry tables without changing the real-arithmetic represented distance. Packed access, lane-cooperative refinement and workload-dependent grouped scanning complement this design. Selection and shared-bound arguments state the ordering and memory conditions needed for correct primary retention. A workload-level policy selects a refinement multiplier through unlabelled output agreement with a larger reference budget; its analysis separates sampled agreement from GT recall.

Archived measurements on an RTX 5090 cover six embedding datasets. The largest tested index searches 17.78 million vectors at 20.44 GiB resident device memory. Two-group tables lead in 22/24 configurations. Integrated scheduling improves geometric-mean throughput by 2.727× at batch 8 against the lane-refinement reference, with much smaller full-batch gains. At recall 0.97, interpolated host-to-host comparisons place JHQ first in three of four historical E1 datasets and near parity with IVF-RaBitQ on arXiv. Those OpenAI runs use TF32 GEMMs; a separate FP32 sensitivity retains 7.9–8.6% leads over archived IVF-RaBitQ at that target. Competitors lead in other recall regions.

Full-pool calibration meets a $10^{-3}$ held-out recall-loss target relative to the best tested budget in all twelve cells, with maximum observed loss 0.0006. Smaller $S = 128$ samples have up to 40/64 threshold crossings. These are fixed-pool observations, not population recall guarantees; complete traces confirm all sampled and full-pool finite-grid decisions. Direct calibrated-reuse measurements support net savings on suitable workloads; distance-only ties retain conditional theoretical coverage. Negative designs further show that arithmetic reuse and lower reconstruction error need not improve the end-to-end frontier. The findings support joint evaluation of representation, execution and effort under explicit quality, timing and capacity conditions.

# Acknowledgements

**TO WRITE:** Acknowledge actual supervision, collaboration, computing resources, and other assistance. This page is optional unless the course specifies it; remove its input from main.tex if unused.

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# Notation and Abbreviations

| Symbol | Meaning |
|---|---|
| $N, d$ | Number of database vectors and original dimension |
| $M, D_s$ | Number of primary subspaces and dimensions per subspace |
| $\Pi$ | Square orthogonal transform; $q' = \Pi q$ |
| $B, B_r$ | Primary bits per subspace and residual bits per coordinate |
| $\rho(p), o_\ell$ | Input ID at physical position $p$, and start of IVF list $\ell$ |
| $k$ | Number of returned neighbours |
| $n_c, c$ | Routed candidates and primary survivors receiving refinement |
| $\alpha$ | Refinement multiplier, with $c = \max\{k, \lceil \alpha k \rceil\}$ |
| $S, \epsilon$ | Calibration sample size and allowed disagreeing result slots |
| $C_\alpha, \mathcal{R}_\alpha$ | Valid primary survivor set and returned ID set at budget $\alpha$ |
| $\alpha_{\text{ref}}, B_{\text{reuse}}$ | Reference refinement budget and number of subsequent reuse batches |
| $g_{\text{LUT}}$ | Number of groups in a factorised lookup table |
| $g_{\text{scan}}$ | Number of scan groups per query |
| $C_{\text{buf}}, T_{\text{blk}}$ | Scan buffer capacity and threads per block |
| $n_{\text{LUT}}(g_{\text{LUT}})$ | Number of LUT entries per primary subspace |
| $\kappa(D, p)$ | Packed complete-key encoding for bound publication |
| $\ell_{\text{ref}}$ | Number of cooperating lanes per refined candidate |
| $D_{\text{raw}}$ | Squared distance between original vectors |
| $D_{\text{P}}$ | Distance under the primary reconstruction |
| $D_{\text{H}}$ | Refined ranking score: reconstructed squared distance plus a query-only constant |

| Abbreviation | Meaning |
|---|---|
| ANN | Approximate nearest neighbour |
| ADC | Asymmetric distance computation (distinct from the ADC conference) |
| IVF | Inverted file |
| JHQ | Johnson–Lindenstrauss enhanced hierarchical quantisation |
| LUT | Lookup table |
| PQ | Product quantisation |
| QPS | Queries per second |
| GT | Ground truth |

**TO WRITE:** Check every definition against the final implementation and remove symbols that are not used. Keep code parameter names distinct from mathematical notation, especially the multiple uses of G and B.

Chapter 1

# Introduction

Searching a large embedding database requires decisions about both information and work: how compactly to represent each vector, which vectors to inspect, and how much precision to spend on them. A GPU makes many operations parallel, but it does not make these decisions free. This thesis studies their interaction in JHQ-GPU, a GPU implementation and experimental analysis of JHQ's primary/residual quantisation hierarchy.

## 1.1 Context and Practical Objectives

High-dimensional embeddings support similarity search over images, documents and other objects. In the tested workloads, a vector has 768–3,072 coordinates and the largest database contains 17.78 million vectors. Exhaustive distance computation exposes substantial arithmetic, while retaining full vectors consumes capacity before any index overhead. For example, the tested Stella FP32 array alone would occupy 67.81 GiB (section 7.7). Approximate nearest-neighbour search exchanges some exact neighbour recovery for reduced access and scoring work.

Modern GPU approaches offer several ways to make that exchange. Graph methods such as CAGRA avoid many vectors through navigation, while compressed IVF methods combine selective list access with compact distance computation [17, 29, 32]. They make a systems question unavoidable: where do representation, selection and memory movement place the cost at a required recall? A short code saves storage, but table construction, dependent lookups, candidate retention and repeated launch setup can determine whether it also saves query time.

JHQ provides a useful setting for studying this question [15]. Its compact primary representation screens candidates, and a residual representation refines a shortlist. This architecture exposes two related decisions: how to execute the broad screen efficiently, and how many of its survivors to refine. It also permits a useful experimental separation: execution can change while keeping the represented score fixed, and budget can change while reusing a trained index.

The practical objective is to improve the attainable combination of Recall@10, host-visible query throughput/latency, resident memory and construction cost. The evaluation includes cases where an alternative is faster or a proposed change fails. This makes the contribution an account of competitive operating conditions and their mechanisms, rather than a single speedup detached from quality and resource constraints.

## 1.2 Problem Definition and Scope

For a database $\mathcal{X} \subset \mathbb{R}^d$ and query $q$, the target is the top-$k$ set under raw squared L2. The implemented system routes through IVF, ranks the visited vectors by a primary reconstructed score $D_{\mathrm{P}}$, retains up to $c = \max\{k, \lceil \alpha k \rceil\}$ candidates, and selects results using a residual-refined score $D_{\mathrm{H}}$. Both scores differ from raw-vector distance. The refined value additionally contains a query-only constant, as defined in section 2.3. Exactness of a selection procedure therefore concerns its computed score and tie contract; final ANN quality remains an empirical question against GT.

The representation follows JHQ: a square orthogonal rotation, Cartesian primary codes and residuals relative to primary reconstruction. This thesis studies GPU training/encoding, physical placement, query execution and one workload-level refinement multiplier. The multiplier is selected from unlabelled query outputs against a larger-budget reference, then is intended to be reused under a stable workload. It is not a per-query learned controller or an absolute-recall certificate.

The main cross-system experiments use one RTX 5090, squared-L2 top-10 and batches of 1,000 queries on four datasets. Six datasets support component and budget studies, with separate large-index measurements. Small-batch results concern internal JHQ comparisons. The implemented compressed index resides on one GPU; CPU model preparation and host-query transfers remain part of its actual architecture. Multi-GPU distribution, online updates, host-backed residual paging and billion-scale deployment are outside the tested system.

## 1.3 Three Linked Technical Challenges

Figure 1.1 connects three challenges to the mechanisms and evidence used to address them.

First, the primary codebook has useful mathematical structure that a direct GPU port can overlook. Each eight-bit subspace code indexes 256 distances. Its Cartesian

coordinates permit an exact 16+16 factorisation, but more aggressive splitting adds lookups and arithmetic. The challenge is to exploit separability without assuming that the smallest table gives the fastest scan. Candidate-parallel word access and residual lane cooperation also need different data mappings.

Second, a query's primary winners can be concentrated in any part of its routed pool. Parallel groups cannot safely retain only a fraction of the required global survivors. Exact local retention, a global merge and a shared complete-score bound provide a principled route, but add buffers, staging and synchronisation. A large batch can already supply enough blocks; an imbalanced workload can still benefit from more groups. The challenge couples correctness with a workload-dependent execution decision. Selecting IVF lists remains a separate primitive from retaining database candidates.

Third, a fixed survivor multiplier can repeatedly refine irrelevant vectors, while a small multiplier can remove a true neighbour too early. Agreement with a large-budget reference is available without GT, but agreement does not repair the reference's own errors or guarantee future-query recall. Choosing a sample and budget also consumes time. The challenge is to evaluate selection quality, calibration cost and reuse together. These are questions organised around an iterative project record; observed benefits are not presented as preregistered predictions.

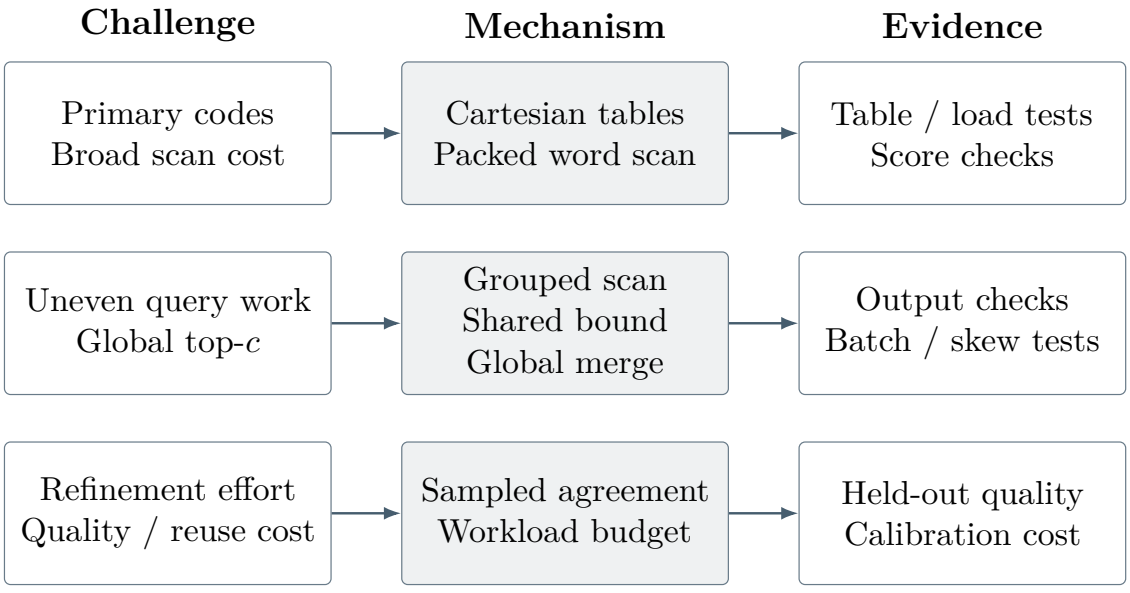



**Figure 1.1:** Problem, mechanism and evidence. The arrows organise research questions; they do not imply that independently measured speedups multiply or that an unlabelled agreement rule guarantees GT recall.

## 1.4 Research Questions and Falsifiable Claims

**RQ1: Construction and capacity.** How can JHQ's hierarchy be trained, encoded and arranged as a searchable GPU-resident index, and what construction cost and tested capacity result? The evidence is the physical layout, train/add records and resident-memory account (section 7.7). An unsuccessful build or an allocation beyond the device budget would limit the capacity claim; a resident sample alone does not establish construction peak.

**RQ2: Correct and efficient execution.** Which representation-aware scoring, retention and scheduling choices improve GPU search while respecting the specified score and tie semantics? Paired LUT, packed-load, refinement and scan experiments connect to reference checks and batch sensitivity (sections 7.3, 7.4 and 7.6). A non-tie selection error would challenge the correctness contract; consistent slowdowns would challenge the proposed execution choice.

**RQ3: Budget quality and total cost.** Can unlabelled workload agreement choose a useful survivor budget, and under what sampling and reuse conditions is calibration worthwhile? Disjoint query evaluation compares fixed budgets, sampled/FULL rules, enumeration and a GT-labelled oracle (section 7.5). Loss crossings challenge reliability; no positive saving after calibration challenges the net-cost benefit. The oracle is an evaluation control, not deployable label-free logic.

**RQ4: Competitive operating regions.** At which measured recall targets does the complete system compete with modern GPU ANN alternatives under a common host-to-host boundary? The answer uses independently tuned E1 frontiers and explicit memory definitions (section 7.2). Int8 graph competitors, high-recall reversals and absent coverage are part of the answer. The question does not seek a universal ranking across hardware, memory budgets or request sizes.

Chapter 3 turns these questions into controlled comparisons. Together they separate what was built, whether its execution is correct, what effort a workload requires, and whether the resulting system has useful operating regions.

## 1.5 Contributions and Research Ownership

Table 1.1 states three linked project contributions and their inherited foundations. The core contribution is the adaptation and evaluation of a particular representation–execution–budget combination. JHQ, Cartesian quantisation, IVF, bitonic/radix selection, merging and CUDA Graph execution retain their prior-art status.

**Table 1.1:** Technical contributions and their evidence boundaries.

| | Inherited foundation | Project contribution | Evidence |
|---|---|---|---|
| C1 | JHQ rotation, codebooks and hierarchy | GPU training/encoding, bounded batch construction and list-ordered packed representation | Search of 17.78M vectors at 20.44 GiB resident; repeated train+add 10.54–10.65 s; sampled construction peak 22.58 GiB |
| C2 | Cartesian additivity and established GPU primitives | Integrated factorised scoring, complete-key grouped retention/bounds, lane refinement and execution scheduling | Two-group LUTs lead in 22/24 cells; scheduled execution 2.727× at batch 8; explicit correctness scope |
| C3 | Candidate expansion and output-agreement ideas | Workload-level budget rule, conditional selection analysis, held-out controls and cost/risk evaluation | FULL meets the relative-loss target in 12/12 cells; smaller samples expose risk; four cells directly measure calibrated reuse |

The results make the claims concrete without making them universal. On the full-batch E1 grid near recall 0.97, JHQ leads in three datasets and is near parity with RaBitQ on arXiv under the interpolated comparison. Other recall regions favour competitors. FULL's maximum observed held-out loss is 0.0006 relative to the best tested arm, while $S = 128$ reaches 40/64 loss crossings in one cell. These are empirical quality results; ten FULL cells retain conditional nestedness coverage, while all twelve FULL finite-grid choices now match enumeration (section 7.5.5). The OpenAI E1 results use TF32 GEMMs; a separate FP32 sensitivity retains smaller favourable margins (section 7.2.3).

This COMP8800 project is presented by Rui Luo under Dr Mengxuan Zhang's supervision. The coauthored ADC manuscript names Rui Luo and Mengxuan Zhang and shares the JHQ-GPU implementation and measurement artifacts [21]. The thesis expands the correctness contracts, newer experiment analysis and treatment of failed designs; historical manuscript numbers retain their own versions.

Technical contribution labels identify the project scope rather than assigning sole ownership of collaborative work. Personal contribution allocation and AI assistance are documented separately in the declaration and contribution record. AI-assisted implementation, analysis and writing require explicit disclosure and author review; a source ledger does not substitute for that responsibility.

## 1.6 Thesis Roadmap

Chapters 2 and 3 establish the representation, alternatives and measurement design. Chapter 4 follows training and physical index construction; Chapter 5 develops GPU scoring and selection contracts. Chapter 6 analyses workload-level refinement calibration. Chapter 7 evaluates construction, execution, budget quality and competitive operating regions. Chapter 8 interprets those findings through negative results, validity limits and testable extensions. Chapter 9 answers the research questions and states the resulting systems principle. Appendix A maps claims to implementation and measurement artifacts.

Chapter 2

# Background and Critical Related Work

An ANN system combines a candidate-access strategy, a representation and a selection procedure. Their costs interact: a compact code can require an expensive scorer, and an accurate scorer cannot recover a vector excluded earlier. This chapter establishes the technical vocabulary for those interactions, identifies what is inherited from JHQ, and compares the alternatives that motivate the GPU execution and budget questions.

## 2.1 ANN Objective and Metrics

Let $\mathcal{X} = \{x_i\}_{i=0}^{N-1} \subset \mathbb{R}^d$ be a database with stable identifiers. For query $q$, the exact task selects the $k$ smallest raw-vector distances

$$D_{\text{raw}}(q, x) = \|q - x\|_2^2. \tag{2.1}$$

Ties require a specified ordering or a set of equally valid answers. This thesis evaluates the stored GT top-10 set, with its fixed tie choices. ANN reduces the cost of accessing and scoring vectors while permitting missed members of that set. The primary quality measure is Recall@10 (equation (3.1)); it is an empirical set-recovery measure. A high measured recall does not establish a worst-case multiplicative distance guarantee.

There are four relevant cost axes. Query throughput counts queries completed per second at a stated batch and timing boundary. Batch latency counts elapsed time for that call; throughput alone supplies no concurrent-service tail guarantee. Construction cost includes the specified training and encoding stages. Storage distinguishes persistent bytes per vector from model, workspace, context and temporary allocation. Chapter 3 defines the actual measurement boundaries. A method may improve one axis while worsening another; equal recall, equal memory and equal construction effort are different comparisons.

Tuning produces a finite set of operating points. Its Pareto frontier keeps points whose recall and throughput are not simultaneously improved by another measured configuration. At a target recall, the fastest qualifying point is an available configuration, while interpolation estimates between neighbouring points. An uncovered region supplies no evidence of either dominance or impossibility. These distinctions are especially relevant when the compared systems use different code precisions and graph/index sizes. The detailed frontier estimators and their endpoint tolerance are fixed in section 3.4.

## 2.2 IVF, PQ, ADC and Refinement

IVF partitions the database around coarse centroids and stores a list of vectors assigned to each centroid. A query chooses $n_{\text{probe}}$ lists, producing a routed universe $U(q)$ of $n_c$ candidates. Visiting fewer lists reduces access work but can exclude a true neighbour before any fine scoring. The centroids are a routing device; their distance ordering is a different selection problem from choosing database vectors.

Product quantisation divides a vector into $M$ coordinate subspaces and represents each with a label into a small learned codebook [16]. If $\widehat{x}_m = \mathcal{C}_m[z_m]$, asymmetric distance computation (ADC) keeps the query unquantised and scores

$$\|q - \widehat{x}\|^2 = \sum_{m=0}^{M-1} \|q_m - \mathcal{C}_m[z_m]\|^2. \tag{2.2}$$

A query-specific table precomputes each subspace distance. Scanning then uses code loads, table lookups and accumulation. The product is between subspaces; the centroids *within* a learned subcodebook need not have a further coordinate product. This distinction determines whether Chapter 5's exact internal table factorisation is valid.

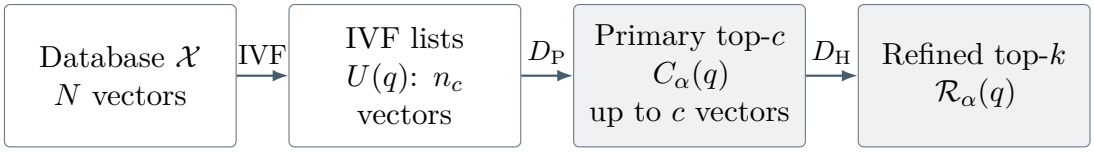
"Residual" has two meanings in this setting. IVF-PQ commonly encodes $x - \mu_{\ell(x)}$, making the coarse centroid part of reconstruction. JHQ instead routes vectors through IVF while defining its residual relative to the primary quantised reconstruction in rotated coordinates. These choices have different codebook dependencies; adding an IVF centroid to JHQ's residual reconstruction would count a term that its encoder did not subtract. The original PQ/ADC framework and GPU implementations also permit candidate expansion followed by a more accurate refinement stage [9, 17].

In the analysed regime with at least $k$ valid routed candidates, JHQ's primary selection retains valid survivors $C_\alpha(q)$, capped by $c(\alpha) = \max\{k, \lceil \alpha k \rceil\}$, and refined

selection returns $\mathcal{R}_\alpha(q)$. The set inclusion is

$$\mathcal{R}_\alpha(q) \subseteq C_\alpha(q) \subseteq U(q) \subseteq \mathcal{X}. \tag{2.3}$$

Intersecting with GT gives stage-wise coverage upper bounds on final recall. These inclusions do not quantify how much loss each stage causes; that requires fixed-universe counterfactual scoring. Refinement can improve ordering among retained vectors, but cannot restore excluded IDs.




Query $q' = \Pi q$ stays FP32.
Primary codes score the broad scan.

Residual $r = \Pi x - \widehat{p}$.
Survivors decode $\widehat{p} + \widehat{r}$.

**Figure 2.1:** Candidate and precision cascade. IVF selects lists; primary scoring selects vectors; only survivors read residuals. The hierarchy is inherited. This diagram defines logical sets and score fidelity, not measured recall losses or GPU kernel boundaries.

Ignoring routing and selection, table-based broad scoring costs $O(n_c M)$ lookups and residual scoring costs $O(cd)$ coordinate work. This asymmetry motivates selective precision, but does not predict latency: memory placement, arithmetic, parallel work and candidate selection also matter. Increasing probes changes $U$; increasing $\alpha$ changes survivors within that universe. Treating these as one generic search-depth parameter hides their different quality and cost effects.

## 2.3 JHQ Representation and Assumptions

### 2.3.1 What is inherited

JHQ combines an orthogonal transformation, an analytical Cartesian primary code and a higher-precision residual layer [15]. Here the transform is square: $\Pi \in \mathbb{R}^{d\times d}$, $\Pi^\top \Pi = I$, $y = \Pi x$ and $q' = \Pi q$. Therefore

$$\|q - x\|^2 = \|\Pi(q - x)\|^2. \tag{2.4}$$

Although the prior work calls this an orthogonal JL transformation, this configuration does not reduce dimension. It preserves real-arithmetic distance exactly; quantisation

subsequently introduces approximation. Actual FP32 orthogonality and GEMM error are separate implementation checks.

Partition $y$ into $M$ subspaces of dimension $D_s = d/M$. With $B$ bits per primary subspace, $K = 2^B$ labels are formed from $L = 2^{B/D_s}$ scalar levels, requiring the implemented Cartesian parameters to make $L$ an integer. Writing $\Phi$ for the standard normal CDF, the constructor uses

$$a_i = \sigma\Phi^{-1}\left(\frac{i-1/2}{L}\right), \quad i = 1, \ldots, L, \qquad \mathcal{C}_m = \{a_1, \ldots, a_L\}^{D_s}. \tag{2.5}$$

At the evaluated $B = D_s = 8$, $L = 2$ and $\mathcal{C}_m = \{-a, +a\}^8$, with $a \simeq 0.67449\sigma$. Each byte records eight coordinate signs. The implementation estimates $\sigma$ from vector energy; unit-normalised inputs motivate the scale $1/\sqrt{d}$. This representation is prior art, not an invention of the GPU execution layer.

If $\widehat{p}$ concatenates primary codewords, the residual is $r = y - \widehat{p}$. Quantising it gives $\widehat{r}$ and hierarchical reconstruction $\widehat{y} = \widehat{p} + \widehat{r}$. The tested residual layer uses eight bits per coordinate; primary and residual payloads consequently occupy $d/8$ and $d$ bytes per vector, before metadata. Selective refinement changes how many residual rows are read, rather than how many are stored. The inherited coarse-to-fine search is implemented as a resident GPU pipeline in Chapters 4 and 5.

### 2.3.2 Model assumptions and score semantics

Random rotation can spread coordinate energy, motivating a shared Gaussian-inspired scalar model. It does not force an arbitrary realised database to have independent, zero-mean Gaussian coordinates. For a fixed rotation and empirical database mean $\mu$, the transformed mean is $\Pi\mu$ and $\|\Pi\mu\| = \|\mu\|$. Averaging over random rotations is different from centring one fixed corpus. Even a uniformly random point on a sphere has dependent coordinates through its fixed norm. Consequently, isometry is an algebraic guarantee; the distributional approximation is a modelling assumption. Chapter 8's centred-coding pilot examines one practical consequence of that distinction.

Terminology also matters for scalar optimality. The implemented primary levels are Gaussian mid-quantiles. For a zero-threshold one-bit quantiser under an exactly Gaussian model, squared-error-optimal reconstruction levels are instead conditional means, $\pm\sigma\sqrt{2/\pi} \simeq \pm 0.79788\sigma$. Thus the inherited quantile construction is not, by itself, a proof of MSE-optimal levels. For fixed signs and a positive common scale,

the choice of $a$ cancels from primary ordering:

$$D_{\mathrm{P}} = \|q'\|^2 + da^2 - 2a\langle q', s\rangle, \qquad s \in \{-1, +1\}^d. \tag{2.6}$$

It still affects residual reconstruction. This thesis relies on the codebook's separability and measured quality, rather than a universal Gaussian or quantiser-optimality claim.

Finally, the three distance notions remain distinct. $D_{\mathrm{raw}}$ uses original vectors; $D_{\mathrm{P}} = \|q' - \widehat{p}\|^2$ uses the primary reconstruction. The implemented refined score satisfies

$$D_{\mathrm{H}} = \|q' - \widehat{p} - \widehat{r}\|^2 + \|q'\|^2. \tag{2.7}$$

Its query-only constant preserves ranking but changes reported distance values. Exact selection under either computed score leaves representation and routing error intact. It is not raw-vector exact reranking.

## 2.4 GPU Execution Concepts

The implementation uses CUDA's SIMT execution: threads are organised into blocks and 32-thread warps, with registers, block-shared memory and device global memory serving different reuse scopes [26]. Coalescing groups neighbouring lane accesses into suitable memory transactions; it does not require fewer logical code bits. Candidate-parallel primary scanning assigns lanes to neighbouring vectors, while refinement assigns several lanes to one survivor's coordinates. These mappings exploit different available parallelism, so one mapping need not suit both stages.

Occupancy is constrained by registers, shared state and block geometry. More resident threads can hide latency, but more blocks per query can also duplicate tables and local candidate buffers. Shared memory is valuable when query data are reused enough to repay loading and synchronisation. These observations motivate Chapter 5's table grouping, packed access and batch-aware scheduling; the throughput ablations assess their combined effects. A claim of bandwidth saturation or a specific cache bottleneck would additionally require counters and a consistent physical-byte model.

Selection is itself substantial computation. Faiss's GPU work combines efficient distance processing with warp-oriented selection [17]. Bitonic networks, radix methods and merge-based approaches provide established building blocks with different $k$, input length and state costs. AIR top-$k$ and GridSelect further illustrate why global

selection design depends on workload and whether scores arrive on the fly [36]. This thesis adapts such ideas to JHQ's probe selection and survivor retention; it does not claim to invent these primitives.

CUDA Graph replay reduces repeated launch setup for a captured workload. Capture, workspace allocation and changes in graph shape belong to the index/search lifecycle, rather than the mathematical scoring rule. Likewise, publishing a shared threshold requires an explicit ordering and memory-access contract. Correct scalar scores do not alone prove concurrent admission safe. Chapter 5 separates these correctness conditions from performance measurements, and Chapter 3 keeps device profiling distinct from the host-visible search interval.

## 2.5 Graph Search on GPUs

Graph ANN replaces list scanning with navigation through promising neighbourhoods. Its benefit is to avoid scoring most database vectors; its GPU difficulty is the dependency between discovering a neighbour and deciding which neighbourhood to expand. SONG separates graph search into stages to expose distance parallelism and controls dynamic memory overhead [37]. This is an alternative access strategy, rather than a different implementation of JHQ's fixed routed candidate universe.

CAGRA designs graph construction and search for GPU parallelism, including small- and large-batch queries [29]. Its graph connectivity and search width expose a different tuning surface from IVF probes. Storing edges and vectors creates a capacity trade-off; quantised-vector CAGRA is also relevant, so fp32 CAGRA alone is an incomplete compressed-index comparison. The thesis measures both in E1. Their different operating regions are reported under the common boundary rather than inferred from cross-paper speedup numbers.

BANG targets a different capacity regime: it keeps compressed vectors on the GPU and accesses the host-resident graph through CPU/GPU cooperation [18]. Capacity is obtained by distributing the working structures, with transfer and coordination becoming part of the design. Its billion-scale results demonstrate an alternative to complete device residency, not capacity evidence for this thesis. The present JHQ implementation retains its compressed search index on one device and has no comparable host-graph execution path.

The comparison therefore turns on access regularity, representation and residency, not a general graph-versus-quantisation hierarchy. Graph navigation can be attractive for a small number of queries; list scans expose regular code access and abundant

batch work. Either can be bottlenecked by selection or movement. Which wins at a target recall is an empirical question for a specified device, memory budget and workload. E1 tests that question at batch 1,000; internal small-batch JHQ gains do not answer it for graph competitors.

## 2.6 Quantised Search and Fast Tables

### 2.6.1 Learning a representation versus exploiting its structure

Optimised product quantisation learns the space decomposition and codebooks to reduce quantisation distortion [12]. Its rotation is optimised for the data, whereas JHQ's random square rotation supports a cheap analytical primary model. The trade-off involves fitting cost, reconstruction fidelity and scorer structure. Improving a general learned codebook does not automatically preserve the internal Cartesian product needed by an exact 16+16 decomposition.

ScaNN's anisotropic quantisation work instead weights error according to its relevance to maximum-inner-product retrieval, showing why reconstruction MSE is not the only useful objective [14]. Its objective and implementation setting differ from the squared-L2 hierarchical pipeline here. The useful comparison is the choice of loss: a rank-sensitive representation should be tested against actual retained-neighbour quality and execution cost. The stopped rank-oriented experiment in Chapter 8 provides an example of this distinction within JHQ.

### 2.6.2 Small lookup tables have substantial prior art

PQ Fast Scan replaces reliance on cache-resident tables with tables suited to CPU SIMD registers [1]. Quicker ADC generalises register lookup techniques and introduces irregular quantisers and split tables [2]. These works establish that table shape and the execution instruction set must be designed together. This thesis's claim is the exact decomposition available from its inherited Cartesian coordinate structure, and its measured implementation on a GPU. CPU SIMD results are conceptual precedents, not throughput measurements on the tested GPU. FP32 table association and cutoff ties still require separate numerical checking.

RaBitQ also uses randomised quantisation and compact sign information, with a distance estimator and theoretical error analysis [10]. Multi-bit extensions trade

storage for estimator accuracy [11]. Their guarantees attach to their specified constructions and estimator assumptions. They cannot be transferred to JHQ merely because both use rotations and binary components. In JHQ, primary signs select survivors and an explicitly stored residual supplies the next precision level; the resulting quality depends on both truncation and reconstruction.

GPU IVF-RaBitQ brings this family into a complete GPU build/search design, including GPU-oriented distance computation and fused search [32]. It is therefore a particularly relevant contemporary baseline, rather than background evidence of a missing GPU quantiser. Its fused execution makes clear that compact codes alone are insufficient: the access and selection pipeline must also be competitive. E1 includes multiple bit budgets, and its high-recall results limit any broad claim of JHQ dominance.

### 2.6.3 Refinement effort and adaptive stopping

Candidate expansion and reranking already appear in Faiss's `k_factor` and cuVS refinement controls [6, 9]. Faiss autotuning can use GT-labelled queries to search recall–time trade-offs [8]. Learned adaptive termination predicts sufficient search effort [19]; DARTH frames early termination around declarative recall targets [5]. These are relevant alternatives to spending a uniform effort everywhere. Chapter 6's particular policy selects one workload-level survivor multiplier using unlabelled agreement with a larger budget. It avoids a trained predictor, while inheriting the reference's quality limits. This distinction is the policy's scope, rather than a claim that adaptive search or refinement budgets are new ideas.

## 2.7 Research Gap and Design Choices

Table 2.1 compares the alternatives by the constraint they address. The literature already provides GPU graph search, compressed distance computation, register-oriented lookup, fast selection and adaptive effort. A useful contribution must therefore specify the representation contract, the integration decision and the evidence for it. "A GPU version" alone does not identify that contribution.

**Table 2.1:** Design alternatives and the thesis's narrower research gap. This is a mechanism comparison; measured rankings follow in Chapter 7.

| Alternative | Useful structure | Principal trade-off | JHQ-GPU question |
|---|---|---|---|
| IVF-PQ / OPQ | Learned subspace codes; ADC | Distortion and training; arbitrary subcodebooks couple coordinates | What does an internally Cartesian primary code permit in GPU scoring? |
| Fast Scan / Quicker ADC | Small tables and SIMD lookup | Table precision, shape and ISA constraints | Does exact splitting repay extra GPU lookups? |
| SONG / CAGRA | Selective graph navigation | Dependent access, graph storage and construction | Where does a resident hierarchical scan compete? |
| BANG | Compressed GPU scoring with host graph | Capacity versus communication | What can complete compressed residency achieve? |
| IVF-RaBitQ | GPU code construction and fused search | Bit budget, estimator and probe effort | Which recall regions justify the residual hierarchy? |
| Adaptive effort | Refine ratios, autotuning, learned or declarative stopping | Labels, reference fidelity, prediction or calibration cost | Can unlabelled workload agreement select useful effort at an acceptable risk and total cost? |

The first gap is an execution contract for this specific hierarchy: coordinate-separable tables and packed access must work with exact primary retention, concurrent threshold publication and residual scoring. The second is a measured choice of execution regime across batch size and candidate skew, since splitting work can add more than it saves. The third is a quality-and-cost account of workload-level refinement selection, separating reference agreement from GT recall and selected-arm speed from net savings.

These gaps motivate preserving the inherited representation while changing execution and effort. More expressive learned codes and graph navigation remain meaningful alternatives, but changing them simultaneously would obscure the component questions. The thesis evaluates this constrained design through mathematical contracts, paired experiments and competitive frontiers. Its unresolved distribution, tie and calibration assumptions remain visible, making the resulting claims narrower and testable.

Chapter 3

# Research Design and Measurement Methodology

The evaluation connects a systems intervention to an observable cost or quality change. It combines paired execution ablations, held-out budget selection and independently tuned system frontiers. These comparisons answer different questions: a faster kernel, a useful calibration policy and a competitive search system require different controls. This chapter defines those controls and the evidence needed to interpret them. Chapters 4–6 describe the mechanisms; Chapter 7 presents their measured outcomes.

## 3.1 Research Questions and Comparisons

Table 3.1 defines the comparison unit and what would challenge each research claim. A *cell* fixes a dataset, index configuration and workload setting; arms are alternative implementations or budgets within that cell. For paired execution measurements, the index state, queries, probe count, refinement budget and scoring representation are held fixed unless the named treatment changes them. The recorded paired ratio is $Q_{\text{treatment}}/Q_{\text{control}}$. Geometric means summarise multiplicative ratios over the stated cells, giving each cell equal weight.

**Table 3.1:** Research questions as testable comparisons. A capacity observation has a different control from a paired execution intervention.

| Question | Intervention / comparison | Held fixed or accounted for | Measure and counter-evidence |
|---|---|---|---|
| RQ1: build and capacity | GPU construction; cached versus cold lifecycle; compressed versus raw storage | $N, d$, representation, routing and timed construction boundary | Train/add time and resident bytes; failed builds or model–allocation gaps delimit feasibility |
| RQ2: execution | LUT grouping, word access, refinement lanes, grouped scan, shared bound and probe selection | Paired state, workload and score; reference output semantics | Wall QPS, stage time and output checks; slowdowns or non-tie mismatches challenge the mechanism |
| RQ3: budget | Sampled / full-pool rule versus fixed 64, 100, 200, enumeration and GT oracle | One index and route; disjoint calibration and held-out query positions | Held-out recall loss, selected-arm QPS and calibration cost; threshold crossings challenge reliability |
| RQ4: operating region | Independently tuned JHQ, CAGRA, IVF-PQ and IVF-RaBitQ | Exported vectors, GT, $k$, device and host-to-host boundary; memory reported separately | Matched-recall QPS and coverage; stronger competitors at other recall targets challenge broad superiority |

The design distinguishes a mechanism's implementation from its explanation. A paired word-access ablation can establish the throughput effect of that access path in the measured pipeline. Attributing the effect to cache misses or occupancy would additionally require hardware-counter evidence. Likewise, a cross-system frontier compares complete choices of representation, algorithm and implementation; it cannot isolate one kernel's contribution. Section 7.6 provides an integrated scheduling comparison so that component ratios need not be multiplied across incompatible baselines.

The research questions organise an iterative development record. They are not a preregistered test plan: the E1 grid was extended after observing incomplete recall coverage, and the interpretation of workload-dependent refinement emerged from budget sweeps. Low-recall losses, high-recall reversals and unsuccessful alternatives remain part of the evaluation. Output agreement with a quantised reference and recall against raw-vector GT are separate quantities by definition. The budget rule uses the former; the held-out evaluation assesses the latter.

## 3.2 Datasets, Queries, Ground Truth and Splits

Table 3.2 records the six exported datasets used by the newer budget, LUT and scale campaigns. The poster's E1 comparison uses the first four. Vogue contains fashion-image embeddings; arXiv contains abstract embeddings; the two OpenAI datasets use Qdrant's DBpedia exports [4, 30, 31, 33]. BGE uses the Italian Wikipedia configuration, and Stella uses the TREC24 BioGen corpus export [34, 35]. Sizes describe the measured exports after preparation, rather than the current upstream cards.

**Table 3.2:** Data and JHQ training manifest. $n_q$ is the actual query count; $n_t = 39n_{\text{list}}$ is the requested coarse-training sample size. E1 uses the first four rows. All rows use squared L2 and $k = 10$.

| Dataset | $N$ | $d$ | $n_q$ | $n_{\text{list}}$ | $n_t$ |
|---|---:|---:|---:|---:|---:|
| Vogue | 932,328 | 768 | 1,000 | 4,096 | 159,744 |
| arXiv | 2,253,000 | 768 | 1,000 | 8,192 | 319,488 |
| OpenAI-1536 | 999,000 | 1,536 | 1,000 | 8,192 | 319,488 |
| OpenAI-3072 | 999,000 | 3,072 | 1,000 | 8,192 | 319,488 |
| BGE-M3 | 10,091,524 | 1,024 | 1,000 | 32,768 | 1,277,952 |
| Stella | 17,776,615 | 1,024 | 999 | 32,768 | 1,277,952 |

The preparation sources specify L2 normalisation and seeded query removal from the database. The streamed OpenAI/BGE/Stella converter first removes non-finite rows, normalises vectors with norm above $10^{-12}$, and uses seed 42 to choose query positions without replacement. Stella queries are sampled from its corpus, rather than its separate 65-query benchmark split. Its shortened export supplies 999 queries. These are vector-neighbour workloads; relevance-labelled retrieval is outside the measurement. The two OpenAI exports use the same positional sampling rule. Supplementary vector checks support row alignment for all queries and a 10,299-row base sample; original source-ID joins remain absent (sections 7.2 and 7.2.3).

All methods in a cell read the same query and GT files. Ground truth is computed by exhaustive squared-L2 search over exported FP32 vectors; the streamed converter maintains top-$k$ across database tiles. Evaluation uses stored GT order, including its floating-point tie choices. With $\mathcal{T}_k(q)$ the first $k$ GT IDs and $\mathcal{R}_k(q)$ the returned ID set,

$$\text{Recall}\,@k = \frac{1}{|\mathcal{Q}|k} \sum_{q \in \mathcal{Q}} |\mathcal{R}_k(q) \cap \mathcal{T}_k(q)|. \tag{3.1}$$

GT rows are 100 wide for Vogue/arXiv and 20 wide for the other four; only ten entries are scored. Duplicate returned IDs do not earn repeated credit. Range, duplicate and repeat-call checks are recorded separately.

JHQ uses $M = d/8$, $B = B_r = 8$, eight coarse iterations and a requested 100,000-vector residual-training sample. Search sweeps reuse the `arms6_cache` trained states and re-encode the database; cold builds start without that state. The code requests training from database samples, separately from calibration queries. For budget evaluation, even query positions form a 500-query calibration pool and odd positions form a 500-query held-out pool, or 499 for Stella. Seeded subsamples of sizes 32, 64 and 128 are drawn 64 times per cell; FULL uses all 500 calibration queries. GT labels enter the offline oracle and held-out assessment, while the deployable agreement rule uses search outputs (sections A.3 and 6.2).

Preparation code and shape logs establish this protocol; complete historical vector-file and trained-state hashes are unavailable. The ledger preserves that distinction between an inspected preparation procedure and an immutable identity of every run's data.

## 3.3 Timing, Variance and Memory Accounting

The principal comparison starts with FP32 queries in host memory and ends when top-10 IDs and scores are available in host memory after stream completion (figure 3.1). It includes pinned staging, H2D, query preprocessing, search and D2H. CAGRA int8 query quantisation is inside this boundary; quantiser training and index construction are outside it. Resource handles and output buffers are reused. JHQ returns to pageable host arrays and the baselines to pinned arrays; CAGRA/PQ use Python APIs, whereas JHQ/RaBitQ use C++. These interface differences remain visible when interpreting small margins.

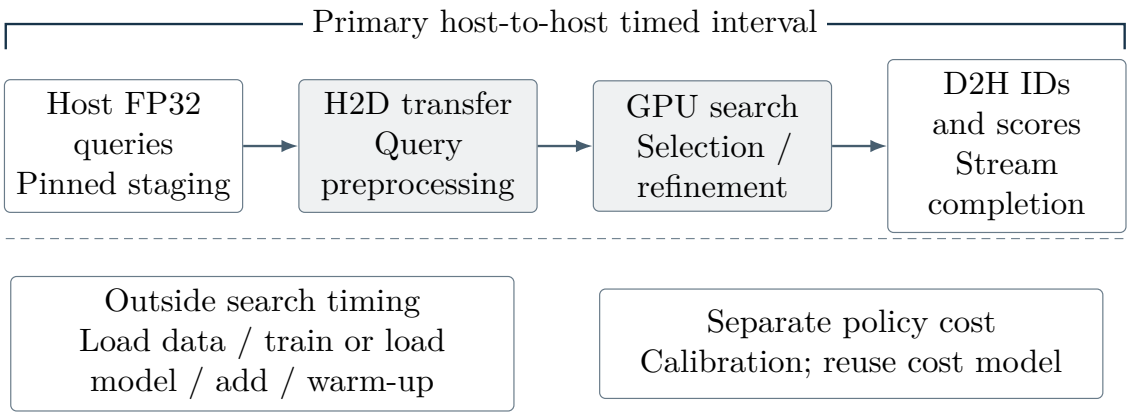



**Figure 3.1:** Timing boundaries. The host interval includes transfers and query-specific computation. Device-stage profiles explain parts of that interval; separate profiling and synchronisation can change execution, so their sum is not an interchangeable end-to-end latency.

For round $r$ with $m_r$ timed calls, each answering a batch of $b$ queries,

$$Q_r = \frac{m_r b}{\sum_{i=1}^{m_r} t_{ri}}, \qquad Q = \operatorname{median}_r Q_r, \tag{3.2}$$

with $t$ in seconds. E1 uses $b = 1{,}000$ and five rounds. JHQ performs one untimed call per variant per round, then normally 24 timed calls. Baselines perform three initial warm-up calls and normally 24 calls per round, reducing that count for points classified as slow. Actual counts are retained. Warm-up excludes JIT and graph capture from steady-state timing. A batch's median or p95 latency describes repeated batch calls, not the latency distribution of individual queries or concurrent requests.

The median of round throughputs is distinct from the reciprocal of median call latency. Both summaries are retained where available, together with round minima/maxima and baseline call traces. Slow valid calls remain in the primary estimate. Rounds share a trained index, and budget draws share a query pool: their counts measure timing variation or sample sensitivity, rather than independent training replications. Small paired differences are reported with their spread and consistency; no independence-based significance claim is attached to the sweep cells.

The principal environment is an RTX 5090 with 32,607 MiB reported memory, driver 595.71.05, CUDA toolkit 13.0 and cuVS 26.08.01. Runs acquire a cooperative GPU lock and record environment snapshots; OpenMP uses 16 threads within a 25-CPU container quota. E1 records a 575 W power limit. These snapshots do not establish locked clocks or constant host load. JHQ's Release compute_80 PTX is JIT-compiled [28]; library baselines use their installed builds. Auxiliary device-only

timing and stage profiles are labelled separately, since JHQ's main API accepts host queries.

Memory accounting separates persistent encoded arrays, model/IVF metadata, query workspace and runtime/context allocations. A process used-memory sample includes more than the index; a build-time allocation delta excludes memory pools created later. E1's context-subtracted JHQ totals and CAGRA's index deltas retain these different definitions. Component models explain resident totals and expose an unattributed remainder (sections 4.4 and 7.7); they do not supply an equal-memory performance comparison. Supplementary 20 ms device samples separately measure construction peaks. Cold train/add timers likewise exclude input loading and preceding object/host-model setup.

**Supplementary evidence boundary.** The 28 October campaign retains the archived E1/budget records and adds repeated empty-cache builds, extracted PTX and toolkit disassembly, OpenAI vector-row correspondence, complete budget traces and a paired precision intervention. The hardware class and reported driver/toolkit versions match, but timing is a separate session. In particular, v69 uses TF32 OpenAI GEMMs; the v72 sensitivity changes add/query arithmetic on the same trained cache. Cross-session baselines remain labelled as historical. The supplementary ledger and exact timing boundaries are in section A.6.

## 3.4 Baselines and Frontier Construction

The competing families cover graph traversal (CAGRA fp32/int8), product-quantised IVF and GPU IVF-RaBitQ [16, 29, 32]. FP32 GPU brute force provides an exhaustive-search reference. Each family sweeps its own implementation parameters (table 3.3); the recorded index configurations can differ in storage and reconstruction fidelity. Consequently the main frontier measures achievable speed at a quality target within these grids. A separate memory account accompanies it.

**Table 3.3:** Principal E1 tuning dimensions. Exact per-point parameters and coverage extensions remain in the raw records. The grid is finite and differs between methods.

| Family | Recorded search dimensions |
|---|---|
| JHQ | Probes and $\alpha$; initial probes 64/128/256 and 0.5/1/2 times the workload budget; coverage extensions reach probe 1,024 and larger/smaller budgets |
| CAGRA fp32/int8 | Graph degree 32/64; search width 1/2/4/8; intermediate top-$k$ capacity 32–512 |
| IVF-PQ | Eight-bit subcodes; 192/384/768-byte codes at $d = 768$, 384/768/1,536 at higher dimensions; fp16/fp32 lookup settings; probes 16–512 |
| IVF-RaBitQ | 4/8/9 bits per dimension, supported search modes, probes 16–1,024; additional 4,096-list OpenAI indexes |
| GPU brute force | Exhaustive FP32 squared-L2 search, common host boundary |

The frontier retains points not dominated in both recall and QPS: point $a$ dominates $b$ when $R_a \geq R_b$ and $Q_a \geq Q_b$, with at least one strict inequality. This envelope can combine different index configurations. For target recall $r$, the measured estimator is

$$Q_{\text{meas}}(r) = \max\{Q_i : R_i \geq r\}. \tag{3.3}$$

It is undefined when no sampled point qualifies. The interpolated estimator uses adjacent frontier points $(R_a, Q_a)$ and $(R_b, Q_b)$:

$$\log Q_{\text{int}}(r) = (1 - \lambda) \log Q_a + \lambda \log Q_b, \qquad \lambda = \frac{r - R_a}{R_b - R_a}. \tag{3.4}$$

The archived parser first accepts a frontier point within $5 \times 10^{-4}$ of the target as a direct match, including near endpoints; otherwise it interpolates only inside the measured range. It extrapolates no segment. Both estimators are reported where comparisons are close: one selects an observed qualifying configuration, while the other reduces sensitivity to unequal grid spacing. Neither supplies an equal-storage comparison.

The parser retains failures and invalid-output diagnostics outside the valid-point frontier. Repeat-call ID changes alone do not discard a point; set changes and ordering changes are distinguished in the source records. Corrected isolated large-baseline reruns supersede contaminated builds, and Stella runs skipped at batch 1,000 contribute no search points. Section A.2 records those decisions. The thesis reconstructs its frontier from all declared baseline families, including int8 CAGRA and adverse operating regions (figure 7.1). Historical ADC and poster plots retain their own version and measurement boundaries.

## 3.5 Versioned Claim-to-Evidence Ledger

Every main empirical claim is associated with an experiment family, a metric and consumed records. The machine-readable registry is `data/ch3/audit.json`; detailed numeric reconstruction is in the Chapter 4–7 audit files. Table 3.4 specifies how identities and missing fields are interpreted. A file hash verifies the input consumed by analysis; it cannot recover an executable or trained state that was never archived.

**Table 3.4:** Claim-to-evidence record and available provenance. Appendix A maps implementation names, executable names and result-to-figure paths.

| Field group | Recorded identity / condition | Interpretation |
|---|---|---|
| Claim and intervention | RQ, mechanism, control, metric, result location and figure/table | Scope identifies what the comparison tests |
| Execution | Run-head or report version, harness, compiler flags, GPU/driver/toolkit | Current analysis checkout is separate from run source; complete executable hashes are missing |
| Index and queries | Shape, metric, training request, cache path, split/seed, $k$, probes, $\alpha$, batch | Cache names and dimensions are recorded; complete historical data/state fingerprints are missing |
| Measurement | Timing scope, warm-up, round/call counts, reference semantics and diagnostics | Family-specific protocols remain attached to their records |
| Analysis | Raw relative path and SHA-256, parser, generated output, validity status | Supports offline regeneration of reported quantities |

The E1 system frontier, newer table sweep, budget campaign and large-data extensions remain separate from the ADC paper's older measurements. Historical packing and refinement records answer their original paired questions. The poster links these mechanisms visually, but does not replace run metadata or extend a comparison's coverage. Version names therefore describe provenance; mechanism names describe the scientific intervention.

`scripts/build_ch7.py` reads archived measurements and regenerates the empirical plots and principal numeric tables, including figures 7.1, 7.3 and 7.11. The source ledger and family audits retain original paths and hashes; `scripts/audit_ch3.py` checks the common protocol against them. Source inspection and offline reconstruction establish correspondence between archived records and reported quantities. Repeating GPU measurements additionally requires the relevant binaries, datasets and trained states; missing diagnostic coverage is identified with each result. Appendix A

supplies implementation and artifact details and specifies which reproduction inputs are available.

## 3.6 Evidence Strength and Threat Controls

Table 3.5 states the inference attached to each evidence class. In particular, exact primary selection concerns the computed primary score, whereas raw-vector recall also depends on routing and reconstruction.

**Table 3.5:** Evidence classes and the conclusions they support.

| Class | Supported inference and scope |
|---|---|
| Formal proof | Selection or coverage property under explicit score, ordering, nestedness and memory assumptions |
| Reference correctness | Agreement on tested cases and comparison keys; ties and ID-set versus bitwise equality remain distinct |
| Paired benchmark | Throughput effect within a fixed state/workload; microarchitectural attribution needs additional measurements |
| End-to-end measurement | Observed operating region on the measured device, batch and tuning grids |
| Model estimate | Byte decomposition or calibration payback under stated accounting and reuse assumptions |
| Unverified claim | A proposed explanation or pending measurement; supplies a research direction rather than an empirical result |

The principal threats are shared-index dependence, finite query pools, grid-selection effects, interface asymmetry and one-device coverage. Controls address them through paired inputs, held-out labels, both matched-recall estimators, explicit timing boundaries and retained adverse results. E1 tests batch 1,000; small-batch scheduling is an internal comparison. Quantised-reference agreement gives a sample-local statement, with population interpretations requiring additional assumptions (section 6.2). Distance-only primary ties also limit the budget general nestedness result, including ten FULL cells; finite-grid enumeration now agrees in all twelve FULL cases (section 6.3). These conditions delimit the claims that Chapter 7 can support and the broader interpretations left for Chapter 8.

Chapter 4

# System Architecture and GPU Index Construction

This chapter addresses RQ1: how to construct a searchable, GPU-resident JHQ index from high-dimensional vectors. JHQ supplies the transform and primary/residual representation [15]. The systems problem is to train that representation, encode a database larger than its available full-precision device storage, and expose consistent list-ordered arrays to the query path. The discussion follows training, placement, allocation and validation. Detailed query kernels follow in Chapter 5; measured comparisons are in Section 7.7.

## 4.1 End-to-End Build and Search Boundaries

The index has three lifecycle stages: training produces reusable model state, adding encodes and physically arranges database rows, and searching uses the completed arrays. This separation matters experimentally. A trained-state cache avoids learning the model again, but still requires database encoding and list construction. A cold train-plus-add run and a search over a reused state measure different operations.

The host owns the input vectors and supplies training samples. It constructs the square transform and analytical primary codebook. GPU matrix products apply the transform; the device training path fits coarse IVF centroids and scalar residual codebooks. Adding then transfers bounded batches, encodes both levels, determines IVF membership, and writes a common list-ordered representation. Host orchestration and device computation therefore coexist within a GPU-resident search system.

The model state consists of the transform, primary codebook, residual codebooks and IVF centroids. The database state adds list offsets, original row identifiers, primary codes, residual codes and correction factors. Search workspace has a shorter logical lifetime: rotated queries, centroid scores, probe offsets, LUTs and survivor buffers are overwritten on the next batch, although their allocations are retained. A

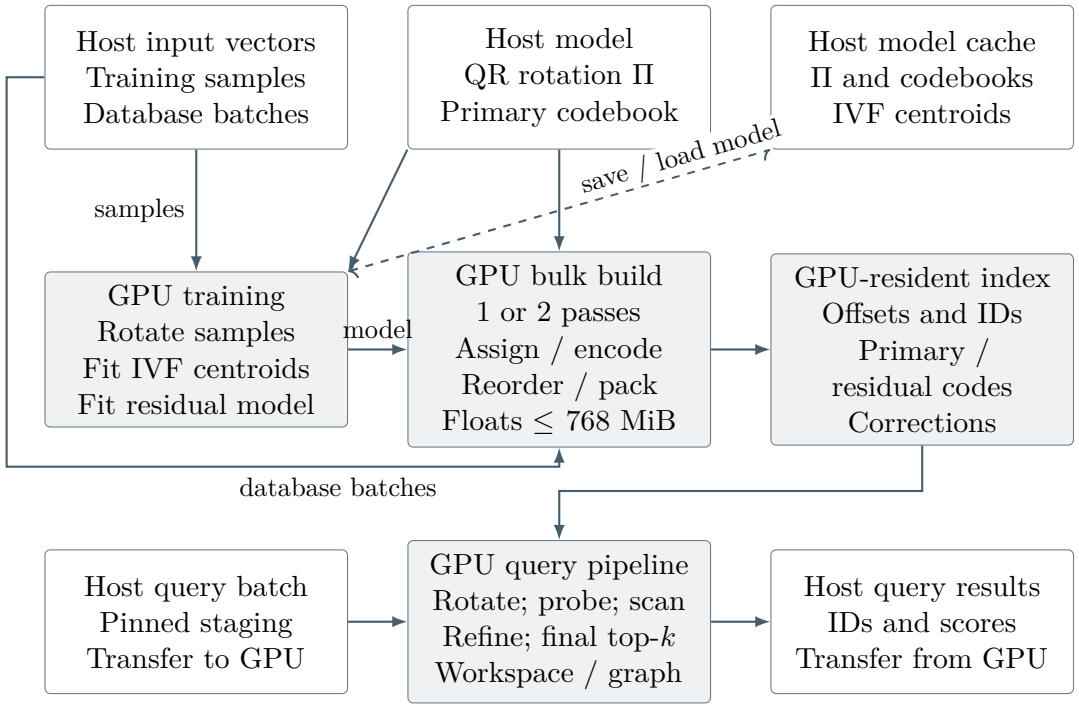



**Figure 4.1:** Implemented build and query boundaries. Host work includes sampling, orthogonal-matrix construction and analytical primary-codebook generation; the evaluated configuration fits IVF and residual models on the GPU. The cache stores trained state, whereas the completed database representation resides on the device. Dashed arrows denote trained-state reuse. The staging label bounds only raw/rotated float buffers at source defaults; other pipeline scratch is additional.

captured CUDA graph belongs to this execution state and references the existing arrays.

The audited API builds a fixed snapshot with one successful `add` call; it rejects a subsequent add. Physical positions remain fixed while searching that snapshot. Changes are handled by building a replacement snapshot. This gives a simple bulk-rebuild lifecycle; mutable insert/delete operations and transactional publication would require additional index management.

Search accepts host queries and returns host IDs and computed ranking scores. The returned $D_H$ equals the reconstructed squared distance plus the query constant $\|q'\|^2$ (equation (5.20)). This preserves within-query ordering. Range thresholds or comparisons across queries must first remove that constant and still account for reconstruction error. It stages input through pinned memory, transfers each batch, executes the device query pipeline and returns its results. The principal throughput measurements use this host-to-host boundary. The exact call/repetition protocol and warm-up treatment are stated in Chapter 7. Original-file loading, training, adding and schedule calibration are outside steady-state search QPS. These boundaries make

the same index usable across query budgets without attributing model construction to every search call.

This design streams construction inputs from host memory while retaining the compressed database on the GPU. It supplies neither a disk-backed search path nor a claim that an arbitrarily large compressed index fits one device.

## 4.2 Training, Rotation and Codebook Generation

### 4.2.1 Transform and sampling

The implementation draws a seeded Gaussian matrix on the host and uses LAPACK QR routines to construct a square orthogonal matrix $\Pi$. For row-major training data $X_t$, device matrix multiplication computes

$$Y_t = X_t \Pi^\mathsf{T}, \qquad y = \Pi x, \qquad \|\Pi(q-x)\|_2^2 = \|q-x\|_2^2 \quad \text{when } \Pi^\mathsf{T}\Pi = I. \tag{4.1}$$

The output retains dimension $d$. This is an orthogonal change of coordinates; QR construction and device products have finite-precision error, whose measurement is part of C0 in section 4.6.

The harness selects database rows at a fixed stride. The primary/IVF sample has 159,744 rows for Vogue, 319,488 for arXiv and both OpenAI datasets, and 1,277,952 for BGE and Stella: exactly $39n_{\text{list}}$ in each case. This matches FAISS's default warning threshold of 39 training points per centroid [7]; it is a sampling rule, not a statistical guarantee for the eight-iteration IVF fit. Residual training uses a separate 100,000-row strided sample, keeping its cost independent of the larger coarse-training sample.

A historical controlled sweep held the primary model and IVF centroids fixed and varied only the residual sample size on Vogue and OpenAI-3072, with $B_r \in \{4, 8\}$ and 32/128/256 probes. Across its 12 configurations, 100K versus all rows changed recall by at most 0.0018: 11 values were lower and one was equal. Larger intermediate samples did not improve recall monotonically, and the residual codes themselves changed substantially. These results motivate the bounded training cost while preserving a measurable quality tradeoff. They used 25 residual Lloyd iterations and do not replace the later six-dataset evaluation. Historical diagnostics and their input hashes are recorded in `data/ch4/review-audit.json`.

### 4.2.2 Why retain the analytical primary model?

The primary constructor estimates a common scale from the sample:

$$\sigma^2 = \frac{1}{n_t d} \sum_{i=0}^{n_t-1} \|x_i\|_2^2, \qquad D_s = d/M, \qquad K = 2^B. \tag{4.2}$$

At $B = D_s = 8$, the Cartesian codebook uses levels $\{-a, +a\}$, $a = 0.674\sigma$. Each byte represents eight signs. This preserves the analytical construction in JHQ [15], enabling coordinatewise $O(d)$ encoding and exact factorisation into the small LUTs of section 5.2. Freely refining 256 codewords per subspace with Lloyd updates generally removes that separability.

For a fixed sign reconstruction $\widehat{p} = as$, $s_j \in \{-1, +1\}$,

$$\|q' - as\|^2 = \|q'\|^2 + da^2 - 2a\langle q', s\rangle. \tag{4.3}$$

For $a > 0$, real-arithmetic primary ranking of these fixed sign codes is independent of the scale. This algebraic property does not require Gaussian coordinates. Scale still changes the residuals $r = \Pi x - \widehat{p}$, their fitted codebooks and the refined ranking; $a = 0$ is degenerate, and floating-point ties require the usual care.

The earlier frontier diagnostics illustrate the tradeoff. On Vogue with $M = 96$, $B_r = 4$ and 128 probes, the earlier and analytical-primary builds achieved primary-only recall 0.6618 and 0.6342, but full-system recall 0.9452 and 0.9409. Residual refinement reduced the observed gap. These were historical cross-version comparisons, including residual-training changes, rather than an isolated causal estimate for replacing the primary codebook. The design choice here is a structured representation whose GPU execution is inexpensive; Chapter 7 evaluates its complete quality–cost frontier.

### 4.2.3 Coarse assignment as filter and refine

IVF centroids are seeded from spaced transformed sample rows and updated for eight configured iterations. Assignment orders centroids by $s_\ell = \|\mu_\ell\|^2 - 2\langle y, \mu_\ell\rangle$. The source offers FP32 and accelerated assignment paths; under its usual dimensional constraints, the default uses int8 products to filter choices and FP32 recomputation to resolve ambiguity.

**Lemma 4.1** (Assignment with certified score intervals)**.** *Let $\widetilde{y}, \widetilde{\mu}_\ell$ be dequantised approximations, $e = y - \widetilde{y}$ and $f_\ell = \mu_\ell - \widetilde{\mu}_\ell$. Keeping centroid norms exact, the*

**Table 4.1:** Historical residual-iteration diagnostic (100K sample). Recall@10 improves markedly from 25 to 2,000 updates; subsequent gains are small and nonmonotonic. These are not the final Chapter 7 benchmark points.

| Dataset | Cap 25 | Cap 2,000 | Cap 5,000 | Cap 40,000 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Vogue | 0.9770 | 0.9846 | 0.9843 | 0.9845 |
| BGE | 0.9514 | 0.9585 | 0.9592 | 0.9586 |
| Stella | 0.9852 | 0.9915 | 0.9921 | 0.9916 |

*approximate score* $\widetilde{s}_\ell = \|\mu_\ell\|^2 - 2\langle \widetilde{y}, \widetilde{\mu}_\ell \rangle$ *has real-arithmetic error bounded by*

$$E_\ell = 2\Big(\|y\|\|f_\ell\| + \|e\|\|\widetilde{\mu}_\ell\|\Big). \tag{4.4}$$

*Given valid intervals* $[L_\ell, U_\ell]$ *containing every target score, discarding only* $L_\ell > \min_j U_j$ *and exactly resolving the remaining scores preserves the minimum and its specified tie rule.*

*Proof.* Expand the dot-product error as $\langle y, f_\ell \rangle + \langle e, \widetilde{\mu}_\ell \rangle$ and apply Cauchy–Schwarz. A discarded score exceeds an upper bound on some retained score, so it cannot attain the minimum. Keeping interval equality preserves possible ties. □

The implementation uses conservative norm bounds and FP32 headroom constants in this filter-and-refine pattern. The lemma explains why a valid bound permits exact rejection; a bitwise guarantee against every FP32 accumulation order additionally requires bounds for those arithmetic errors. The archived assignment diagnostic compares against an FP16 path and reports 0/14,838, 6/31,748 and 3/16,359 differing assignments on Vogue, BGE and Stella tail batches. It is finite implementation evidence, not a full FP32 reference certificate. The cold-build logs do not trace the executed assignment precision.

### 4.2.4 Residual fitting and the iteration budget

IVF fitting precedes residual fitting. The latter encodes its sample with the fixed primary model and forms $r = \Pi x - \widehat{p}(x)$, independently of the assigned IVF centroid. Each subspace fits a sorted scalar codebook of $K_r = 2^{B_r}$ entries shared by its $D_s$ coordinates. The GPU estimator sorts residual values and applies one-dimensional Lloyd updates with a 2,000-iteration cap in the evaluated configuration.

Table 4.1 motivates a fixed budget with diminishing quality returns: 2,000 versus 25 updates gains 0.0063–0.0076 recall. The later changes can exceed the two-run

variability reported for BGE and Stella, so the diagnostic does not establish a statistically exact plateau. It also reports persistent changes in sparse tail bins; this is an observation about the implemented floating-point updates, not a failure of the exact Lloyd descent theorem. Cold logs reach the cap, including Stella, so training is described as budgeted iterative fitting. At cap 20,000, the historical Stella all-row and 100K results were 0.9921 and 0.9920, respectively, under that earlier protocol.

### 4.2.5 Construction work and observed imbalance

Dense QR costs $O(d^3)$ once; dense rotation costs $O(n_t d^2)$. Direct coarse assignment costs $O(n_t n_{\text{list}} d)$ per iteration. Analytical primary construction writes $O(MKD_s)$ values; residual extraction touches $O(n_r d)$ coordinates, followed by sorting and scalar updates. These describe work, rather than predict latency. Supplementary normal runs put Vogue training at 298–303 ms; its archived 1.06 s value is not representative of those repeats. Synchronised phase diagnostics place about 83% of BGE/Stella training in IVF k-means (about 2.97 s). They use one add buffer and forced synchronisation, so phase sums remain separate from normal overlapped construction (section 4.5).

The resulting list-size imbalance directly affects scan scheduling: Chapter 5 uses measured candidate-count CV, with Vogue's archived 0.34–0.62 values triggering grouped execution. Eight IVF iterations, spaced seeds and finite sampling describe the build policy; their individual causal contributions to that imbalance were not isolated.

**Arithmetic used in the measured implementation.** The evaluated implementation (v69) stores FP32 matrices but enables cuBLAS TF32 tensor-core math for $d \geq 1{,}536$. In its compiled faithful branch, a null override falls through to the dimension-based default. This affects training/add/query rotation and centroid GEMMs on both OpenAI datasets; an environment override cannot disable that branch. Thus FP32 storage does not imply full FP32 multiplication. The supplementary FP32 variant (v72) corrects this switch. Its sensitivity experiment reuses the same TF32-trained cache and changes add/query arithmetic, rather than retraining the model in FP32 (section 7.2.3).

## 4.3 IVF Assignment, IDs and Physical Memory Layout

### 4.3.1 From database IDs to list-ordered positions

An input row has identifier $i \in \{0, \ldots, N-1\}$. Coarse assignment places its transformed vector in a list according to the computed centroid scores. The mathematical assignment target is

$$a(i) = \arg\min_{0 \le \ell < n_{\text{list}}} \|\Pi x_i - \mu_\ell\|_2^2. \tag{4.5}$$

Its implementation uses the selected numerical assignment path. Encoding the primary and residual representations does not subtract $\mu_{a(i)}$; list membership restricts the future search universe independently of those reconstructions.

The builder sorts assignments together with a sequence of input IDs. Let $\rho(p)$ be the input ID at sorted physical position $p$ and let $o_\ell$ be the start of list $\ell$. The completed arrays satisfy

$$0 = o_0 \le o_1 \le \cdots \le o_{n_{\text{list}}} = N, \qquad p \in [o_\ell, o_{\ell+1}) \Longrightarrow a(\rho(p)) = \ell. \tag{4.6}$$

Offsets are obtained by lower-bound searches over the sorted assignments. Equal consecutive offsets represent an empty list. Sorting by assignment does not promise stable ordering of equal-list rows across independent builds. A position is stable within the completed snapshot; its meaning is the row $\rho(p)$ shared by every associated array.

The resident ID array implements $p \mapsto \rho(p)$. Its inverse $\rho^{-1}(i)$ is a mathematical bijection, but a second permanent inverse array is unnecessary for search. The two-pass builder constructs that inverse temporarily so input batches can scatter into their final positions. Query results translate physical positions back to input IDs; Chapter 5 uses positions for primary ties and database IDs for final ties.

### 4.3.2 Exact addresses and representation widths

Let $Z[m, p]$ denote the primary byte for subspace $m$ at physical position $p$. The intermediate subspace-major copy has byte offset $mN + p$. Final packing produces

$$\mathsf{w}[j, p] = \sum_{t=0}^{3} 2^{8t} Z[4j + t, p], \qquad \text{addr}_{\text{byte}}(\mathsf{w}[j, p]) = 4(jN + p). \tag{4.7}$$

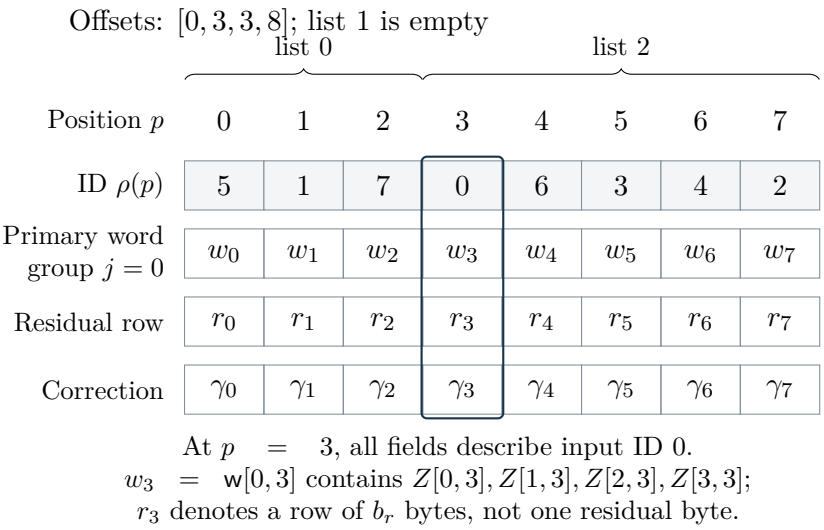



**Figure 4.2:** One common physical position joins IDs, packed primary words, residual rows and correction factors. This illustrative eight-row index has offsets $[0, 3, 3, 8]$, including an empty list. A primary word packs four subspaces of one vector. Values and list sizes are schematic.

Here $j = 0, \ldots, M/4 - 1$. Word layout requires $M \bmod 4 = 0$; the active word-layout build rejects other values. A separate byte-layout compilation retains the byte representation. Each packed array occupies $NM$ bytes, but repacking temporarily holds both old and new copies, costing $2NM$. The one-pass builder temporarily gathers a vector-major $[N, M]$ primary array, transposes it, and then repacks; each obsolete copy is freed. The two-pass builder scatters directly into the subspace-major array before the same final repack. The search-time lane mapping is discussed in Section 5.3.

Residual codes remain row-major, with $b_r = \lceil dB_r/8 \rceil$ bytes per vector. In the eight-bit configuration, coordinate $t$ of row $p$ is at byte offset $pb_r + t$. In the four-bit path it is in byte $pb_r + \lfloor t/2 \rfloor$, with even coordinates in the low nibble and odd coordinates in the high nibble. A four-byte correction per physical row stores

$$\gamma[p] = 2\langle \widehat{p}(x_{\rho(p)}), \widehat{r}(x_{\rho(p)}) \rangle. \tag{4.8}$$

Its value must move with that row's codes during gathering or scattering. Residual access then reconstructs the same object that primary screening identified, even though the two code arrays use different layouts.

This separation favours the workload's two access patterns: primary codes are scanned broadly in list order, while complete residual rows are read for selected positions. Retaining raw FP32 vectors on the device would provide exact reranking

**Table 4.2:** Per-vector bytes. JHQ includes codes, ID and correction; SQ8 is vector codes alone; CAGRA int8 models vector codes plus 32 four-byte neighbours. Offsets, model parameters, workspace and other runtime allocations are excluded. These components are not complete process totals.

| $d$ | Primary | Residual | ID + corr. | JHQ | SQ8 | CAGRA int8 | FP32 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 768 | 96 | 768 | 8 | 872 | 768 | 896 | 3,072 |
| 1,024 | 128 | 1,024 | 8 | 1,160 | 1,024 | 1,152 | 4,096 |
| 1,536 | 192 | 1,536 | 8 | 1,736 | 1,536 | 1,664 | 6,144 |
| 3,072 | 384 | 3,072 | 8 | 3,464 | 3,072 | 3,200 | 12,288 |

but consume $4Nd$ additional bytes and change the reported search design. This index instead refines compressed reconstructions, with the quality consequences evaluated in Chapter 7.

## 4.4 Resident Storage, Workspace and Index Lifecycle

### 4.4.1 Stored bytes and allocated bytes

The eight-bit-residual configuration has an int8-scale resident representation. For one-byte primary subspace codes, its row payload is

$$S_{\text{rows}} = N\left(M + \left\lceil \frac{dB_r}{8} \right\rceil + 8\right), \qquad S_{\text{offsets}} = 4(n_{\text{list}} + 1). \tag{4.9}$$

The extra eight bytes store a four-byte ID and FP32 correction. At $M = d/8$, $B_r = 8$, codes occupy $9d/8$ bytes: 12.5% more than an SQ8 vector's $d$ bytes. A graph-free hierarchy is therefore a design choice, not evidence of a unique compression advantage over int8 alternatives.

The CAGRA comparison uses $d + 4d_g$ bytes at graph degree $d_g = 32$, consistent with the harness's 32-bit neighbour IDs. On Stella, JHQ's row payload is 19.20 GiB, while a successful degree-32 CAGRA int8 record reports 19,656 MiB (19.20 GiB) of index allocation. The near equality is useful context despite their different accounting boundaries. Chapter 7 reports both int8 and fp32 allocations alongside search quality and cost. JHQ's distinctions are graph-free construction and a query-adjustable residual-access budget; lowering $\alpha$ leaves resident residual codes intact.

The basic FP32 model arrays require $4d^2$ bytes for the transform, $4MKD_s$ for the materialised primary codebook, $4MK_r$ for residual codebooks and $4n_{\text{list}}(d + 1)$

**Table 4.3:** Object lifetimes. Sizes describe named arrays, rather than all allocations of a CUDA process. Construction phases are expanded in section 4.5.

| Object | Producer | Location | Lifetime | Bytes / scale |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Input / samples | Loader / harness | Host | Build input; external ownership | $4Nd$ raw; sampled subsets |
| Transform / models | QR / training | Host, GPU | Model and index lifetime | $4d^2 + 4MKD_s + 4MK_r + 4n_{\text{list}}(d+1)$ basic GPU arrays |
| Trained cache | Training | Host file | Across processes; rebuild still needed | Serialised model state |
| Input staging | Add pipeline | Pinned host, GPU | During add | $4n_b a_b d$ host; $8n_b a_b d$ GPU floats, plus scratch |
| IDs / offsets | Sort / lower bound | GPU | Completed snapshot | $4N + 4(n_{\text{list}} + 1)$ |
| Codes / correction | Encode / reorder | GPU | Completed snapshot | $N(M + b_r + 4)$ |
| Order / inverse | Sort / inversion | GPU | Construction only | $4N$ per array; phase dependent |
| Query workspace / graph | Search / capture | GPU, host | Allocations reused; batch contents replaced | Capacity dependent; graph references resident arrays |

for coarse centroids and norms. Derived centroid copies and encoder levels add allocations in the selected path. Query workspace includes two FP32 query matrices $[b_{\text{cap}}, d]$, centroid scores $[b_{\text{cap}}, n_{\text{list}}]$, LUTs, probes and survivor buffers. The optional residual LUT would add $4b_{\text{cap}}dK_r$ bytes; default refinement computes residual scores directly. Group scratch follows equation (5.13) and can retain a larger capacity than the current scan uses: recorded 128-probe samples reserve about 93.8 MiB even on the query-centric path.

### 4.4.2 Reuse, recovery and invalidation

The cache saves the rotation, codebooks and centroids. Its key mixes model parameters and a strided checksum of the training sample, but omits the code version and a checksum of every database byte. Reproducing a build therefore requires model provenance and explicit cache invalidation when implementation or training data change. The search experiments reuse trained states; cold-build records construct separate instances. A close recall result across those instances cannot establish byte-identical models.

A cache hit still executes constructor QR and library warm-up before the training call checks the cache, then loads/uploads the model, encodes rows and builds lists.

Stella's 6.67 s add record is one component of that recovery path, not a measured process-restart time. The add call includes its initial workspace allocation; schedule calibration and search warm-up lie outside that isolated add number.

At fixed $k$, changing $\alpha$ changes the survivor budget without retraining or adding vectors. Search grows insufficient workspace before capture, and recaptures when the actual batch size, survivor count, probe count, refinement lanes, scan groups or shared-bound setting changes. Calibration can bypass capture while trying budgets. Releasing the index destroys its graph and device allocations; buffers are index-owned and reused across the sequential calls evaluated here.

## 4.5 Construction Cost and Tested Scale

### 4.5.1 Bounded input batches and two-pass construction

Rotating all $N$ raw vectors at once requires two FP32 device arrays, together $8Nd$ bytes. The builder instead stages bounded batches through pinned host memory and device raw/rotated buffers. For $n_b$ pipeline buffers and at most $a_b$ rows each, those two device arrays occupy $8n_b a_b d$ bytes. With the source defaults of three buffers and a 128 MiB limit per float array, this component is at most 768 MiB. Assignment products and primary-encoder scratch are additional: the staging bound alone is not a bound on all pipeline memory.

The one-pass path encodes input-order primary/residual arrays, then gathers them into list order. Its temporary and final compressed copies coexist. When the capacity rule predicts insufficient memory, two-pass construction first assigns lists, sorts IDs and builds offsets, then revisits the input to rotate, encode and scatter directly into final positions. This trades another input pass and rotation for fewer simultaneous compressed copies. In the two-pass path, default assignment can compare raw inputs with back-transformed centroids; orthogonality establishes the corresponding real-arithmetic identity.

### 4.5.2 Phase occupancy and the process peak

The source's one-pass branch estimate is

$$H_{\text{single}} = N(2b_r + 3M + 20) + 2^{30} \quad \text{bytes.} \tag{4.10}$$

**Table 4.4:** Analytical row-array occupancy (GiB), $d = 1{,}024$, $M = 128$, $B_r = 8$. BGE uses one pass; Stella uses two. The one-pass Stella column is counterfactual capacity analysis. Pipeline, model, offsets and runtime costs are excluded from these phase values.

| Dataset | Final row payload | One-pass gather | Two-pass repack |
|---|---|---|---|
| BGE | 10.90 | 23.05 | 12.11 |
| Stella | 19.20 | 40.59 | 21.32 |

Its $N$-dependent term is the exact payload of ten arrays simultaneously live during gather/transpose: input-order primary, residual and correction; assignments and sort order; final IDs, residual and correction; and vector-major and subspace-major primary copies. These sum to $3NM + 2Nb_r + 20N$ bytes. The extra 1 GiB is an allowance used by a capacity heuristic, not an exact accounting of all other allocations.

In two-pass construction, the final repack simultaneously holds IDs, residuals, corrections and old/new primary arrays:

$$S_{\text{repack},2} = N(b_r + 2M + 8). \tag{4.11}$$

This is exact for those arrays at that phase. Earlier phases also hold pipeline scratch and, during scatter, a temporary inverse permutation. Consequently the repack expression is not by itself the total peak of the two-pass builder. Model arrays, sort/allocator scratch, runtime context and the later workspace allocation must be included when taking the maximum over the whole lifecycle.

Table 4.4 quantifies the compressed-copy saving. Stella's cold log selects two passes and prints 41.6 GiB for equation (4.10), against 30.6 GiB available at the tail. The separately sampled resident process totals, including context and query workspace, are 11.93 GiB for BGE and 20.44 GiB for Stella. Search working sets depend on batch/probe/candidate capacity as described in section 4.4. Thus static rows, construction phases and searchable resident memory have explicit, different accounting boundaries. The supplementary 20 ms device samples observe a 26.08 GiB BGE peak near the start of add, and a 22.58 GiB Stella peak during repack. These are sampled device totals including context; shorter-lived peaks can be missed.

The early add phase has a previously omitted assignment-product term:

$$S_{\text{dots}} = 4n_b n_{\text{list}} a_b \quad \text{bytes.} \tag{4.12}$$

For three buffers, 32,768 lists and 32,768 rows per buffer, this is three 4 GiB buffers, or 12 GiB in total. This allocation coexists with other pipeline and database arrays near add entry. The 23.05 GiB gather payload describes a later lifetime: adding 12 GiB to it would not give the actual peak. Peak modelling must take the maximum over stage-specific live arrays, including pipeline scratch. Stella's smaller two-pass repack payload, plus model/context, explains its lower observed peak despite its larger database.

### 4.5.3 What the completed measurements establish

Tables 7.14 and 7.15 and figure 7.10 incorporate the supplementary empty-cache builds: three normal runs with warm input pages, one first-read run and one synchronised phase diagnostic per dataset. Normal train+add ranges are 0.558–0.566 s for Vogue and 10.543–10.653 s for Stella. Vogue's archived 1.056 s training time does not reproduce; the three normal repetitions take 298–303 ms. The phase diagnostic forces synchronisation and one pipeline buffer, so its totals are kept outside the normal timing range.

Train+add starts after construction and sample preparation. Timestamped process-start-to-add-completion observations additionally include file opening, host QR and library setup: 18.2–18.6 s for Stella with warm input pages, versus 129.9 s on this session's first read. The boundary ends before schedule calibration and the first search. It is not a universal disk-cold latency. Six fixed operating points over five builds have recall ranges no wider than 0.0012; entire retrained frontiers were not repeated.

Successful isolated Stella CAGRA int8 builds take 74.55 and 82.45 s, including dataset quantisation, at graph degrees 32 and 64. The repeated JHQ construction intervals are shorter under their respective boundaries; complete deployment latency also depends on preparation, calibration and serialization requirements.

The completed large searches contain 10,091,524 BGE and 17,776,615 Stella vectors. Their raw FP32 arrays alone require 38.50 and 67.81 GiB. JHQ and successful CAGRA int8 builds both establish single-device feasibility for the tested Stella workload. The useful deployment comparison combines quality, query cost, rebuild frequency and available memory, as evaluated in section 7.7; the ability to fit is shared by multiple compressed designs.

**Table 4.5:** Archived pilot diagnostics. Correction error covers all indexed rows; returned-score error covers the GPU top-10 comparison for sampled queries. Relative score error is $|s_{\mathrm{GPU}} - s_{64}|/s_{64}$, where the reference includes the query-norm constant.

| Dataset | Indexed rows | Max correction absolute error | Max returned-score relative error |
|---|---|---|---|
| Vogue | 932,328 | $1.28 \times 10^{-7}$ | $2.66 \times 10^{-7}$ |
| arXiv | 2,253,000 | $1.35 \times 10^{-7}$ | $2.38 \times 10^{-7}$ |
| OpenAI-3072 | 999,000 | $2.77 \times 10^{-7}$ | $4.85 \times 10^{-5}$ |

## 4.6 Index Representation and Safety Contracts

Representation contracts protect both numerical geometry and the joins between encoded fields. Their practical importance is illustrated by a historical large-sample failure: a 32-bit $n_t d$ product overflowed at $2^{31}$, produced zero primary scale, and collapsed the primary codebook. A later run initially loaded that model from an older cache because its key omitted the code version. Correct coarse routing alone could not detect the broken primary representation. The corrected implementation chunks the norm computation and accumulates in double. This motivates checking the model, encoded rows and placement separately.

### 4.6.1 Completed representation evidence

The 13 October residual-bound pilot exported trained state and encoded database arrays, including the actual $\Pi$, primary/residual codebooks, IDs, offsets and corrections. The exporter decodes the packed word layout into logical vector-major codes. The pilot reports reusing the arms6 trained cache rather than retraining. Its three complete databases are Vogue (932,328 rows), arXiv (2,253,000) and OpenAI-3072 (999,000).

The codebook audit found zero separability mismatches, scalar-level mismatches and unsorted residual-codebook pairs. Independently decoding the exported primary/residual codes, an FP64 loop checked $\gamma = 2\langle \widehat{p}, \widehat{r} \rangle$ over every indexed row. Table 4.5 reports the worst recorded errors across each dataset's workloads. These are checks of the exported representation, not re-encoding from the original input vectors.

Across seven workloads and 896 query instances, the pilot additionally checked the proposed residual bounds against FP64 reconstructed distances for 72,800,590 routed candidate instances, with zero reported violations. That population also

supports the FP64 composite-score identity check; it is different from comparing GPU-returned scores, which considers only top-10 slots. The historical harness skips returned IDs absent from the routed candidate map, so its maximum error alone is not an exhaustive output-membership certificate.

Offline comparison found identical encoder, primary-training, residual-training and index-construction translation units between the pilot and the evaluated implementation after namespace normalization and removal of the pilot-only export method. This supports applying the pilot's checks to the shared representation path. It does not establish that every later process used byte-identical trained state or verify the large-dataset two-pass path: the audited databases are smaller. The per-workload values, raw-summary checks and source correspondence are reproducible with `scripts/audit_ch4_review.py`.

### 4.6.2 Independent input and placement audit

The supplementary exporter audit uses the shared construction path on Vogue, arXiv, OpenAI-3072 and Stella. Offsets are monotone with endpoints 0 and $N$; IDs form a permutation of every database row in all four. FP64 products of the stored rotation give maximum entrywise $\|\Pi\Pi^{\mathsf{T}} - I\|$ errors of $3.96$–$4.34 \times 10^{-7}$. Sampled norm checks use FP64 rotation, rather than the GPU GEMM, and therefore measure the stored matrix's geometry. Table 4.6 summarises sampled recoding.

**Table 4.6:** Original-input FP64 recoding audit. Flips count coordinate decisions; the final column is the largest residual-boundary distance among mismatches. Structural checks cover all rows; recoding is sampled.

| Dataset | Rows | Orth. error | Primary flips | Residual flips | Max margin |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Vogue | 200,000 | 4.11e-07 | 14 | 5,409 | 1.12e-07 |
| arXiv | 100,000 | 4.11e-07 | 1 | 2,515 | 7.31e-08 |
| OpenAI-3072 | 20,000 | 3.96e-07 | 5,745 | 1,646,806 | 2.67e-05 |
| Stella | 100,000 | 4.34e-07 | 16 | 3,064 | 1.03e-07 |

At 768/1,024 dimensions, mismatches lie within $1.12 \times 10^{-7}$ of decision boundaries. OpenAI-3072 differs materially: residual mismatches affect 2.68% of checked coordinates, up to $2.67 \times 10^{-5}$ from a boundary. This agrees with its TF32 rotation and prevents treating all datasets as FP32-equivalent. Residual comparisons condition on the stored primary digit, avoiding counting a primary flip twice.

For the three smaller databases, forced one-/two-pass builds of the same model have identical primary and residual bytes when joined by ID. Corrections differ by at most $8.94 \times 10^{-8}$; list assignment differs for 1 Vogue, 1 arXiv and 40 OpenAI rows.

**Table 4.7:** Representation contracts after the pilot and supplementary input audit. Coverage separates stored geometry, sampled arithmetic and row placement.

| Boundary | Required property | Evidence / remaining check |
|---|---|---|
| C0: geometry | Common transform with bounded floating-point isometry error | Stored-matrix orthogonality checked on four datasets; TF32 GPU arithmetic distinguished |
| C1: codebooks / correction | Cartesian levels, sorted residual codebooks, correction matches decoded codes | Pilot checks completed on three databases; all-row correction errors in table 4.5 |
| C1: input encoding | Stored codes encode the intended original input row | FP64 original-input recoding on four samples; boundary and TF32 discrepancies quantified |
| C1: placement | Offsets cover rows; IDs form a permutation; all fields follow it | All-row offsets/ID checks; three ID-joined path comparisons; centroid membership unverified |
| Execution | Valid indexing, synchronisation and score-order contracts | Archived query and sanitizer checks; finite coverage, detailed in section 7.4 |

Stella validates the natural two-pass path only. IVF-centroid membership remains unverified because centroids are absent from the export; these structural checks do not prove the assignment decision itself.

### 4.6.3 Contract coverage and remaining checks

The constructor requires $M$ to divide $d$ and $D_s$ to divide $B$; word packing requires $M \bmod 4 = 0$. Query-side LUT verification checks factorisation against actual codeword slices. Positions and IDs are signed 32-bit fields, while large counts and byte-address products require wider arithmetic. The input contract assumes finite vectors and representable counts, and reserves invalid sentinel positions.

The audit consumes the exported rotation and codebooks, rather than a matrix regenerated from its seed. Remaining work is narrower: independently verify membership against exported IVF centroids, test deliberately empty lists and adversarial tails, and obtain a strict CPU reference for actual GPU primary scores. The latter is separate from FP64 recoding and remains in the shared experiment register. Chapter 5 conditions selection on the resulting objects; Chapter 7 evaluates quality and cost.

Chapter 5

# Representation-Aware GPU Search Execution

This chapter addresses RQ2: how JHQ's compressed representation can support correct and efficient GPU execution. The transform, Cartesian primary codebook and residual hierarchy are inherited from JHQ [15]; the focus here is their execution. The argument follows the query path from routing through primary selection to residual scoring. For each mechanism, it separates the mathematical target, implementation conditions and resource trade-offs, with the corresponding measurements in Chapter 7. Workload-level refinement-budget selection is developed separately in Chapter 6.

## 5.1 Query Path and Four Distinct Ranking Objects

For a fixed index, a query is transformed to $q' = \Pi q$, routed to selected inverted lists, screened using primary codes and refined only on the surviving candidates. The final selector returns $k$ database IDs and their computed scores. Figure 5.1 distinguishes the three runtime selection decisions; the ground-truth ordering is an external evaluation object.

Four quantities must be kept separate:

$$\begin{aligned} s_i(q) &= \|\mu_i\|_2^2 - 2\langle q', \mu_i \rangle, && \text{centroid routing score,} \\ D_{\mathrm{P}}(q,x) &= \|q' - \widehat{p}(x)\|_2^2, && \text{primary score,} \\ D_{\mathrm{H}}(q,x) &= \|q' - \widehat{p}(x) - \widehat{r}(x)\|_2^2 + \|q'\|_2^2, && \text{refined ranking score,} \\ D_{\mathrm{raw}}(q,x) &= \|q - x\|_2^2, && \text{raw-space distance.} \end{aligned} \tag{5.1}$$

Here $\mu_i$ is an IVF centroid in transformed coordinates, $\widehat{p}(x)$ is the primary reconstruction and $\widehat{r}(x)$ is the decoded residual. The runtime refined score includes a query-only constant, as derived from the implemented correction in Section 5.6. It

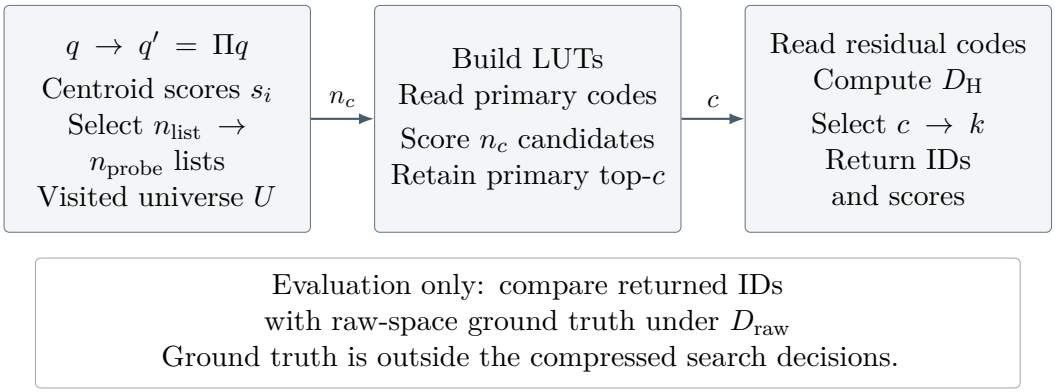



**Figure 5.1:** Query execution and its separate selection boundaries. Routing selects lists, primary screening selects vector candidates, and final selection ranks refined survivors. Raw-space ground truth is used for evaluation; it is not an input to these search decisions.

preserves the ordering of reconstructed distances for a fixed query, but neither it nor the primary score is the original-vector distance.

Routing computes centroid scores and selects $n_{\text{probe}}$ lists (Section 5.7). Concatenating those lists defines the visited universe $U$ of size $n_c$. An exact probe primitive selects the requested centroids under the computed routing scores; it does not certify that $U$ contains every raw-space neighbour. The prefix offsets also expose the actual candidate counts needed for scanning and scheduling.

Primary screening builds query-specific LUTs and reads primary codes for the visited vectors. It retains up to $c = \max\{k, \lceil \alpha k \rceil\}$ candidates under $D_{\text{P}}$. With fixed table grouping, score evaluation costs $O(n_c M)$, in addition to local-selection and merge work. Sections 5.2 and 5.3 address table and code access; Sections 5.4 and 5.5 establish selection invariants and examine the cost of exposing more parallelism.

Residual scoring then reads residual codes only for valid survivors, performs $O(cd)$ coordinate work and supplies $D_{\text{H}}$ to the final selector (Section 5.6). In this path, compressed reconstructions replace search-time raw-vector reads. The implementation's final repeated-minimum selector scans $c$ slots for each of $k$ outputs, with additional block reduction work.

Deterministic ordering keys attach tie rules to these scores: centroid selection uses list ID, complete-key primary selection uses physical row position, and final selection uses database ID. The query-centric legacy primary path has a different cutoff-tie rule, qualified in Sections 5.4 and 5.5. Consequently, score preservation, survivor-set agreement, ordered-output equality and raw-space recall are separate claims. Chapter 7 tests them at their respective boundaries rather than treating a single unchanged recall value as proof of the whole pipeline.

**Table 5.1:** Query-stage contracts. $c_v = \min(c, n_c)$ counts valid primary survivors. Exactness refers to the stated computed scores; routing and quantised reconstruction determine raw-space approximation.

| Stage | Input → output | Data read | Main work | Order / exactness |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Transform | $q \to q'$ | Query; transform | Apply $\Pi$ | Transform (precision in section 7.2.3) |
| Probe | $n_{\text{list}} \to n_{\text{probe}}$ lists | FP32 centroids; list lengths | Score; radix; rank count | $(s_i, i)$; exact probe selection |
| LUT | $q' \to$ tables | Primary codebook | $MD_s 2^{8/g_{\text{LUT}}}$ terms | Real-arithmetic factorisation; FP32 rounding |
| Primary, $g_{\text{scan}} = 0$ | $n_c \to c_v$ | Packed primary codes; LUT | $O(n_c M)$ scoring; compaction | Exact distance-order selection; arbitrary cutoff ties |
| Primary, $g_{\text{scan}} \geq 1$ | $n_c \to c_v$ | Same primary representation | Score; compact; merge | $(D_{\text{P}}, p)$; exact under stated premises |
| Refine | $c_v \to c_v$ scores | Residual codes; correction | $O(c_v d)$ | Computed $D_{\text{H}}$; lane-dependent FP32 association |
| Final | $c_v \to k$ | Refined scores; IDs | $O(kc)$ slot scans | $(D_{\text{H}}, \text{ID})$; exact with $k$ finite valid entries |

**Table 5.2:** Library defaults and measured pipeline settings. Environment variables or setters can override library defaults. The policy parameter $-1$ requests scheduling; it does not force a grouped kernel.

| Control | Unconfigured library | E1 / budget pipeline |
|---|---|---|
| Refinement lanes | 0: scalar byte path | 16: cooperative word path |
| Scan policy | 0: query-centric | $-1$: scheduler chooses 0/2/4/8 |
| Shared bound | Enabled, inactive at $g_{\text{scan}} = 0$ | Enabled, used only when $g_{\text{scan}} > 1$ |
| Schedule statistic | Not calibrated automatically | 512 database pseudoqueries |

Tables 5.1 and 5.2 specify the stage boundaries and measured configuration. In particular, the budget harness explicitly sets 16 lanes, scheduled scans and bound sharing; merely linking the newest library retains the scalar/query-centric defaults. Component ablations override the controls stated in their protocols. Raw run metadata and the mechanism-to-version map in Table A.1 identify those variants.

## 5.2 Exact Cartesian LUT Factorisation

The broad scan evaluates primary reconstructions through asymmetric distance computation: the query remains FP32 while a stored code selects reconstructed coordinates [15, 16]. For transformed query $q'$, the ordinary table for primary

subspace $m$ is

$$T_m[z] = \|q'_m - \mathcal{C}_m[z]\|_2^2, \qquad D_{\mathrm{P}}(q,x) = \sum_{m=0}^{M-1} T_m[z_m(x)]. \tag{5.2}$$

With an eight-bit code, this requires 256 entries per subspace. The opportunity here comes from the codebook's internal Cartesian structure, not just the fact that the vector is partitioned into PQ subspaces.

The analytical builder uses two scalar levels per coordinate when $K = 256$ and $D_s = 8$:

$$\begin{aligned} a = \sigma\Phi^{-1}(3/4) \simeq 0.67449\sigma, \qquad \mathcal{C}_m = \{-a, +a\}^8, \\ D_{\mathrm{P}}(q,x) = \|q'\|_2^2 + da^2 - 2a\sum_{j=0}^{d-1} s_j(x) q'_j. \end{aligned} \tag{5.3}$$

Here $\Phi$ is the standard normal CDF and $s_j(x) \in \{-1, +1\}$. Each byte encodes eight coordinate signs, with higher bits representing earlier coordinates. For $a > 0$, primary ranking is equivalent to an inner-product ranking with that sign vector. The two-level Cartesian product also explains why four- and eight-way coordinate splits remain algebraically exact. This describes the analytical construction; a learned, non-Cartesian replacement requires a new compatibility check.

### 5.2.1 Factorisation without changing the quantiser

For the tested $D_s = 8$ Cartesian codebook, the high nibble $h$ selects the first four reconstructed coordinates and the low nibble $l$ selects the remaining four. Thus $\mathcal{C}_m[16h + l] = (A_m[h], B_m[l])$, with no cross-dependence between the two coordinate groups. Define

$$T_m^{\mathrm{hi}}[h] = \|q'_{m,\mathrm{hi}} - A_m[h]\|_2^2, \qquad T_m^{\mathrm{lo}}[l] = \|q'_{m,\mathrm{lo}} - B_m[l]\|_2^2. \tag{5.4}$$

Squared-L2 additivity over disjoint coordinates gives

$$T_m[z] = T_m^{\mathrm{hi}}[z \gg 4] + T_m^{\mathrm{lo}}[z \,\&\, 15]. \tag{5.5}$$

Only 32 entries are stored, rather than 256. This preserves the reconstruction and the real-arithmetic score; no code retraining, extra quantisation or change in the candidate universe is involved.

The builder reads representative codewords $16h$ and $l$ from the existing full codebook and evaluates only their corresponding coordinate slices. The zero digits

**Table 5.3:** Cartesian table trade-offs for an eight-bit, eight-coordinate primary subspace. Combining additions are the algebraic minimum for joining the looked-up values, excluding accumulation across subspaces; they are not measured instruction counts.

| $g_{\mathrm{LUT}}$ | Entries | FP32 bytes | Lookups | Combining adds | Build terms |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 256 | 1,024 | 1 | 0 | 2,048 |
| 2 | 32 | 128 | 2 | 1 | 128 |
| 4 | 16 | 64 | 4 | 3 | 32 |
| 8 | 16 | 64 | 8 | 7 | 16 |

in the other slice are irrelevant. This is valid only when all codewords sharing a nibble share that slice. The `verify_split_lut` check compares the stored codeword slices against their representatives and rejects incompatible codebooks. An arbitrary learned 256-centroid PQ subcodebook need not satisfy this condition: dividing its code labels into nibbles does not factor its centroid coordinates.

FP32 accumulation order changes between the full and split tables. The archived grouping sweep checks end-to-end recall, whose observed spread is at most $10^{-4}$; it supplies no full-table versus split-table per-candidate score-error or cutoff-tie comparison. Those stronger numerical checks remain pending. All compared tables use FP32.

### 5.2.2 Grouping, construction work and resource cost

The table-grouping ablation generalises the split to $g_{\mathrm{LUT}} \in \{1, 2, 4, 8\}$ contiguous coordinate groups whose bit fields match the Cartesian digits. For eight bits and $D_s = 8$, each group has $2^{8/g_{\mathrm{LUT}}}$ entries; the total entries and FP32 storage per query are

$$n_{\mathrm{LUT}}(g_{\mathrm{LUT}}) = g_{\mathrm{LUT}} 2^{8/g_{\mathrm{LUT}}}, \qquad S_{\mathrm{LUT}}(g_{\mathrm{LUT}}) = 4M n_{\mathrm{LUT}}(g_{\mathrm{LUT}}) \text{ bytes.} \tag{5.6}$$

Independent entry construction evaluates $D_s 2^{8/g_{\mathrm{LUT}}}$ coordinate contributions per subspace. Two groups therefore reduce table storage eightfold and coordinate work sixteenfold relative to independently constructing every full-table entry. These are table-level cost ratios, not predicted application speedups.

The table is built in global workspace and staged cooperatively when its complete shared-memory footprint fits the queried per-block opt-in limit $S_{\max}$. For candidate-buffer capacity $C_{\mathrm{buf}}$, the ordinary exact scan and the grouped scan respectively

require

$$S_0 = 8C_{\text{buf}} + 8 + S_{\text{LUT}}(g_{\text{LUT}}), \qquad S_{\text{grp}} = 8C_{\text{buf}} + 24 + S_{\text{LUT}}(g_{\text{LUT}}) \quad \text{bytes.} \quad (5.7)$$

These formulas concern the evaluated scan without optional fused refinement or early-exit scratch. The code selects shared lookup exactly when the corresponding footprint is at most $S_{\max}$.

In the table sweep, $c = 1{,}000$, block sizes are 512 or 1,024, and $C_{\text{buf}} = 2{,}048$. Full tables span 96–384 KiB, versus 12–48 KiB for two groups. NVIDIA specifies a 99 KiB per-block limit for compute capability 12.0 [25]. With this limit, the full-table footprint exceeds capacity even at $M = 96$ (114,696 bytes in the query-centric path), whereas the largest two-group footprint is 65,560 bytes in the grouped path. Thus the source-level placement rule sends full tables to global memory and two-group tables to shared memory in these configurations. This is a deduction from the launch rule and published limit; a device-attribute printout was not retained in the reviewed records.

Four and eight groups both store 16 entries per subspace but perform more lookups and combinations. Extraction, lookup dependencies, staging, synchronisation and residency jointly determine the measured trade-off. Multiple scan groups may stage the same table independently.

The $16 + 16$ representation is a nibble LUT for an eight-bit sign code. Related small-table execution appears in PQ Fast Scan, Quicker ADC and IVF-RaBitQ [1, 2, 32]. This algebraic connection does not identify JHQ's two-level score with RaBitQ's distance estimator. The contribution here is GPU execution of JHQ's primary/residual structure, including its scan, selection and refinement, with a measured table-grouping choice. Section 7.3 reports that two groups lead in 22/24 cells, with the remaining margins below 1%.

## 5.3 Packed Codes and Candidate-Parallel Memory Access

LUT factorisation reduces the query-specific table; code layout determines how lanes fetch each candidate's table indices. These are separate optimisations. The scan assigns neighbouring lanes to neighbouring candidate occurrences, so its broad phase

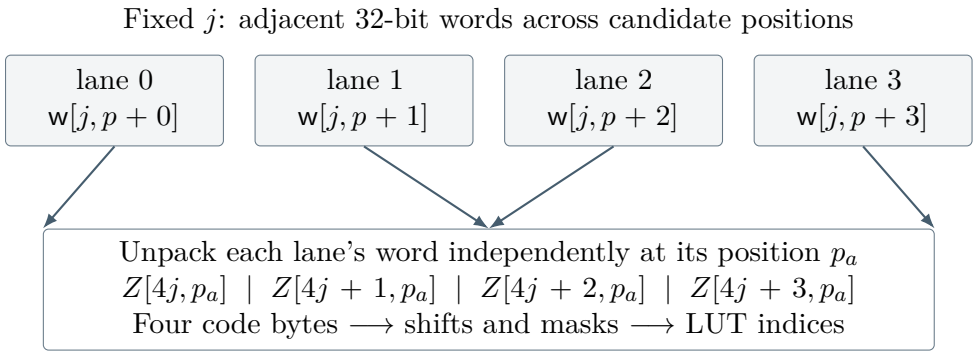



**Figure 5.2:** Packed candidate-parallel access, showing a subset of warp lanes. At fixed word group $j$, consecutive positions access adjacent four-byte words. Each word contains four subspace codes of one candidate. Unpacking preserves each code byte; LUT splitting happens afterwards. The diagram illustrates addresses, not a measured number of memory transactions.

benefits from storing codes by subspace across candidates rather than storing each candidate's full primary code contiguously.

### 5.3.1 Address mapping and four-byte packing

Let $o_\ell$ be the start of inverted list $\ell$, $r$ the row within that list and $p = o_\ell + r$ its physical position. If $Z[m, p]$ denotes the eight-bit code for primary subspace $m$, the byte-oriented scan copy stores it at byte offset $mN + p$. Candidate-major storage would instead use $pM + m$. When lanes visit consecutive positions within a list, the former makes their accesses at fixed $m$ adjacent. At list boundaries, positions can jump, so the mapping does not guarantee one contiguous transaction for every warp.

The packed representation combines four subspace codes of the same candidate into one unsigned word:

$$\mathsf{w}[j, p] = \sum_{t=0}^{3} 2^{8t} Z[4j + t, p], \qquad \mathrm{offset}_{\mathrm{bytes}}(\mathsf{w}[j, p]) = 4(jN + p). \tag{5.8}$$

The four codes are recovered exactly by $(\mathsf{w}[j, p] \gg (8t)) \,\&\, 255$. Each recovered code then supplies the high and low nibble indices in equation (5.5). Packing four subspaces is distinct from Cartesian splitting of one subspace's eight-bit label, and from packing codes for four different candidates.

The build path explicitly repacks the $[M, N]$ byte array into $[M/4, N]$ words. Merely reinterpreting the original byte array as `uint32_t` would combine consecutive candidate bytes rather than the required subspaces. The implementation requires $M$ divisible by four and rejects a partial final word. The repack reads and writes $NM$

code bytes once at construction, with old and new storage briefly coexisting; it is outside the search timing boundary.

### 5.3.2 What packed access saves, and what it preserves

At the source level, a candidate now obtains four codes with one word load instead of four byte loads, followed by shifts and masks in registers. Within a contiguous list segment, 32 lanes request a logical 128-byte word window. Actual transactions depend on alignment, active lanes and the memory hierarchy. A fourfold reduction in source-level load operations does not establish a fourfold reduction in transactions or elapsed time.

The logical payload remains $M$ bytes per candidate: this repacking does not further compress the index. Both byte and word alternatives already organise the scan copy by subspace or subspace group. The historical on/off comparison therefore measures the net effect of the packed layout and its load/unpack path, not the isolated contribution of transposing candidate-major storage. It also cannot uniquely separate instruction count, addressing and cache effects.

Section 7.3 reports 48 matched byte/word configurations with throughput ratios 1.012–1.658×. Each arm has one aggregate rate, so these records provide weaker variability evidence than the newer repeated LUT sweep. The integer representation identity is exact, while the observed recall spread of at most $10^{-4}$ belongs to the complete measured execution. The method claim is preservation of code values with fewer load/address operations, qualified by the experiment's measurement scope.

## 5.4 Exact Global Primary Top-c via Multi-Block Scanning

Primary screening must expose enough GPU work without losing a candidate that should reach residual refinement. A query-centric scan launches one block per query; a small batch therefore offers few blocks even when each query visits many vectors. GPU selection is a substantial design problem in its own right [17]. The grouped-scan component partitions the visited candidates across blocks and combines their survivors. Its contract is exact selection under the computed primary scores. IVF routing and the quantised representation remain approximate.

### 5.4.1 Candidate partition and deterministic ordering

For a fixed query, concatenate the selected inverted lists in probe order to obtain $n_c$ candidate occurrences. Assume that each visited database row occurs once and that the index stays fixed during search. For $g_{\text{scan}} \in \{1, 2, 4, 8\}$, block $(q, j)$ owns the interval

$$U_j = \left[\left\lfloor \frac{jn_c}{g_{\text{scan}}} \right\rfloor, \left\lfloor \frac{(j+1)n_c}{g_{\text{scan}}} \right\rfloor\right), \qquad j = 0, \ldots, g_{\text{scan}} - 1. \tag{5.9}$$

Here an interval denotes the corresponding candidates, rather than their database IDs. The device computes its endpoints from the routed candidate count. Groups differ in size by at most one candidate; a long list can cross a group boundary. This balances candidate counts, whereas assigning equal numbers of lists need not do so. Each thread finds its first list through the probe-prefix offsets and advances its list cursor while scanning its interval. Residual codes are not read at this stage.

The selection key is

$$K_q(x) = \Big(D_{\text{P}}(q, x), p(x)\Big), \qquad (a, p) \prec (b, r) \iff a < b \text{ or } (a = b \text{ and } p < r), \tag{5.10}$$

where $p(x)$ is the physical row position in the fixed inverted-list storage. It is unique among the query's candidates and independent of the order of atomic appends. It is not the database ID used to break final-result ties. With non-NaN scores, this defines a total order on distinct candidates. All local comparisons and merge decisions use that same order. Partition-independent selection additionally requires that each candidate receive the same computed score in every compared path; the ordering rule alone cannot remove floating-point scoring differences.

### 5.4.2 Exact local retention and global coverage

Write $\text{Top}_c(V)$ for the first $\min(c, |V|)$ candidates of $V$ sorted by $K_q$, with $c = \max\{k, \lceil \alpha k \rceil\}$. Each independent group retains its full local top-$c$, not a share $c/g_{\text{scan}}$. This distinction is necessary: with $c = 4$ and two groups, all four global winners may belong to one group. Retaining only two from each group loses winners even though the combined capacity is four.

**Lemma 5.1** (Local-buffer retention)**.** *Let $V_t$ be the candidates scored by a block through chunk $t$, and $B_t$ its valid buffer after any compaction or filtering at that point. Assume fixed complete keys, sufficient append capacity and exact top-$c$ compaction. Let $\beta_t$ be the minimum of the complete shared bounds observed so far, including the*

*initial top sentinel. Then*

$$\mathrm{Top}_c(V_t) \cap \{x : K_q(x) \preceq \beta_t\} \subseteq B_t. \tag{5.11}$$

*With sharing disabled, the bound is the sentinel and the buffer contains the whole prefix top-c.*

*Proof.* The empty prefix satisfies the invariant. A new candidate can fail the local admission threshold only if $c$ previously retained keys precede it; those keys remain predecessors in every later prefix. Rejection by an observed shared bound excludes only keys above $\beta_t$. An old candidate outside a prefix top-$c$ cannot improve its rank when the prefix grows. Thus every eligible new prefix winner is either retained already or admitted. Exact compaction preserves it: fewer than $c$ members of the whole prefix, and hence of the buffer, precede it. Filtering removes only keys above an observed bound. Induction over appends, compactions and filtering proves the claim. The running minimum is essential if reads may return different stale published values. □

**Proposition 5.1** (Coverage and truncated merging)**.** *For fixed keys under a common total order, let $U$ be the visited universe and $V$ any retained subset. If* $\mathrm{Top}_c(U) \subseteq V \subseteq U$*, then* $\mathrm{Top}_c(V) = \mathrm{Top}_c(U)$*. Pairwise sorted merging with truncation to c preserves this result. In particular, for disjoint groups,*

$$\mathrm{Top}_c\left(\bigcup_j U_j\right) = \mathrm{Top}_c\left(\bigcup_j \mathrm{Top}_c(U_j)\right). \tag{5.12}$$

*The statement includes universes smaller than c.*

*Proof.* Every global winner is in $V$, and every other member of $V$ follows the global winners. Selection from $V$ therefore recovers them. For the independent-group special case, let $x$ belong to the global top-$c$ and to group $U_j$. Fewer than $c$ candidates precede $x$ globally, so fewer than $c$ precede it within $U_j$. Consequently $x \in \mathrm{Top}_c(U_j)$, and the local union contains every global winner. Selecting its first $c$ therefore recovers precisely the global winners in the same order. If the whole universe has fewer than $c$ members, every member is retained.

For merging, the first $c$ of two sorted lists are their union's top-$c$. A discarded candidate already has at least $c$ predecessors within that union and cannot enter the top-$c$ of any larger union. Induction over the merge tree establishes the claim. □

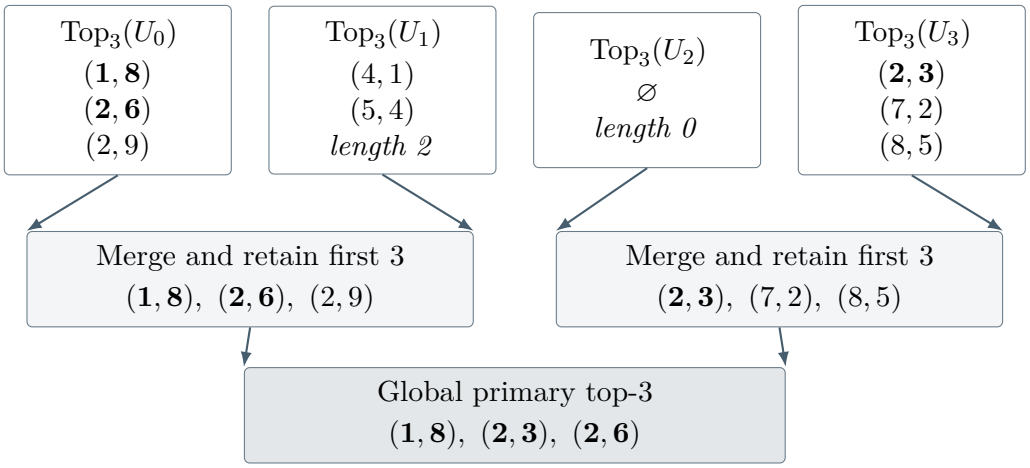



**Figure 5.3:** Local coverage and truncated pairwise merging, illustrated with $c = 3$ and $g_{\text{scan}} = 4$. Entries are $(D_{\text{P}}, p)$ keys, not measured data. Bold entries are the final global winners. A short group contributes its valid prefix; an empty group contributes no entries. Every merge uses the same key order and retains at most $c$ entries.

The CUDA implementation maintains a shared-memory buffer of $C_{\text{buf}}$ key pairs, where $C_{\text{buf}}$ is a power of two and $C_{\text{buf}} \geq c + T_{\text{blk}}$ for a scan block of $T_{\text{blk}}$ threads. A compaction sorts this buffer with a bitonic network, retains at most $c$ valid entries and records the last retained key as the local threshold when $c$ entries exist. Before that point the threshold is a sentinel above every valid key. Between compactions, only candidates preceding the threshold are appended. Its $c$ witness candidates make the threshold a safe upper bound for the best $c$ of the scanned prefix, even as further candidates arrive.

Each chunk contributes at most $T_{\text{blk}}$ appends. After a chunk, the block compacts whenever the next chunk would exceed capacity. Following compaction at most $c$ entries remain, so $C_{\text{buf}} \geq c + T_{\text{blk}}$ provides space for the next chunk; otherwise the explicit capacity check provides it. This invariant prevents overflow without restricting how many competitive candidates one thread may encounter. A per-thread fixed-size retention buffer does not provide the same coverage guarantee. Together with exact bitonic compaction, this capacity argument discharges the implementation premises of Lemma 5.1. With sharing, every observed bound is above the global $c$th key by Proposition 5.2; the lemma therefore retains every global winner belonging to this block, even when its full local top-$c$ is filtered. The general coverage proposition then justifies the merge.

An alternative is to materialise all $n_c$ score/position pairs and then invoke a separate selector. That preserves the target but adds an $O(n_c)$ intermediate array and its writes. Here packed-code scoring feeds a bounded local buffer directly, exchanging

repeated local sorting for $O(g_{\text{scan}}c)$ intermediate output. Register-based selection is another established GPU design [17]; this campaign evaluates the chosen scan variants against the archived reference.

### 5.4.3 Merge implementation, storage and boundary cases

For $g_{\text{scan}} > 1$, one 256-thread block per query performs $\log_2 g_{\text{scan}}$ rounds of pairwise merging. A pair with valid lengths $a, b$ emits $\min(c, a+b)$ keys. Merge Path partitions this output into contiguous thread slices: a binary search finds the input offsets for each slice, then the thread merges its slice sequentially [13]. All comparisons use equation (5.10); block barriers separate rounds. Figure 5.3 illustrates the truncation invariant. The tree emits at most $c(g_{\text{scan}} - 1)$ key pairs across its internal nodes, in addition to the partition searches and synchronisation work.

The two global score/position workspaces have capacities $[b_{\text{cap}}, g_{\text{scan}}, c]$ and $[b_{\text{cap}}, g_{\text{scan}}/2, c]$ and alternate between rounds. With four-byte scores and positions, their combined payload is

$$S_{\text{pairs}} = 8b_{\text{cap}}c\left(g_{\text{scan}} + \frac{g_{\text{scan}}}{2}\right) \quad \text{bytes}, \qquad g_{\text{scan}} > 1. \tag{5.13}$$

Group counts require another $4b_{\text{cap}}g_{\text{scan}}$ bytes; shared bounds add $8b_{\text{cap}}$ when provisioned. These are additional to final survivor arrays and other search workspace. Allocation grows before graph capture and is retained for reuse, so choosing a smaller $g_{\text{scan}}$ later does not necessarily release the reserved memory. The merge keeps only list lengths in shared memory rather than all $g_{\text{scan}}c$ keys.

Counts, rather than sentinel scores alone, delimit local valid prefixes. Compaction pads its sorting buffer with $(+\infty, \text{INT_MAX})$; valid positions must be below that reserved position. Empty groups have count zero. The final survivor array pads unused slots with $(+\infty, -1)$, and refinement skips negative positions. These two sentinels serve different purposes: the negative padding position must not participate as a valid key in a merge. $g_{\text{scan}} = 1$ writes directly to the survivor arrays and omits the merge.

The older query-centric path is selected by the implementation label $g_{\text{scan}} = 0$, meaning one block per query, not zero blocks. Its default primary selection is exact by score, but its distance-only cutoff can retain a different member of a tie from the complete-key path. The lossy `K_LOCAL=4` alternative requires `JHQ_EXACT_TOPCK=0` in a build that permits it; paper-faithful builds force exact selection. It is not the

measured default. For this distance-only path, the buffer argument uses a total preorder: after final compaction it retains all candidates strictly below the prefix's $c$th distance and enough candidates at that distance to fill $\min(c, |V_t|)$ slots. A rejected distance has $c$ retained witnesses with no larger distance; exact distance sorting preserves this rank property at each compaction. Tied identities need not be unique. Section 7.4 reports 64 grouped-scan comparisons with no non-tie primary differences and identical final outputs on the used queries. Those checks compare GPU implementations, rather than independently sorting every visited candidate on the CPU. An existing host checker accepts cutoff-tie substitutions and compares primary sets, so it does not certify the complete-key order. Strict CPU sorting of the same recorded score/position pairs remains a separate validation target; its exporter must first match the measured packed layout and LUT grouping. The proposition establishes a conditional selection property, not raw-space exact kNN or unconditional equivalence to every legacy tie policy.

## 5.5 Shared Complete-Key Thresholds and Execution Scheduling

Full local top-$c$ retention establishes correctness, but can produce $g_{\text{scan}}c$ intermediate survivors for only $c$ global outputs. The shared-bound component reduces this excess selection work. The scheduler then chooses how much scan parallelism to expose. Both operate at a fixed refinement budget; choosing that budget is the separate problem in Chapter 6.

### 5.5.1 A complete-key upper bound with explicit witnesses

Let $K_{(c)}$ be the global $c$th key when $|U| \geq c$. If a group holds $c$ distinct, fully scored candidates, the largest key among those witnesses, $\tau_j$, satisfies $K_{(c)} \preceq \tau_j$. There are already $c$ candidates no later than $\tau_j$ in the global universe. The shared bound is initialised to a top sentinel and updated by

$$\tau \leftarrow \min_{\prec}(\tau, \tau_j). \tag{5.14}$$

No bound is published from fewer than $c$ valid candidates. If the entire universe has fewer than $c$, no group can publish such a bound and all valid candidates remain eligible.

**Proposition 5.2** (Safe rejection by a witnessed bound)**.** *Assume fixed keys, publications backed by c distinct candidates, and reads that return either the initial sentinel or one complete published key. Rejecting a candidate only when $K_q(x) \succ \tau$ cannot remove a global top-c candidate, irrespective of publication timing.*

*Proof.* Every published bound is at least $K_{(c)}$, and the minimum of such bounds is also at least $K_{(c)}$. A global winner satisfies $K_q(x) \preceq K_{(c)} \preceq \tau$, so it is never rejected. An older bound remains an upper bound and merely permits extra work. Publications made after earlier safe rejections remain valid: any $c$ retained distinct candidates still supply $c$ witnesses, whether or not they are the best $c$ of their group. □

This last distinction matters. With sharing enabled, a group need not return its own full local top-$c$: it can discard locally competitive candidates already certified as globally uncompetitive. Correctness requires the union still to contain every global winner. The truncated merge argument of Proposition 5.1 then applies to that union. Candidates equal to the shared bound remain eligible, including the witness that established it. The implemented admission condition is

$$K_q(x) \prec \lambda_j \quad \text{and} \quad K_q(x) \preceq \tau_{\text{seen}}, \tag{5.15}$$

where $\lambda_j$ is the local compaction threshold and $\tau_{\text{seen}}$ is the group's last observed shared bound.

### 5.5.2 Publication, filtering and implementation limits

For nonnegative FP32 scores generated as sums of squares, the code packs the distance bits and nonnegative position into an unsigned 64-bit key:

$$\kappa(D, p) = 2^{32}\,\text{uintbits}_{32}(D) + p. \tag{5.16}$$

Unsigned integer comparison then agrees with the lexicographic order. This relies on positive-zero encoding and excludes NaNs and negative scores; it is not a general signed-float encoding. Positive infinity orders after finite scores, and the all-one initial word orders after valid encodings. Invalid positions are excluded from bound publication. These are score-domain and representation preconditions, not properties inferred from unchanged recall.

One thread per block reads the query's bound for each chunk. After compaction, it publishes the local $c$th key through 64-bit `atomicMin` when enough valid entries

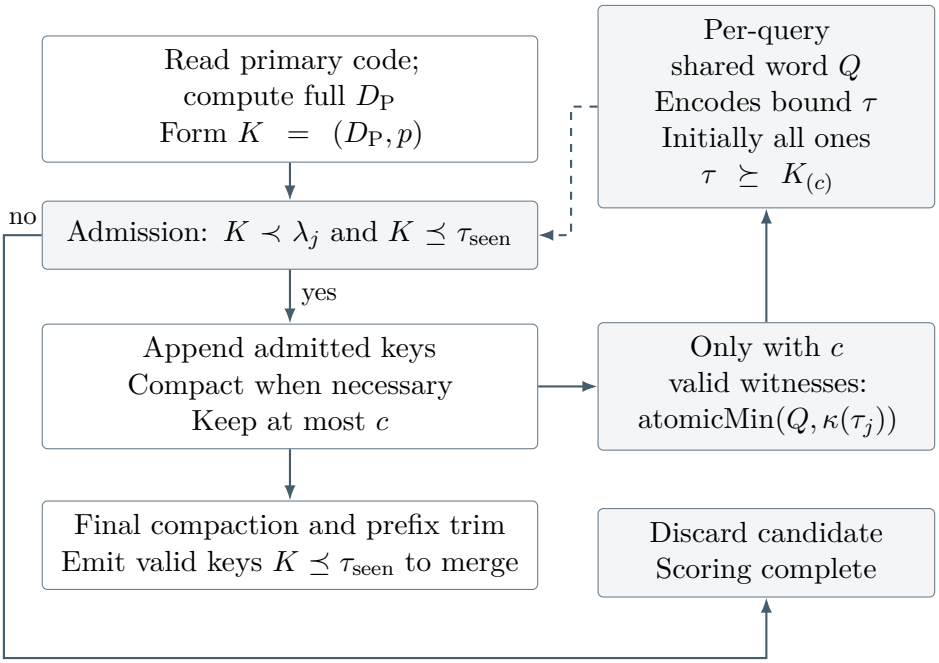



**Figure 5.4:** Shared complete-key filtering for one scan group. A candidate's full primary score is computed before admission. A valid $c$-candidate witness set can tighten the per-query bound; a stale but complete bound only weakens filtering. Final prefix trimming reduces the valid merge input, while the allocated workspace capacity remains unchanged. The whole-key-read premise is qualified in the text.

exist. At scan completion, another publication and a binary search retain only the sorted prefix no later than the observed bound. There is no cross-block barrier or wait for other groups. A late update can leave extra entries in another group's output, which the exact merge safely removes. Bounds are reset before every search in the same stream, and the merge runs after the scan kernel finishes.

The archived binary's extracted PTX contains scalar `ld.volatile.global.u64` and `atom.global.min.u64`. PTX gives compatible, equally sized strong accesses single-copy atomicity [27]; these aligned 64-bit operations therefore supply the whole-key premise at PTX level. Reassembling that PTX with CUDA 13.0 `ptxas` for `sm_120` produces one 64-bit strong system load and one GPU-scope atomic-min reduction, recorded in section A.6. The toolkit disassembly corroborates the contract; the driver JIT's actual SASS was not captured. CUDA C++ `volatile` alone is not the basis of the argument [26].

Figure 5.4 also identifies what this optimisation saves. Every scanned candidate still loads its primary code and computes its complete primary score. The bound avoids some buffer appends, local sorts and intermediate writes, and shortens the lists consumed by the merge. It does not implement partial-distance early termination or

reduce the number of primary scores evaluated. Its benefit competes with polling and atomic-update overhead. The observed paired speedup range includes a slight slowdown, as reported in Section 7.4.

### 5.5.3 Choosing parallelism without changing the budget

For batch size $b$, grouped scanning launches $bg_{\text{scan}}$ blocks instead of $b$. This can expose otherwise unavailable parallelism, but duplicates table staging and local selection and introduces a merge. The fixed-group design therefore cannot be uniformly preferable. Smaller static quotas would reduce intermediate storage, but require a certificate or fallback to preserve coverage; the pilot's concentrated survivor distribution motivated using witnessed thresholds instead (Section 7.4).

The implemented scheduler uses a fill proxy and a workload-skew statistic. Let $T_{\text{blk}}$ be scan threads per block, $H$ the number of SMs times the maximum resident threads per SM, and $v = \text{sd}(n_c)/\,\text{mean}(n_c)$ the candidate-count coefficient of variation. Its rule is

$$g_{\text{fill}} = \max(\{1\} \cup \{h \in \{2, 4, 8\} : bhT_{\text{blk}} \leq 0.6H\}), \tag{5.17}$$

$$g_{\text{skew}} = \begin{cases} 4, & v \geq 0.3, \\ 1, & v < 0.3, \end{cases} \qquad g_{\text{chosen}} = \max(g_{\text{fill}}, g_{\text{skew}}). \tag{5.18}$$

The skew rule may override the fill limit. In the evaluation harness, $v$ is calibrated using 512 database vectors as pseudoqueries and a fixed routing configuration; it uses no ground-truth labels. This is distinct from Chapter 6's sampled output-agreement calibration. Once calibrated, scheduling uses the batch size and stored statistic without an additional per-search host readback. The constants were fitted on four pilot configurations and then evaluated on further configurations. The one-time pseudoquery calibration is excluded from the reported steady-state search times. Supplementary timing separates host gathering (0.81–7.04 ms), the first calibration call (6.00–27.77 ms) and repeat medians (2.72–18.13 ms). This startup cost is separate from refinement-budget calibration (section A.6).

When $g_{\text{chosen}} = 1$, the implementation selects the faster query-centric path, labelled $g_{\text{scan}} = 0$. It leaves the index, probe count and refinement budget unchanged, but inherits that path's distance-only cutoff ties. The common-total-order premise must therefore be checked before claiming identical survivor sets across all scheduler

choices. Section 7.6 reports the separate integrated-output checks and the scheduler's measured gains and regret.

### 5.5.4 Observed execution paths

For the 170-SM RTX 5090, the published 48-warps-per-SM limit gives $0.6H = 156{,}672$ threads [25]. At batch 1,000 with $T_{\text{blk}} = 512$, even two groups require a fill proxy of 1,024,000. The fill rule therefore selects one group; only sufficient skew forces four groups in this case.

The main throughput campaign exercises both implementations, rather than uniformly using grouped scanning. Across 38 E1 run records, nine have $v \geq 0.3$, all Vogue (approximately 0.338–0.622). Their 132 run–budget cells contain 27 Vogue cells scheduled to four groups and 105 arXiv/OpenAI cells scheduled to the query-centric path. Thus the non-Vogue large-batch QPS results do not exercise grouped retention, shared-bound filtering or merging. They still include the LUT, packed access, lane-refinement and probe components.

For Vogue, scheduled-versus-query-centric checks report 3–15 queries with tie-only primary differences per 1,000, zero non-tie differences, and bit-identical final outputs in every recorded cell. The narrower 7–11 range applies only to $n_{\text{probe}} = 128$.

The budget campaign makes the calibration/evaluation distinction concrete: 10 of 12 held-out configurations use the query-centric scan (batch 500, or Stella's 499); the two Vogue configurations use four groups. At calibration size $S = 128$, eight use two groups, two use four, and two remain query-centric. Execution paths therefore differ in 8/12 configurations. Grouped selection principally serves smaller batches and skewed workloads; there is no universal batch-256 boundary. The offline recount and input hashes are recorded in `data/ch5/review-audit.json`.

The rule is a heuristic rather than an occupancy calculation or a latency oracle: it omits register pressure, shared-memory residency, budget-dependent compaction cost and merge cost. A frozen pseudoquery statistic can also misrepresent future queries. In the recorded campaign the largest regret occurs at batch 256, where a fixed-group alternative is about 1.217× faster. The design combines parallel candidate scanning, witnessed filtering and workload-dependent execution, with its gains and regret measured under a fixed refinement budget. Refinement and final top-$k$ consume the resulting valid survivors as described in Section 5.6.

## 5.6 Lane-Cooperative Residual Scoring and Final Top-k

Only the primary survivors access residual codes. This preserves a broad, cheap scan over $n_c$ candidates followed by a narrower $O(cd)$ scoring stage. Reading residuals for every visited candidate would instead move that coordinate work towards $O(n_c d)$. Lane cooperation accelerates the chosen survivors; it does not decide the refinement budget.

### 5.6.1 Reconstructed scoring and the query-only constant

Let $\widehat{p}(x)$ be the primary reconstruction and $\widehat{r}(x)$ the decoded residual in transformed coordinates. The encoder stores $\gamma(x) = 2\langle \widehat{p}(x), \widehat{r}(x) \rangle$. The implemented refined ranking score is

$$D_{\mathrm{H}}(q, x) = D_{\mathrm{P}}(q, x) + \|q' - \widehat{r}(x)\|_2^2 + \gamma(x) \tag{5.19}$$

$$= \|q' - \widehat{p}(x) - \widehat{r}(x)\|_2^2 + \|q'\|_2^2. \tag{5.20}$$

The second equality follows by expanding the squared norms. Thus the score orders hierarchical reconstructions by squared distance, but the returned value includes a query-only constant. It is neither a direct raw-vector distance nor an unshifted reconstruction distance. The constant does not affect a fixed query's ordering. Reconstruction error remains even when selection under this score is exact [15].

Residual coordinates use scalar codebook entries shared within a subspace. The scalar path walks each candidate's dimensions and sums their squared differences from $q'$. Query coordinates and, when space permits, the residual codebook are staged in shared memory; the stored correction and primary score are added afterwards.

### 5.6.2 Mapping lanes to words and reducing partial sums

For $\ell_{\mathrm{ref}} = L \in \{1, 8, 16, 32\}$, a scan-independent refinement block assigns $L$ adjacent lanes to a candidate. A 32-bit residual word holds $d_{\mathrm{word}} = 32/B_R$ coordinate codes, where $B_R$ is the residual bit width. The tested eight-bit path has $d_{\mathrm{word}} = 4$; the four-bit path has $d_{\mathrm{word}} = 8$. Lane $a$ reads word indices $a, a + L, a + 2L, \ldots$, decodes their coordinates and accumulates a partial sum. A butterfly shuffle reduction combines the $L$ partials, and lane zero writes the refined score.

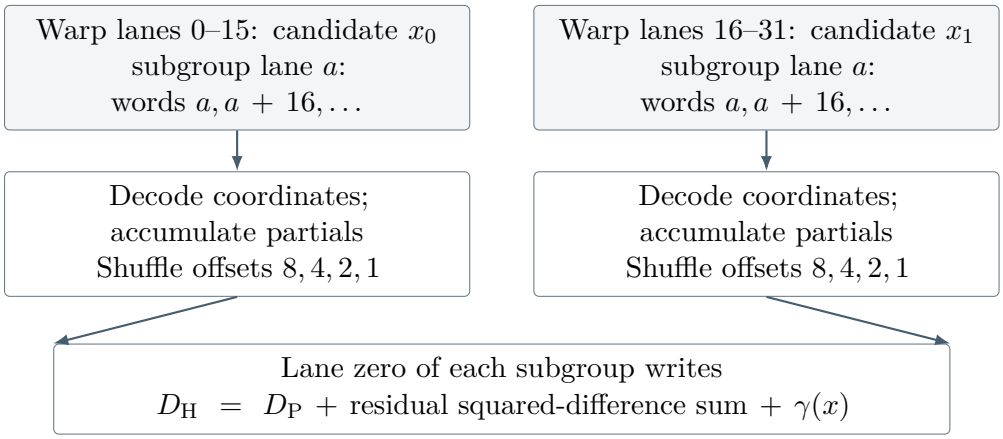



**Figure 5.5:** Sixteen-lane residual refinement. A warp handles two candidates; lane $a$ within a candidate reads residual words $a, a + 16, \ldots$. With eight-bit residual codes, each 32-bit word decodes four coordinates. Subgroup reductions combine partial scores before adding the retained primary score and correction. Candidate positions can be scattered even when each subgroup's word access is contiguous.

The launch requires a word-aligned residual row and $D_s$ divisible by $d_{\mathrm{word}}$, so a word never crosses a subspace's codebook boundary. All lanes execute the shuffle sequence, including lanes assigned to invalid or out-of-range survivor slots; these contribute zero before the output is marked infinite. This avoids making warp participation depend on whether a particular candidate exists. At $L = 16$ a warp handles two candidates, rather than one candidate per lane.

The experiment separates two changes. L0 is the original scalar byte-load path; L1 uses word loads with one lane per candidate, preserving its accumulation order. L8/L16/L32 additionally distribute coordinate work across lanes. This shortens each lane's serial walk and provides useful work when $c$ is small, but adds shuffles and reduces the number of independent candidates handled concurrently. Larger $L$ is therefore not automatically better. Irregular survivor positions and shared/global codebook placement remain relevant costs.

### 5.6.3 Final selection and the numerical boundary

For at least $k$ valid survivors with finite refined scores and unique database IDs, the final kernel performs exact top-$k$ selection under $(D_{\mathrm{H}}, \text{database ID})$. One block per query loads the $c$ scores and repeatedly reduces the minimum, emits its ID and score, and removes that score before the next round. All $c$ slots are scanned at each round; there is no fixed per-thread candidate quota. This contract requires $k$ finite valid entries. In a degenerate pool, selection sets the winning score to infinity but leaves

its position valid: after finite entries are exhausted, the smallest valid ID can repeat with an infinite score. An entirely invalid pool returns invalid IDs and infinity. These cases lie outside the finite-pool contract used for the reported evaluation.

The final ID tie rule differs from the physical-position rule used for primary retention. An exact final selector cannot recover candidates discarded by routing or screening, nor remove quantisation error. Wider lane reductions also change floating-point association before selection, which can move near-tied candidates even when the real-arithmetic formula is unchanged.

Section 7.3 separates these effects: L1 is bit-identical in its tested cases, while multi-lane distance differences reach approximately $1.6 \times 10^{-6}$ relative error. The ordinary L16 end-to-end gains range from 1.015 to 1.789×; kernel-only gains are larger and must not be substituted for them. The design is supported by controlled load-only and cooperative variants, with numerical equivalence tested rather than assumed.

## 5.7 IVF Probe Selection as an Independent Primitive

Probe selection precedes primary scanning and selects inverted lists, not database-vector survivors. For IVF centroid $\mu_i$, the selector orders the FP32-valued computed routing scores

$$s_i = \|\mu_i\|_2^2 - 2\langle q', \mu_i \rangle, \qquad (s_i, i) \text{ ordered lexicographically.} \tag{5.21}$$

Omitting the common query norm preserves centroid ordering. In contrast to primary squared-distance tables, these scores can be negative. The required output is the first $n_{\text{sel}} = \min(n_{\text{probe}}, n_{\text{list}})$ centroid IDs in score order, using the smaller list ID at a tie, plus the prefix offsets of their list lengths.

The dot products inherit the cuBLAS math mode: in the measured v69, OpenAI rotation and centroid GEMMs use TF32 inputs with FP32 accumulation. The selector's exactness concerns these computed scores. Its subsequent FP32 `fma` and deterministic key ordering do not recover rounding already introduced by the GEMM (section 7.2.3).

### 5.7.1 Radix selection followed by deterministic ordering

The earlier bitonic selector repeatedly bitonic-sorted a growing candidate buffer. The radix replacement keeps one block per query but finds the cutoff by four most-significant-byte-first radix passes. Each pass counts only keys matching the prefix selected so far, then locates the bin containing the remaining order statistic. After four passes it has the cutoff key and the number of equal-cutoff entries still required.

The float mapping canonicalises both signed zeros to positive zero, then transforms their 32-bit representation $u$ by

$$F(u) = \begin{cases} \sim u, & \text{if the sign bit is set,} \\ u \mid 2^{31}, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \tag{5.22}$$

For non-NaN floats this preserves numerical order, including negative scores and infinities; canonicalisation makes equal zeros share a key. This differs from the nonnegative-score encoding in equation (5.16). NaNs are outside the selector's ordering contract. Every pass recomputes scores with the same explicitly rounded `fma` expression, so changing the pass does not change its keys.

The histogram has 256 bins and 32 lane replicas, requiring 32 KiB for its counters alone. Replicas separate same-warp atomic updates to a popular bin; different warps can still contend. This exchanges shared storage and reduction work for less concentrated histogram updating, rather than eliminating all contention.

Collection first gathers every key below the cutoff. If too many keys equal the cutoff, an ordered rescan uses ballots and prefix counts to take exactly the required number in increasing list-ID order. Atomic arrival order therefore does not choose the final tied subset. For each of the $n_{\text{sel}}$ selected entries, a rank-count step counts how many selected keys precede it under $(s_i, i)$ and writes it to that rank. This restores deterministic sorted order without sorting all centroids.

Finally, a block prefix scan produces offsets of the selected list lengths and their total candidate count. When $n_{\text{probe}} > n_{\text{list}}$, the implementation pads the ID array by repeating the final selected ID but assigns those extra entries zero length. They do not scan the same list again. Nonempty centroid sets and a positive requested probe count are assumed.

### 5.7.2 Costs and separate correctness contracts

The histogram passes and collection revisit the centroid-score row; rank counting costs $O(n_{\text{sel}}^2)$ comparisons. The algorithm is consequently not a uniformly linear-cost substitute for every probe count. Large $n_{\text{sel}}$ increases both ranking work and selected-entry shared storage, while the histogram reserves space even for small centroid sets. Radix selection is an established selection technique; the contribution here is its deterministic integration and measured execution trade-off for this query pipeline.

The archived probe checker reports 1,792 cases with zero differences against the earlier selector in IDs, offsets and total candidate counts. Its distributions include many ties, all-equal values, mixed signed zeros, mostly infinite values and extreme magnitudes. Cases also cover requested probe counts larger than the number of lists. These are targeted finite tests of the probe primitive, not a proof of primary top-$c$ or of exact nearest neighbours.

Section 7.4 gives the real-query identity checks, stage timings and end-to-end comparison. It also retains the Vogue cross-process anomaly: matching probe/primary dumps do not imply identical final pipeline outputs. The optional FP16 routing changes score precision and is a separate approximation; high probe overlap or unchanged recall does not make it part of the computed-score equivalence claim.

Chapter 6

# Workload-Level Refinement-Budget Calibration

Chapters 4 and 5 establish a compressed index and its GPU execution. This chapter addresses RQ3: how much refinement work a workload needs, and whether selecting that budget repays its calibration cost. The policy compares unlabelled query outputs with a larger-budget reference and reuses one selected multiplier across batches. The method is analysed through its acceptance rule, conditional selection theorem, experimental controls and amortisation model. Chapter 7 reports the measured outcomes.

## 6.1 Why Fixed Refinement Budgets Can Be Wasteful

JHQ screens routed candidates with primary codes before reading residuals for a smaller survivor set [15]. For a query $q$, let $U(q)$ be the candidates in its selected IVF lists. The refinement multiplier sets

$$c(\alpha) = \max\{k, \lceil \alpha k \rceil\}, \qquad C_\alpha(q) = \mathrm{Top}^{\mathrm{primary}}_{\min\{c(\alpha),|U(q)|\}} U(q). \tag{6.1}$$

Here $C_\alpha$ denotes valid survivors. The implementation reserves $c(\alpha)$ slots and can pad an underfull pool with sentinels. The analysis assumes at least $k$ valid candidates. Raising $\alpha$ expands refinement capacity within the visited lists; raising $n_{\mathrm{probe}}$ changes the visited universe. Neither operation recovers information lost by the other automatically.

A large fixed $\alpha$ may repeatedly refine candidates that do not change the final top-$k$. A small value can exclude a useful neighbour before residual scoring. Which tradeoff is worthwhile depends on the query population, primary reconstruction, list coverage and refined-score ordering. One global default therefore need not suit every dataset–probe configuration. The evaluated grid spans $c = 20$ to 2,000 at $k = 10$. Changing it reuses the same trained index and stored residuals. Lowering the

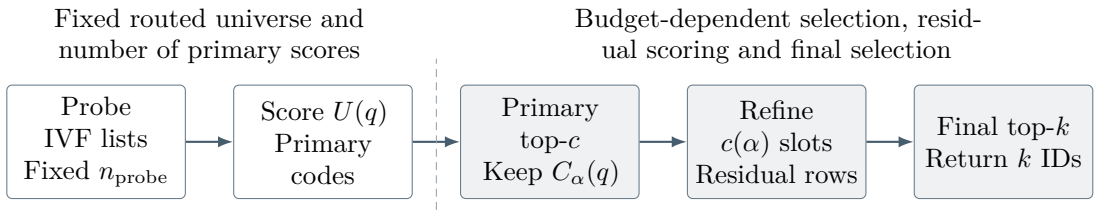



**Figure 6.1:** The refinement budget changes work after primary-score production. With a fixed query, index and probe count, it leaves the routed candidate universe unchanged. The highlighted stages depend on survivor capacity; this is a logical work decomposition, not a measured latency breakdown. The scan kernel also performs budget-dependent admission and compaction. Padding applies when fewer than $c$ candidates exist.

multiplier reduces residual rows accessed, rather than releasing the resident residual representation. Survivor buffers grow when capacity is insufficient and retain that capacity afterward, so a smaller budget is not a proportional reduction in allocated memory.

An explanatory latency decomposition is

$$T(\alpha) = T_{\text{base}} + T_{\text{select}}(c(\alpha)) + T_{\text{refine}}(c(\alpha)) + T_{\text{final}}(c(\alpha)). \tag{6.2}$$

For a fixed batch and route, $T_{\text{base}}$ includes transfer, rotation, routing and primary-score production; selection, residual scoring and final selection depend on the survivor capacity (figure 6.1). This is a work model, not a fitted latency predictor. Buffer capacities, launch occupancy and resource thresholds can change in steps. At small budgets, fixed work can produce a throughput plateau. Ten alternating remeasurements of OpenAI-3072 at 128 probes give 142.3/142.7 kQPS for $\alpha = 4/2$, reversing the archived noisy 145.0/128.7 kQPS contrast (section 7.5.5). The policy minimises accepted budget rather than optimising a noisy timing rank.

Each calibration trial still runs rotation, probing and primary scoring before refinement. Reusing the index avoids rebuilding or retraining; it does not cache every intermediate query result across budget trials. The cost of calibration must therefore count full searches, not merely the difference between two residual-scoring workloads.

The policy selects one budget for an index, routing configuration, $k$ and query workload. It uses neither a trained per-query predictor nor an online choice for each arriving query. Scan-group scheduling remains the separate mechanism of section 5.5; its execution path must still be considered when interpreting budget calibration.

**Position among adaptive ANN methods.** The multiplier has the same candidate-pool role as FAISS `IndexRefine::k_factor` and cuVS's refinement ratio [6, 9]. FAISS auto-tuning explores speed–accuracy operating points using a ground-truth criterion [8]. Li et al. learn per-query termination conditions from search features [19]; DARTH predicts recall during execution to stop at a requested target [5]. Here the decision calibrates one unlabelled workload budget for reuse, using reference-output coverage rather than a trained recall predictor. The final scorer remains a compressed reconstruction, whereas the cuVS refinement example reranks source vectors. These distinctions separate the work parameter, its selection mechanism and the scored representation.

## 6.2 GT-Free Sampled Output Agreement

Let $\mathcal{R}_\alpha(q)$ be the set of $k$ valid, unique database IDs returned at budget $\alpha$ on a fixed index. Define $\mathcal{R}_{\mathrm{ref}}(q) = \mathcal{R}_{\alpha_{\mathrm{ref}}}(q)$. The descending grid is

$$A = (200, 100, 64, 32, 16, 8, 4, 2), \qquad \alpha_{\mathrm{ref}} = A[0] = 200. \tag{6.3}$$

For $S$ calibration queries $\mathcal{Q}_S$, define

$$D_S(\alpha) = \sum_{q \in \mathcal{Q}_S} \left(k - |\mathcal{R}_\alpha(q) \cap \mathcal{R}_{\mathrm{ref}}(q)|\right), \qquad D_S(\alpha) \le \epsilon. \tag{6.4}$$

The evaluated $\epsilon = 1$ permits one missing reference ID across the whole sample. It ignores output order and distance differences; replacing one ID counts once, although the symmetric difference contains two IDs. The finite-grid objective is

$$\widehat{\alpha} = \min\{\alpha \in A : D_S(\alpha) \le \epsilon\}. \tag{6.5}$$

The reference supplies a nonempty fallback. The objective minimises an accepted multiplier; section 6.3 states when bisection solves it exactly.

At $k = 10$, the normalised allowance $\epsilon/(Sk)$ is 0.003125, 0.0015625 and 0.00078125 for $S = 32, 64, 128$, and 0.0002 at $S = 500$. Increasing $S$ therefore changes both coverage and effective strictness. Calibration and held-out evaluation use disjoint queries; subsamples reuse a finite calibration pool (section 7.5).

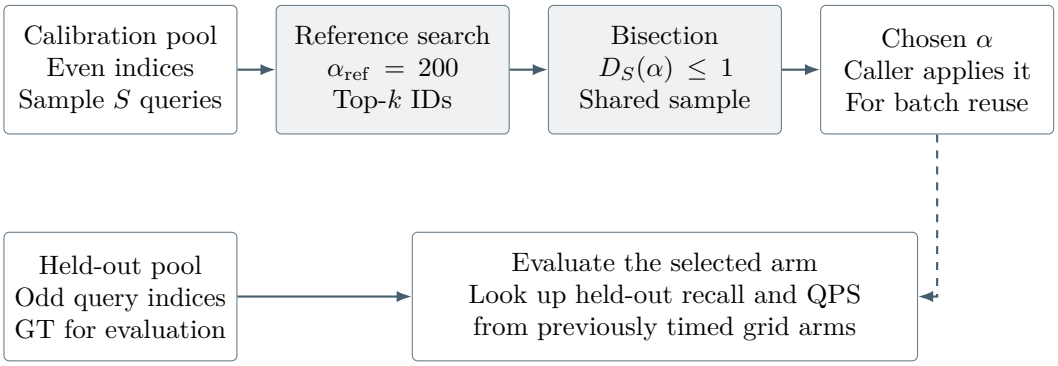



**Figure 6.2:** Workload-level calibration and its evaluation. Budget decisions use reference IDs; GT assesses held-out quality. Selected-arm results are looked up from timed fixed arms. Implementation boundaries are in section A.3.

### 6.2.1 What agreement controls

Under Proposition 6.1, disagreement counts reference answers excluded by primary screening:

$$D_S(\alpha) = \sum_{q \in \mathcal{Q}_S} |\mathcal{R}_{\text{ref}}(q) \setminus C_\alpha(q)|. \tag{6.6}$$

For valid fixed-size output sets, let $r_{\mathcal{Q}_S}$ denote GT recall on these same queries. Each missing reference ID removes at most one GT hit, so

$$r_{\mathcal{Q}_S}(\alpha) \geq r_{\mathcal{Q}_S}(\text{ref}) - \frac{D_S(\alpha)}{Sk}. \tag{6.7}$$

This bound is sample-local and reference-relative. Agreement controls additional loss relative to the reference; the reference's own quality requires GT evaluation. Section 7.8.2 quantifies that distinction with the reconstruction pilot.

### 6.2.2 Sampling resolution and ordered testing

Let $H_S$ count queries with any missing reference ID. Since $H_S \leq D_S$, acceptance implies $H_S \leq 1$. For a prespecified budget and i.i.d. queries, the one-sided 95% exact binomial upper limit after one event solves [23]

$$(1-u)^S + Su(1-u)^{S-1} = 0.05. \tag{6.8}$$

The query-event limits are 0.03652 at $S = 128$ and 0.009452 at 500. Treating all $Sk$ result indicators as homogeneous independent Bernoulli trials is stronger: the corresponding limits are 0.003701 and 0.0009484, approximately $4.74/(Sk)$. Query

i.i.d. alone does not justify dividing the query-event limit by $k$; neither model certifies repeated subsamples of this fixed pool.

For monotone disagreement and a fixed grid order, bisection selects the accepted prefix. If its per-arm decisions are valid level tests, the first-unsafe-arm argument gives fixed-sequence error control without a Bonferroni factor [3]. The implemented one-slot rule is a stability threshold; a GT-risk guarantee would require a valid test for that target.

**A finite-pool extension.** Suppose every query has a fixed disagreement count $X_q(\alpha)$ under the intended sample-size execution regime, unchanged by subset membership or position. Let $N_{\text{cal}}$ be the pool size and $n_j$ count queries with $X_q = j$. Under uniform sampling without replacement, $D_S \leq 1$ requires either only zero-count queries or one single-count query [24]:

$$\Pr\{D_S(\alpha) \leq 1\} = \frac{\binom{n_0}{S} + n_1\binom{n_0}{S-1}}{\binom{N_{\text{cal}}}{S}}. \tag{6.9}$$

Out-of-range binomial coefficients are zero. This is a conditional acceptance model. Predicting selection risk additionally needs the grid's acceptance structure and selected-arm quality map. The supplementary full-pool records reproduce every sampled curve by summing the recorded $X_q$ over its actual sample IDs: 18,432 grid counts match, including changes of execution path (section 7.5.5). This validates the aggregate counts on those draws. Prediction for arbitrary subsets still assumes stable per-query counts. Acceptance needs no labels; predicting GT-loss crossings additionally uses the fixed-arm held-out quality map.

## 6.3 Budget Search, Nestedness and Tie Safety

### 6.3.1 Bisection and complete enumeration

Write $J = |A|$. The implementation computes the sample reference once, then searches for the largest acceptable index in the descending grid:

1. Set $l = 0$, $h = J - 1$. Index zero is the reference fallback.
2. While $l < h$, test $j = \lfloor (l + h + 1)/2 \rfloor$ by running $A[j]$ and computing $D_S(A[j])$.
3. If $D_S(A[j]) \leq \epsilon$, set $l = j$; otherwise set $h = j - 1$.
4. Return $A[l]$. A caller applies it before processing reuse batches.

The eight-point grid needs at most three complete candidate searches in addition to the reference. Invocation, host-comparison complexity and timing boundaries are specified in section A.3.

Complete enumeration repeats the reference and tests all seven other budgets on exactly the same sample, selecting the smallest accepted multiplier. Including a fresh reference in both timers aligns their cost boundaries. Enumeration evaluates the finite grid even if acceptance has holes; bisection requires an accepted prefix to guarantee the same minimum.

### 6.3.2 A sufficient condition for monotonicity

**Proposition 6.1** (Nested survivors preserve reference membership)**.** *For one query, assume fixed routing and survivor sets $C_\alpha \subseteq C_\beta \subseteq C_{\alpha_{\text{ref}}}$ whenever $\alpha \leq \beta \leq \alpha_{\text{ref}}$. Assume at least $k$ valid survivors, fixed refined scores and one deterministic total order for final ties. Each result is the exact top-$k$ in that order. Then*

$$|\mathcal{R}_\alpha \cap \mathcal{R}_{\text{ref}}| = |C_\alpha \cap \mathcal{R}_{\text{ref}}|, \qquad D_S(\alpha) \geq D_S(\beta). \tag{6.10}$$

*The latter statement holds when these conditions hold for every sampled query.*

*Proof.* A reference item has fewer than $k$ predecessors in the largest survivor set. If it is present in a smaller set, restriction cannot introduce new predecessors, so it remains in that set's exact top-$k$. Thus the intersection with the reference equals the reference items present in the survivor set. Nestedness can only add such items. Summing missing reference counts over queries proves the inequality. □

Exact primary top-$c$ under one fixed total key supplies the nesting premise as $c$ grows. A fixed refined total key then makes acceptance monotone, so acceptable indices form a prefix and bisection finds the smallest accepted grid budget. Neither GT recall nor execution speed appears in this theorem. Approximate refined scores can promote a false neighbour as the pool grows, and runtime remains hardware dependent.

### 6.3.3 A corollary for the evaluated grouped path

The run-head source defaults to exact primary selection. Within one calibration draw, $S$, routing and scan threads are fixed; `scheduled_groups(S)` is independent of $c$. Changing the budget changes buffer capacity and admission work, while the grouped scorer uses the same FP32 LUT entries and accumulation order. Refinement

| Case | $C_1$ | $C_2$ | $C_3$ | Reference overlap |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Nested | $\{b\}$ | $\{b, c\}$ | $\{a, b, c\}$ | 0, 0, 1 |
| Non-nested | $\{a\}$ | $\{b, c\}$ | $\{a, b, c\}$ | 1, 0, 1 |

**Figure 6.3:** Constructed $k = 1$ example with refined order $a \prec b \prec c$ and reference $\{a\}$. The nested case preserves reference membership. With all primary scores tied, different tie choices can produce the non-nested middle pool and break monotonicity. These are explanatory sets, not measured GPU outputs.

fixes $B_r$ and 16 lanes, preserving each candidate's residual reduction; final selection uses $(D_{\mathrm{H}}, \mathrm{ID})$.

**Corollary 6.2** (Grouped calibration)**.** *For the evaluated grouped configuration, under the representation and shared-bound contracts of Chapters 4 and 5, primary survivors are nested across budgets. Consequently Proposition 6.1 applies and bisection returns the same minimum accepted grid budget as enumeration.*

*Proof.* Lemma 5.1 and propositions 5.1 and 5.2 give exact primary top-$c$ under the common key $(D_{\mathrm{P}}, \mathrm{position})$. Its prefixes nest as $c$ grows. The fixed per-candidate refinement and exact final total order supply the remaining premises of Proposition 6.1. □

The corollary covers 2,176 of the 2,304 subsampled draws at $S = 32, 64, 128$. The remaining 128 use OpenAI-3072's distance-only one-block selector at $S = 128$. The supplementary trace records every grid count: all 2,304 curves are monotone and all decisions match enumeration (section 7.5.5).

**Full-pool coverage.** The twelve $S = 500$ calls are separate: two Vogue cells use grouped selection and ten use $g_{\mathrm{scan}} = 0$. The supplementary harness adds full-pool enumeration: all twelve curves are monotone and all selected budgets match the minimum accepted enumerated budget. This closes the finite-grid empirical check. The ten distance-only cells still lie outside Corollary 6.2; a common cutoff order, or no tie straddling any grid cutoff including the reference cutoff, remains a sufficient condition for a general nestedness guarantee. Matching the held-out regime aids transfer without proving that broader condition.

**A rank-based extension.** Under the same nestedness and fixed-score conditions, let $\mathrm{rank}_{\mathrm{P}}(x)$ be a reference answer's one-based rank under the common primary key. Then

$$D_S(\alpha) = \sum_{q \in \mathcal{Q}_S} \sum_{x \in \mathcal{R}_{\mathrm{ref}}(q)} \mathbf{1}\{\mathrm{rank}_{\mathrm{P}}(x) > c(\alpha)\}. \tag{6.11}$$

**Table 6.1:** Budget controls and the questions they answer. Held-out GT is used to assess every result, but only the diagnostic oracle uses it to choose a budget. The reference is fixed at 200 for agreement-based arms.

| Control | Selection information | Question |
|---|---|---|
| Fixed 100 | No calibration | Gain relative to the inherited default? |
| Fixed 64 and smaller grid arms | No calibration | Does a simple fixed choice remove the need for calibration? |
| Sampled bisection | $S$ unlabelled queries; slot agreement | How well does a low-cost sample choose a reusable budget? |
| Same-sample enumeration | Same $S$, reference and threshold; all grid arms | Did bisection miss the smallest accepted grid budget? |
| Full-pool calibration | All 500 calibration queries; same bisection rule | What changes with broader coverage and a stricter normalised allowance? |
| Held-out oracle | GT recall and timed QPS for all arms | Which measured arm is fastest under the diagnostic quality constraint? |

Exporting these ranks would recover the grid curve from one reference search. The current harness reruns each budget; rank extraction and transfer remain prospective work under the same ordering conditions.

## 6.4 Budget Baselines and Their Questions

Table 6.1 separates budget selection from its evaluation. Fixed arms share the index, route and held-out queries; invocation and timing details are in section A.3.

Let $\widehat{r}(\alpha)$ and $\widehat{Q}(\alpha)$ be measured held-out recall and QPS, and let $\widehat{r}^* = \max_{\alpha \in A} \widehat{r}(\alpha)$. The oracle is

$$\alpha_{\text{oracle}} \in \arg\max_{\alpha \in A} \left\{ \widehat{Q}(\alpha) : \widehat{r}(\alpha) \geq \widehat{r}^* - \delta \right\}, \qquad \delta = 10^{-3}. \tag{6.12}$$

The recall slack $\delta$ differs from the slot allowance $\epsilon$. The oracle consumes held-out labels and timings: it is a finite-grid diagnostic, not a deployable label-free decision rule.

Full-pool calibration remains label free and uses bisection, not a GT-constrained scan of all budgets. Its larger sample also tightens $\epsilon/(Sk)$. Same-sample enumeration instead holds sample coverage and threshold fixed, isolating the search procedure. The oracle solves a quality-constrained speed problem, whereas agreement minimises an accepted multiplier. Even exact bisection and perfect calibration-pool coverage need not select the oracle arm.

Fixed 64 tests whether a smaller universal default already captures the benefit; fixed 200 supplies a high-budget control. Their observed quality and selected-budget outcomes are in tables 7.8 and 7.9.

## 6.5 Hold-out Risk, Calibration Cost and Payback

### 6.5.1 Choosing a calibration scale

The full-pool working point is supported by the held-out results in table 7.7; sampled alternatives are evaluated in figure 7.5. The independent-slot model in section 6.2 provides a planning scale: at $k = 10$, $4.74/(Sk) \approx 10^{-3}$ suggests $S$ of order 500, while 128 has coarser resolution. This strong model concerns reference disagreement, not GT loss, and does not make the empirical recommendation a prespecified quality guarantee.

Full-pool and held-out batches use the same scan regime. Ten cells use distance-only cutoffs; full-pool enumeration now confirms the minimum accepted grid budget in all twelve measured cells (section 6.3). This empirical check complements the grouped-path theorem without extending it to arbitrary distance-only ties.

### 6.5.2 Risk and selected-arm performance

Over $m$ calibration draws, let draw $r$ select $\widehat{\alpha}_r$. Define held-out loss and threshold-crossing frequency by

$$L_r = \widehat{r}^* - \widehat{r}(\widehat{\alpha}_r), \qquad \widehat{p}_\delta = \frac{1}{m}\sum_{r=1}^{m} \mathbf{1}\{L_r > \delta\}. \tag{6.13}$$

Mean loss, crossing frequency and tail size answer different questions. Table 7.8 and figure 7.5 report the archived summaries; the supplementary per-draw maxima are in table 7.11.

Reported selected-arm rate is $\overline{Q} = m^{-1}\sum_r \widehat{Q}(\widehat{\alpha}_r)$, a lookup from timed fixed arms. It is distinct from the median budget's rate and from the throughput of a calibrated query stream. Quality and speed must be read together (table 7.10).

### 6.5.3 Cost of reuse

For $B_{\text{reuse}}$ equal-sized subsequent batches, model

$$T_{\text{policy}}(B_{\text{reuse}}) = T_{\text{cal}} + B_{\text{reuse}}T_{\text{chosen}}, \qquad T_{\text{fixed}}(B_{\text{reuse}}) = B_{\text{reuse}}T_f. \tag{6.14}$$

When $T_{\text{chosen}} < T_f$, the break-even count is

$$B^*_{\text{reuse}} = \frac{T_{\text{cal}}}{T_f - T_{\text{chosen}}}. \tag{6.15}$$

Strictly exceeding $B^*_{\text{reuse}}$ gives positive saving. If the chosen batch is no faster, there is no throughput payback. Convert QPS to milliseconds as $T = 1000n/Q$ for an $n$-query batch. Using $1/\overline{Q}$ is optimistic when choices vary, because $1/\mathbb{E}[Q] \leq \mathbb{E}[1/Q]$. Measured call boundaries are in section A.3; direct calibration-plus-stream totals validate this model in four measured cells (section 7.5.6), with quality reported alongside time. Figure 7.6 gives the campaign's estimates.

**A worked reuse calculation.** On OpenAI-1536 at 128 probes, full-pool calibration selects $\alpha = 8$, requesting 80 survivors versus fixed 100's 1,000. Both arms have recall 0.9280; their rates are 267,690 and 167,451 QPS. For 500 queries this gives $T_{\text{chosen}} = 1.868\,\text{ms}$ and $T_f = 2.986\,\text{ms}$. With 9.5 ms calibration, $B^*_{\text{reuse}} = 8.50$: nine subsequent batches give positive modelled saving. These are calculations from archived arms, not directly timed stream costs.

Recalibration every $H$ batches would add $T_{\text{cal}}/H$ per batch; drift detection and automatic recalibration remain future work.

## 6.6 Policy Failure Modes and Applicability

Reuse is justified only for a sufficiently stable index, $k$, routing configuration and query population. Changing the index or routing changes the calibration target; a different batch regime may also change ties and arithmetic through scheduling. The checks in table 6.2 define applicability conditions, not automatic safeguards already supplied by the harness.

**Table 6.2:** Conditions to check before interpreting or reusing a calibrated budget. Measured net cost and representation checks have stated finite coverage; future drift handling remains separate work.

| Failure mode | Evidence or condition needed |
|---|---|
| Reference misses true neighbours | Held-out GT quality alongside agreement |
| Sample misses difficult queries | Crossing frequency and tail loss over the stated pool |
| Non-nested ties or changed paths | Common ordering, or matched finite-grid enumeration |
| Noisy arm timing or short job | Repeated timing and direct total cost including calibration |
| Changed index, route or query mix | Fresh validation before reusing the chosen multiplier |
| Underfull or invalid outputs | Valid-ID counts and uniqueness before applying set agreement |

For the observed workload family, the resulting choice is full-pool calibration when quality takes priority, with $S = 128$ as the cheaper variant whose crossing risk is measured separately. A caller must install the selected $\alpha$ explicitly and reuse it with the same index, route and $k$. The contribution is a label-free finite-grid decision, a conditional exact search for that decision and a cost model for reuse. Chapter 7 tests its quality and speed against fixed budgets and the diagnostic oracle, and directly measures calibrated reuse on four cells.

The supplementary archive now contains every draw's sample IDs, selected $\alpha$, full $D_S$ curve and loss, full-pool enumeration, pool-level $X_q$ records and 500-batch traces. Remaining work concerns arbitrary-subset per-query invariance, a strict CPU reference for actual primary scores, the Vogue cross-process discrepancy and future workload changes. Their status is maintained in `assessment/ch7-pending-experiments.txt`.

The reported budget campaign and its trace rerun use v69 arithmetic, including TF32 on the OpenAI datasets. The separate FP32 sensitivity measures a search frontier; it does not recalibrate or validate these budget choices under FP32.

Chapter 7

# Experimental Evaluation and Research Findings

This chapter answers the thesis's four research questions with measurements of construction, controlled execution changes, held-out budget selection and cross-system search. For **RQ1** (construction and capacity), the largest tested index searches 17.78 million vectors using 20.44 GiB of resident device memory; supplementary train-plus-add repetitions take 10.54–10.65 s, with a sampled construction peak of 22.58 GiB. For **RQ2** (correct and efficient GPU execution), two-group tables lead in 22/24 configurations, and scheduled scanning improves geometric-mean throughput by 2.727× at batch 8 while preserving tested final ID sets. For **RQ3** (budget quality and net cost), full-pool calibration meets the quality target in 12/12 cells, with maximum loss 0.0006; its geometric-mean selected-arm rate is 1.111× fixed 100. Lower-cost $S = 128$ calibration has up to 40/64 threshold crossings. Supplementary decision traces and direct calibrated-reuse timings close the finite-grid and net-cost checks. For **RQ4** (competitive operating regions), at recall 0.97 JHQ is fastest in three historical E1 datasets and numerically close to IVF-RaBitQ on arXiv under interpolation. The OpenAI results use TF32; the FP32 sensitivity retains smaller leads. CAGRA int8 leads at lower recall.

## 7.1 Final Experiment Manifest and Comparison Families

The experiment families separate the evidence needed for RQ1–RQ4. Component names describe the mechanism; implementation versions identify its provenance. Recorded run heads, binary names and source-to-result mapping are given in Chapter A.

**Table 7.1:** Evidence families. Counts denote measured configurations or checks, not independent index builds. All use the RTX 5090; timing protocols differ.

| Family | Purpose and implementation | Coverage |
|---|---|---|
| E1 | v69 versus cuVS graph, PQ, RaBitQ and brute force | 1,590 points; 4 datasets |
| LUT | v71 table grouping, $g_{\mathrm{LUT}} \in \{1, 2, 4, 8\}$ | 24 cells; 96 arms |
| Packing | Historical byte/word access factorial | 48 paired cells |
| Refinement | v61 scalar/load/lane ablation | 13 configurations |
| Scan/bound | v62 global selection; v63 shared bound | 64 / 48 correctness checks |
| Scheduling | Integrated v65 execution policy | 50 workload–batch cells |
| Probe | v69 exact computed-score probe selection | 1,792 synthetic cases |
| Budget | v69 sampled, full-pool and oracle budgets | 12 cells; 64 draws per $S$ |
| Scale | v69 search, cold builds and resident memory | BGE and Stella extensions |
| Supplement | Repeated builds; PTX; pairing; budget traces; precision | 30 builds; 12 budget cells; 76 precision pairs |

### 7.1.1 Evidence families and measurement boundaries

Table 7.1 identifies the experiment families used in this chapter. Version numbers name experimental implementations, not successive measurements of one unchanged benchmark. In particular, the historical ADC paper and the later v69/v71 runs have different timing results. The newer raw records determine the corresponding numbers here; historical packing and refinement experiments remain separate ablations. Multiplying their speedups would combine different baselines and would not yield a measured system speedup.

Sections 3.2 and 3.3 define the dataset manifest, environment and measurement protocol. The main system comparison uses host-to-host steady-state throughput on the RTX 5090. Construction and budget calibration are measured separately.

The authors' CPU JHQ artifact is represented in separate archived CPU experiments, rather than in the E1 frontier. The October locality campaign uses Vogue with 1,024 lists and level bits $[8, 4]$, whereas E1 uses 4,096 lists and a different residual budget. Older CPU CSVs come from a local reimplementation; separate CPU audit notes document legacy recall-protocol issues. These records support CPU-local questions, but supply no matched-protocol CPU/GPU acceleration factor here.

Adaptive call counts and auxiliary device-only timing are documented in section A.2.

### 7.1.2 Metrics and reproducibility

All experiments use squared L2 and the Recall@10 definition in equation (3.1). The refinement factor determines $c = \max\{k, \lceil \alpha k \rceil\}$ survivors. Throughout this chapter $g_{\mathrm{LUT}}$ denotes Cartesian table grouping and $g_{\mathrm{scan}}$ denotes parallel scan groups; the two parameters perform different work.

The chapter's analysis script reads existing measurements without running new GPU experiments. It verifies record counts and correctness fields, recomputes paired ratios and matched-recall values, and writes the numeric tables directly from those records. A companion source ledger records SHA-256 hashes of consumed files. Its source-checkout identifier records the audited repository snapshot; it does not imply that every historical binary was built from that commit. Raw run headers and family-specific reports retain the individual build provenance. This separation makes the current figures reproducible without relabelling historical runs.[1]

## 7.2 Modern GPU ANN Recall–QPS Frontiers

This section answers RQ4 by locating common-recall operating regions, including regions in which competing methods are faster.

### 7.2.1 Comparison scope and frontier construction

Figure 7.1 compares JHQ-GPU with CAGRA fp32, scalar-quantized CAGRA int8, IVF-RaBitQ, IVF-PQ and GPU brute force. CAGRA represents graph search; PQ and RaBitQ represent compressed inverted-file alternatives [16, 29, 32]. The four datasets are Vogue (932,328 × 768), arXiv (2,253,000 × 768), and the 999,000-vector OpenAI datasets at 1,536 and 3,072 dimensions. Each uses 1,000 queries in one batch ($b$ = 1,000), with the same ground-truth file across methods. Cross-system comparisons at batches 8–32 are absent; the small-batch gains in section 7.6 are internal ablations.

The recorded schedule uses $g_{\mathrm{scan}} = 0$ for all 105 arXiv/OpenAI run–budget cells and $g_{\mathrm{scan}} = 4$ for all 27 Vogue cells, triggered by Vogue's candidate-count CV of 0.338–0.622. Thus the non-Vogue frontiers exercise query-centric scanning, while Vogue also exercises grouped retention, shared bounds and merging (section 5.5).

[1] The report repository provides `scripts/build_ch7.py`, `data/ch7/audit.json`, `data/ch7/matched.csv` and the source ledger `data/ch7/sources.csv`. The script requires the sibling `JHQ_GPU` checkout containing the archived measurements.

Each method contributes its non-dominated measured operating points. An operating point is removed if another configuration of that method achieves at least its recall and throughput, with a strict improvement in one. Thus a frontier combines search parameters and sometimes distinct index configurations; it is not the trajectory of one fixed index. JHQ contributes 27–39 points per dataset, compared with 54–264 for the baseline families. The E1 parser finds 1,590 valid points, no failure records and no invalid-identifier or duplicate-row flags. This count establishes the size of the search sweep, not 1,590 independent replications.

The parameter coverage is substantive. CAGRA varies graph degree 32/64, search width 1–8 and intermediate top-$k$ capacity 32–512. RaBitQ varies 4/8/9-bit budgets, supported search modes and probe counts up to 1,024. PQ varies code length, lookup precision and probe count. JHQ varies both probe count and refinement budget, extending its initial grid where recall coverage is insufficient. The resulting comparison is conditional on these recorded grids. A curve ending before a target recall indicates an unmeasured operating region, not a proof that the method cannot reach it.

These curves compare achievable throughput, not equal memory consumption. JHQ stores approximately $d/8$ primary bytes and $d$ residual bytes per vector, plus metadata. RaBitQ at nine bits has a comparable nominal $9d/8$ code budget, but its 4/8-bit configurations use less storage. CAGRA int8 also stores graph edges; PQ code lengths vary; CAGRA fp32 retains FP32 vectors. Taking the envelope across these choices is useful for deployment decisions, but cannot isolate a representation advantage at a fixed memory budget. The memory evidence is discussed separately in Section 7.7.

### 7.2.2 Matched recall and opposing operating regions

Table 7.2 quantifies the region around recall 0.97 using two estimators. The interpolated estimator is linear in log throughput between adjacent frontier points and never extrapolates beyond coverage. The measured estimator selects the fastest sampled point reaching the target. The interpolated estimator treats a measured recall within $5 \times 10^{-4}$ of the target as a match; the measured estimator requires recall at least equal to the target. Interpolation reduces sensitivity to unequal grid spacing; the measured estimator corresponds to an actually recorded configuration. Neither creates a new measurement at exactly the requested recall.

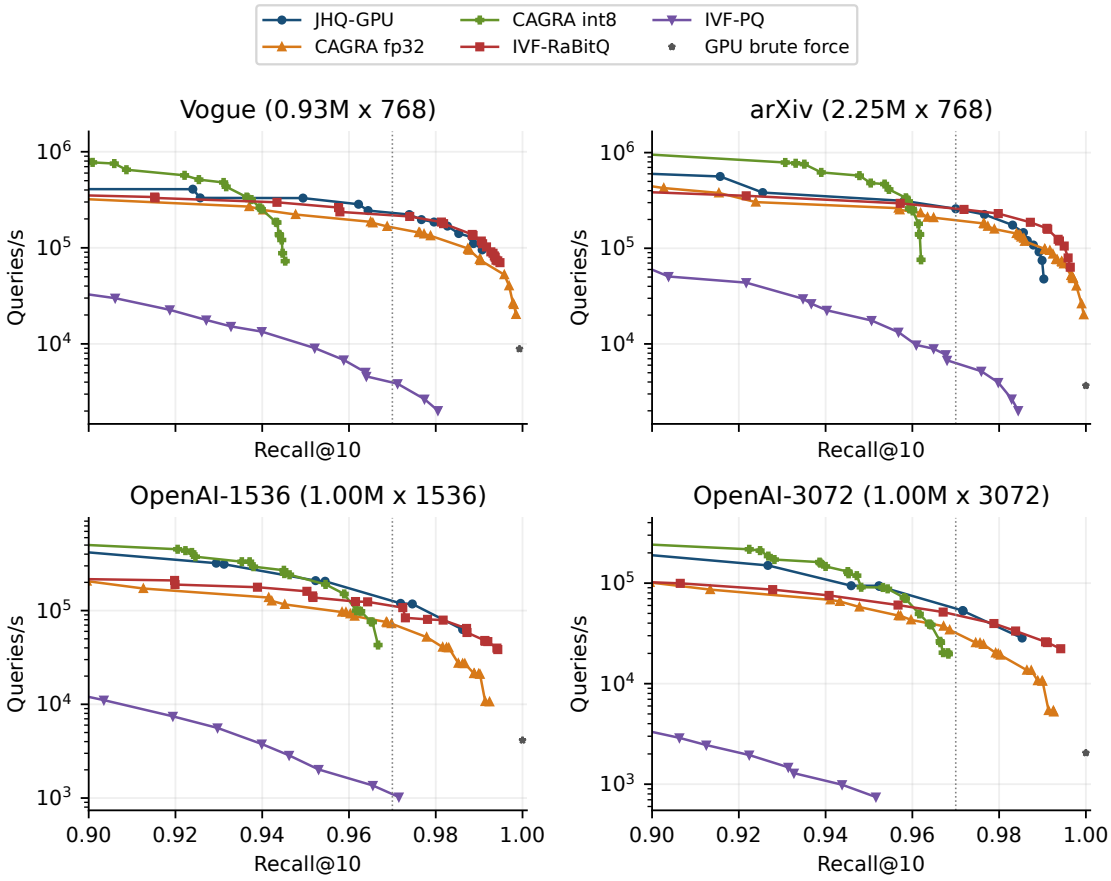



**Figure 7.1:** Measured host-to-host recall–QPS frontiers on the four E1 datasets. The displayed recall window begins at 0.90, with a vertical line at 0.97; all baseline families, including CAGRA int8, participate in frontier construction. Lines connect measured points; throughput uses a logarithmic axis.

**Table 7.2:** Recall 0.97 comparison. Each ratio is interpolated / measured; values above one favour JHQ. JHQ kQPS is the interpolated estimate. The small arXiv–RaBitQ difference changes direction with the estimator.

| Dataset | JHQ kQPS | vs CAGRA fp32 | vs IVF-RaBitQ |
|---|---|---|---|
| Vogue | 230.8 | 1.416 / 1.537 | 1.059 / 1.046 |
| arXiv | 258.6 | 1.317 / 1.422 | 0.996 / 1.015 |
| OpenAI-1536 | 126.7 | 1.747 / 2.294 | 1.130 / 1.111 |
| OpenAI-3072 | 55.9 | 1.747 / 2.088 | 1.157 / 1.346 |

**Table 7.3:** Vogue E1 path sensitivity at batch 1,000. Both frontiers use the same run–budget grid and log-QPS interpolation rule against RaBitQ; each paired run has bit-identical final outputs.

| Recall | $g_{\text{scan}} = 4$ / RaBitQ | $g_{\text{scan}} = 0$ / RaBitQ |
|---|---|---|
| 0.96 | 1.250 | 1.072 |
| 0.97 | 1.059 | 0.933 |

Against CAGRA fp32, interpolated ratios at this target range from 1.317× on arXiv to 1.747× on the two OpenAI datasets. Against IVF-RaBitQ, the corresponding values are 1.059×, 0.996×, 1.130× and 1.157×. The arXiv result is a near tie: its interpolated rate is slightly lower, while the measured threshold comparison is slightly higher. Reporting this as an unequivocal win would give the interpolation convention more evidential weight than the measurement supports.

The paired E1 one-block measurements connect RQ2 to this RQ4 result. Rebuilding Vogue's frontier with $g_{\text{scan}} = 0$ reduces its 0.97 ratio to RaBitQ from 1.059 to 0.933 (table 7.3). The favourable direction therefore depends on the scheduled grouped path in this grid. The comparison holds the index, probes, budget and final outputs fixed within each pair; it measures the integrated path, rather than isolating the shared bound's contribution alone.

Across targets 0.90–0.985, JHQ's interpolated advantage over CAGRA fp32 is approximately 1.10–2.44× in the covered comparisons. However, adding CAGRA int8 changes the low-recall interpretation: around 0.90–0.92, its lower-precision graph search can be faster than JHQ. At higher recall, IVF-RaBitQ often regains the lead, including several targets at 0.98 or above. On arXiv around 0.99, CAGRA fp32 is also faster than JHQ in the recorded grid. The defensible claim is therefore that JHQ has useful competitive regions, particularly around moderately high recall, rather than that it dominates modern GPU ANN methods.

CAGRA int8 reaches maximum measured recalls of 0.9453, 0.9620, 0.9667 and 0.9683 on Vogue, arXiv, OpenAI-1536 and OpenAI-3072, respectively. It therefore has no qualifying point at 0.97 in these grids. At targets 0.90–0.92 it is approximately 1.20–1.98× faster than JHQ by the same interpolation rule; it remains faster at 0.95 on arXiv and at 0.94 on both OpenAI datasets. The 0.97 result concerns methods with measured coverage and does not extend to every target below 0.97.

The two estimators can disagree substantially where the grid is sparse. For example, at recall 0.97 the OpenAI-1536 comparison with CAGRA fp32 is 1.747× by interpolation but 2.294× using qualifying measured points. The latter includes

the cost of whichever baseline point next exceeds the threshold. It should not be presented as a directly measured same-recall advantage of that magnitude. The companion matched table preserves both estimators and marks targets without coverage, enabling readers to distinguish an operating-region result from a sampling artefact.

### 7.2.3 Precision sensitivity on the OpenAI datasets

Supplementary source inspection establishes that the E1 implementation uses TF32 multiplication with FP32 accumulation for OpenAI rotation and centroid GEMMs, despite FP32 input/storage and a misleading source comment (section 4.2). The main E1 frontier remains the historical measurement of that implementation. A separate FP32 variant changes the cuBLAS math-mode switch and replays 37/39 OpenAI configurations at batch 1,000, five rounds each. Execution order alternates between variants across probe settings. Both reuse the same TF32-trained model; the intervention changes add/query arithmetic, including database encoding and routing. It is not a comparison of independently FP32-trained models. Table 7.4 summarises the paired changes.

**Table 7.4:** FP32 sensitivity. QPS ratio is FP32/TF32 at equal configuration (geometric mean); recall differences have the same direction. The last two columns compare the FP32 frontier at recall 0.97 with archived E1 IVF-RaBitQ and CAGRA fp32 frontiers. Baselines were not remeasured.

| Dataset | Pairs | QPS ratio | ΔRecall | vs RaBitQ | vs CAGRA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| OpenAI-1536 | 37 | 0.953 | +0.0003–+0.0005 | 1.086 | 1.679 |
| OpenAI-3072 | 39 | 0.951 | +0.0000–+0.0003 | 1.079 | 1.629 |

At equal configuration, FP32 reduces throughput by about 5% and increases recall by 0–0.0005. At matched recall 0.97, its throughput is about 3% below the same-session TF32 frontier. It remains 1.086× and 1.079× archived RaBitQ, and 1.679× and 1.629× archived CAGRA fp32. Same-session v69/RaBitQ ratios are 1.118/1.114, versus historical 1.130/1.157. This separates the precision intervention from session variation: the competitive direction persists, with smaller margins, while the cross-session baseline comparison retains timing uncertainty. The two precision variants' complete frontiers are shown in figure 7.2.

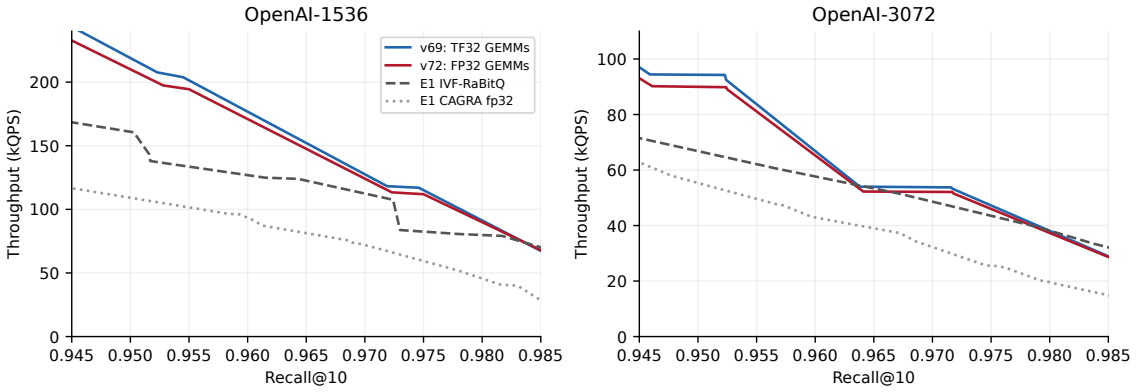



**Figure 7.2:** Supplementary precision frontiers. Solid curves are same-session JHQ variants; dashed/dotted baselines are historical E1 measurements. All use the chapter's frontier and interpolation rules.

### 7.2.4 Interpretation and comparison limits

The OpenAI pair supplies a row-aligned embedding-width contrast from Qdrant's DBpedia `text-embedding-3-large` corpus family [30, 31]. The supplementary check compares all 1,000 query rows and every 97th base row (10,299 rows): truncating and renormalising the 3,072-dimensional vector gives cosine at least 0.9980 against its 1,536-dimensional counterpart, with median 1.000000. GT top-10 overlap averages 9.046/10. This strongly supports matching row order in the inspected exports; original entity-ID mappings were not exported. Doubling dimension leaves the historical 0.97 CAGRA fp32 ratio at 1.747 in both datasets and changes the RaBitQ ratio from 1.130 to 1.157. The FP32 sensitivity likewise retains comparable advantages. Dimension alone therefore does not explain the observed advantage within this paired corpus/embedding contrast.

The advantage instead co-varies with refinement demand: the E1 setup's 128-probe budget anchors are 4–8 for OpenAI, 64 for Vogue and 100 for arXiv (the later full-pool rule selects 200 there). Their 0.97 RaBitQ ratios are respectively 1.130–1.157, 1.059 and 0.996. This four-dataset association agrees with the design of selective residual access; the anchors are neither equal-recall frontier parameters nor a causal isolation of primary quality. The ablations below test execution components directly.

Residual comparison limits remain after aligning the main timing boundary. JHQ is called from C++, whereas CAGRA and PQ use Python bindings; small host overhead differences remain even with reused resources. JHQ's output copy targets pageable host memory, whereas baseline outputs use pinned memory. Compilation

targets differ, and unrelated host load is not fully controlled. These effects are relevant to small margins. Five rounds characterize repeated execution of the built indexes; they do not estimate variation across independent index builds or independent machines.

## 7.3 Cartesian LUT, Packed Loads and Lane Refinement

For RQ2, the ablations separate representation-preserving table and load changes from cooperative residual scoring and measure their application effect as well as their kernel effect.

### 7.3.1 Exact table factorization and its throughput consequence

Cartesian factorization changes the evaluation of the represented primary distance, rather than training a new quantizer. Splitting an eight-bit Cartesian code into two four-bit components replaces 256 table entries with $2 \times 16 = 32$. With FP32 entries, this changes 1,024 bytes to 128 bytes per corresponding table, an eightfold reduction. The mathematical score is preserved; floating-point evaluation order can still affect the final bits. Smaller tables alone therefore do not justify calling the complete ANN output bit-identical.

Figure 7.3 compares Cartesian table grouping on six datasets, probe counts 8/32/128/512, fixed $\alpha = 100$, and $g_{\mathrm{LUT}} \in \{1, 2, 4, 8\}$. Each arm has five timing rounds; batch size is 1,000 except Stella's 999 queries. Two groups have the highest median throughput in 22 of 24 cells. The exceptions are arXiv at 128 probes, where one group is about 0.23% faster, and OpenAI-3072 at eight probes, where four groups are about 0.84% faster. These narrow differences are best treated as near ties. The newer count is 22/24, rather than the historical ADC paper's 23/24. In the specific two-group versus one-group comparison, two groups win 23/24 cells; each dataset's four-probe geometric-mean ratio exceeds one (1.021–1.318). This supports the choice across the tested workloads without treating configurations sharing an index as independent trials.

The two-group/one-group ratio ranges from 0.998 to 1.914. Four and eight groups each require only 16 total entries, but differ in the number and granularity of lookups.

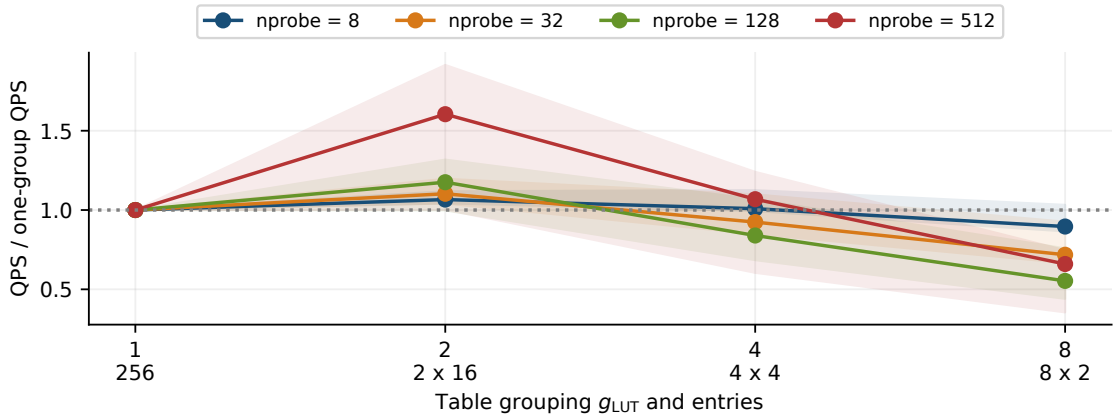



**Figure 7.3:** Cartesian table grouping at fixed $\alpha = 100$ (v71). Group counts describe $g_{\mathrm{LUT}}$, not parallel scan groups. Curves are medians of per-dataset QPS ratios to the one-group arm; shading shows their range.

Their performance provides a useful control: reducing table storage beyond the two-group design does not necessarily improve search. Additional indexing and accumulation work can outweigh storage savings. The measurements establish the net trade-off; without a separate occupancy or instruction-counter experiment, they do not identify one hardware effect as the sole cause. The maximum reported recall spread within any four-arm cell is $10^{-4}$.

### 7.3.2 Packed access and cooperative residual scoring

The historical packing experiment compares byte-oriented and word-oriented access while holding the dataset, probe count and table grouping fixed. Across six datasets, four probe counts and $g_{\mathrm{LUT}} \in \{1, 2\}$, the 48 pairs yield throughput ratios from 1.012 to 1.658, with maximum recall difference $10^{-4}$. Gains are generally smaller at eight probes and larger at 512. Both alternatives already use a subspace-major layout; this experiment supports packed access, not a claim that a physical transpose alone produced the improvement. Each arm has one reported aggregate rate, so this older evidence has weaker uncertainty information than the five-round v71 sweep.

Figure 7.4 and table 7.5 then separate wider loads from lane cooperation in residual refinement. L0 is the original scalar path; L1 changes the load path without distributing a candidate across multiple lanes; L16 assigns 16 lanes to a candidate. The same process rotates arm order across five timing rounds, with three search calls per arm per round. For the twelve ordinary configurations, L16 improves end-to-end throughput by 1.015–1.789×. An additional arXiv configuration at $\alpha = 200$,

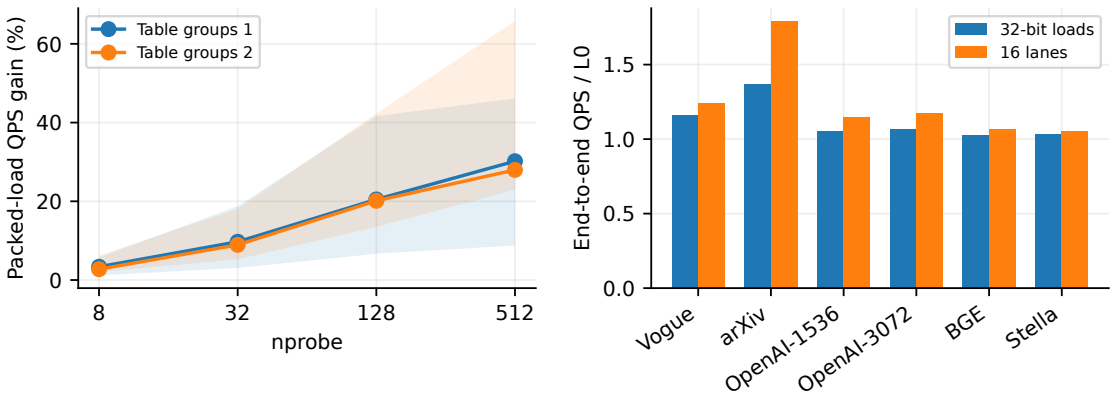



**Figure 7.4:** Packing and refinement controls. Left: median packed-load QPS gain across six datasets, with shaded minimum–maximum ranges, for each table grouping and probe count. Right: measured load-only and 16-lane end-to-end gains at 128 probes and the ordinary dataset-specific budgets. These panels come from different experiment families.

**Table 7.5:** Refinement at 128 probes. Ratios are paired end-to-end gains over L0, except the last column, which is the profiled refinement-kernel gain. The kernel and application gains must not be interchanged.

| Dataset | $\alpha$ | $L1/L0$ QPS | $L16/L0$ QPS | Kernel gain |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| arXiv | 100 | 1.368 | 1.789 | 5.97 |
| BGE | 32 | 1.026 | 1.062 | 1.97 |
| OpenAI-1536 | 8 | 1.055 | 1.145 | 3.34 |
| OpenAI-3072 | 4 | 1.063 | 1.171 | 8.81 |
| Stella | 16 | 1.030 | 1.053 | 2.66 |
| Vogue | 64 | 1.161 | 1.240 | 3.72 |

explicitly a high-budget control, reaches 2.383×; it is not the gain range of the ordinary selected budgets.

The load-only control is bit-identical to L0 in the tested cases, yet already improves arXiv throughput by 1.368×. Lane cooperation adds a larger reduction in refinement time. On arXiv at $\alpha = 100$, the profiled refinement kernel falls from 4,277.5 to 716.8 $\mu$s, a 5.97× gain, while total throughput improves 1.789×. OpenAI-3072's refinement kernel improves 8.81×, but total throughput improves 1.171×. This is consistent with Amdahl's law: acceleration of a small stage cannot remove the cost of routing, screening, final selection or transfers. It also motivates the subsequent scan and probe experiments, which target the remaining work.

A quantitative Amdahl check uses the refinement kernel's baseline time as a fraction $f$ of host-to-host baseline latency and its kernel speedup $s$, giving $1/(1 - f + f/s)$ if the remaining time is unchanged. The fractions are approximately 0.529 on arXiv and 0.168 on OpenAI-3072, producing estimates of 1.787× and 1.175×,

close to the measured 1.789× and 1.171×. These combine separate kernel-profile and wall-time measurements and are explanatory estimates.

Cooperative reductions alter floating-point addition order. The tested multi-lane variants have very small distance differences, with maximum reported relative error about $1.6 \times 10^{-6}$, and occasional changes near ranking boundaries. The evidence therefore supports numerically close scoring with measured end-to-end gains, rather than universal bitwise equivalence. Sanitizer checks cover the recorded refinement and top-$k$ kernels on small query subsets; they are useful implementation checks, not a proof for arbitrary inputs.

## 7.4 Global Top-c, Shared Bound and Probe Correctness/Ablation

This section answers the correctness part of RQ2 before examining the cost of grouped scanning, threshold sharing and radix probe selection. The earlier representation pilot in section 4.6 separately checks codebook structure, all-row corrections and sampled returned scores. Those checks complement the query-selection comparisons below; neither substitutes for original-input re-encoding or a full placement reference.

### 7.4.1 Global primary selection before performance

The grouped-scan experiment addresses a correctness requirement that cannot be evaluated through recall alone. Dividing a query's candidates among blocks must preserve the global primary top-$c$; assigning each block only $c/g_{\text{scan}}$ survivors can discard a globally competitive candidate from a disproportionately productive group. JHQ's grouped-scan path instead retains up to $c$ candidates in every group and merges the local lists. Selection uses the complete key $(D_{\text{P}}, \text{position})$, where position breaks primary-distance ties deterministically.

Lemma 5.1 and propositions 5.1 and 5.2 establish local retention and global recovery for this primary-score target. The experiment checks those outputs on the visited candidates.

The grouped-scan checker covers four workloads, batches 8/32/256/1,000 and group counts 1/2/4/8, giving 64 comparisons. It reports no non-tie primary selection differences from the original one-block path, zero change in compared primary distances, and bit-identical final top-10 identifiers and distances for every used query. The original path sorts on distance alone, so its primary cutoff can select a different

member of a tie; these differences do not violate the new complete-key specification. They also did not change final outputs in this particular experiment.

The harness uses complete batches: 992 queries at batch 32, 768 at 256 and 1,000 at 8/1,000. Recorded memcheck, racecheck and synccheck runs separately cover smaller subsets of the scan/merge kernels.

### 7.4.2 Shared bounds preserve the selection target

Keeping a full local top-$c$ is safe but potentially expensive. With the shared-bound component (v63), groups of one query publish a shared bound using the same complete key. Once any group has established $c$ keys no greater than a bound, a candidate worse than that bound cannot enter the global top-$c$. A stale, looser bound can cause extra admissions, but cannot legitimately exclude a better candidate. This requires that a published bound be backed by enough valid candidates and that atomic updates preserve the complete-key ordering; an approximate distance threshold alone would not establish the same tie behaviour.

The implementation still computes every scanned candidate's complete primary score before deciding admission. The bound reduces selection, compaction, sorting and downstream merging work; it does not prune primary distance evaluation or avoid reading every rejected primary code. This scope matters when interpreting an apparent scan-stage speedup. A faster scan stage need not mean fewer evaluated distances.

The shared-bound checks compare shared-bound groups 2/4/8 with their independent-bound counterparts across the four workloads and four batch sizes. All 48 comparisons report identical primary top-$c$ and final outputs. Five-round paired throughput measurements range from about 0.994 to 1.562× relative to independent bounds. Thus sharing substantially helps some expensive cases but is not uniformly faster. On arXiv at $\alpha = 200$, batch 1,000 and eight groups, the profiled merge cost falls from approximately 2,629 to 471 $\mu$s, while scan falls from 7,968 to 5,513 $\mu$s in the same paired profile. The result supports reducing excess intermediate work rather than claiming that more scan groups are always beneficial.

A rejected alternative was to allocate smaller static local quotas. The campaign's distribution measurements place 46–81% of the global survivors in the first candidate group for the pilot workloads. Equal quotas would frequently require a correctness fallback, and calibrated unequal quotas still leave the dominant group on the critical path. These observations motivated the exact shared bound. They are pilot

**Table 7.6:** v69/v65 end-to-end throughput ratios for the exact computed-score probe change. Each workload–batch comparison has ten timing rounds per binary, collected in alternating runs. Values above one favour v69.

| Dataset | Batch 8 | 32 | 256 | 1,000 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| arXiv | 1.074 | 1.063 | 1.035 | 1.034 |
| Vogue | 1.109 | 1.103 | 1.052 | 1.041 |
| OpenAI-3072 | 1.167 | 1.117 | 1.055 | 1.050 |

measurements of those workloads, not a theorem that every possible quota policy is inferior.

### 7.4.3 Exact probe selection and the limits of pipeline identity

Once screening becomes faster, IVF probe selection becomes a larger fraction of small-batch time. The radix probe primitive (v69) changes how the smallest computed centroid scores are selected while retaining the preceding score arithmetic. On OpenAI this includes TF32 GEMMs (section 7.2.3). Its synthetic checker covers 1,792 cases and reports zero failures. Checks of the real arXiv, Vogue and OpenAI-3072 workloads find identical probe identifiers and identical primary top-$c$ positions and distances for all 1,000 queries. These are more specific observations than a single unchanged recall number: they test the routing and screening outputs directly.

Table 7.6 shows end-to-end improvements of 1.034–1.167×. At batch 8, the profiled probe stage falls from 56.5 to 22.6 $\mu$s on arXiv, 52.7 to 14.7 $\mu$s on Vogue, and 77.8 to 16.7 $\mu$s on OpenAI-3072. Smaller full-batch gains are expected because the unmodified stages account for more of total elapsed time. These are within-family ratios; they should not be multiplied by the preceding v62 or refinement gains as if all measurements shared a single baseline.

Vogue isolates an important distinction between the probe primitive and cross-process pipeline reproducibility. The probe/primary dump is byte-identical across the two binaries for all 1,000 queries in the one-group, batch-8 test, yet final recall is 0.9642 versus 0.9644. The same baseline binary also changes from 0.9642 in the identity run to 0.9644 in each of its two timing runs. Thus the observed variation does not require the probe change; in the dump-controlled case it arises after the recorded primary-selection boundary. Residual representations, inputs and score computation remain possible sources, whose root cause is unconfirmed. Within each checked process, scheduled and one-block outputs remain bit-identical. Appendix A records the dump coverage so that it is not mistaken for every timed path.

Finally, the optional v70 FP16 experiment is a separate approximation. Its probe sets match the v69 reference on 936/1,000 arXiv queries, 979/1,000 Vogue queries and 998/1,000 OpenAI-3072 queries, with very high mean set overlap. High overlap and small recall changes do not make the primitive exact. Those results are excluded from the main E1 frontier and from the exact-probe claim.

## 7.5 Held-out Budget Quality, Throughput and Payback

The policy and its sufficient monotonicity conditions are defined in Chapter 6 and proposition 6.1. Here RQ3 concerns quality and amortized cost against credible fixed budgets. Accordingly, the comparison includes both the inherited $\alpha = 100$ and the stronger universal fixed control $\alpha = 64$.

### 7.5.1 Unlabelled selection and a labelled diagnostic oracle

The budget experiment fixes one trained index per dataset–probe cell and compares fixed budgets, sampled calibration, full-pool calibration, same-sample enumeration and an offline oracle. The six datasets are tested at 128 and 512 probes. Even-indexed queries form a calibration pool of 500; odd-indexed queries form a disjoint held-out pool of 500, except Stella, which has 499. Samples of $S \in \{32, 64, 128\}$ are drawn from the calibration pool without replacement within each draw, using a fixed random seed, with 64 draws per size. Repeated draws reuse a fixed finite query pool; they are not 64 independent samples of future workload drift.

The descending grid is $A = (200, 100, 64, 32, 16, 8, 4, 2)$. Calibration compares candidate top-10 identifier sets with the $\alpha_{\max} = 200$ reference. For sample $\mathcal{Q}_S$, the acceptance statistic is

$$D_S(\alpha) = \sum_{q \in \mathcal{Q}_S} \left(10 - |\mathcal{R}_\alpha(q) \cap \mathcal{R}_{200}(q)|\right), \qquad D_S(\alpha) \leq 1. \tag{7.1}$$

The allowance is one disagreeing result slot over the entire sample, not one per query and not a ground-truth recall tolerance. No labels are supplied to the deployed rule. The reference is itself approximate, so perfect agreement can reproduce its errors.

The offline oracle has a different role. After observing held-out recall for all eight fixed budgets, it selects the fastest measured arm within $10^{-3}$ of the best measured held-out recall. This is a diagnostic benchmark, not an implementable label-free

**Table 7.7:** Full-pool calibration ($S = 500$). Loss is relative to the best measured held-out recall; rates are kQPS from the selected fixed arm. "Cal." is one full-pool calibration call per cell, not a repeated stream timing. Held-out counts are 500, or 499 for Stella.

| Dataset | Probe | $\alpha_{\text{full}}$ | Loss | $Q_{\text{full}}$ | vs 100 | vs oracle | Cal. ms |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Vogue | 128 | 100 | 0.0000 | 202.9 | 1.000 | 0.908 | 10.1 |
| arXiv | 128 | 200 | 0.0000 | 151.5 | 0.728 | 1.000 | 10.0 |
| OpenAI-1536 | 128 | 8 | 0.0000 | 267.7 | 1.599 | 1.000 | 9.5 |
| OpenAI-3072 | 128 | 4 | 0.0000 | 145.0 | 1.691 | 1.000 | 17.1 |
| BGE | 128 | 64 | 0.0006 | 124.9 | 1.075 | 0.932 | 17.1 |
| Stella | 128 | 16 | 0.0006 | 110.4 | 1.153 | 1.000 | 20.6 |
| Vogue | 512 | 100 | 0.0002 | 100.1 | 1.000 | 0.969 | 20.9 |
| arXiv | 512 | 200 | 0.0000 | 69.0 | 0.831 | 1.000 | 25.1 |
| OpenAI-1536 | 512 | 8 | 0.0000 | 114.9 | 1.326 | 1.000 | 21.8 |
| OpenAI-3072 | 512 | 4 | 0.0002 | 52.1 | 1.219 | 0.977 | 40.5 |
| BGE | 512 | 64 | 0.0006 | 50.8 | 1.033 | 1.000 | 42.3 |
| Stella | 512 | 16 | 0.0006 | 36.0 | 1.041 | 1.000 | 60.3 |

decision. Likewise, "full pool" means applying the same calibration search to all 500 calibration queries; it does not mean enumerating every budget with held-out labels. The distinctions prevent an apparent oracle match from being mistaken for a quality guarantee.

### 7.5.2 Full-pool calibration as the quality-first working point

Full-pool calibration uses all 500 calibration queries once per cell. Its selected arms meet the held-out $10^{-3}$ loss target in 12/12 cells; the largest observed loss is 0.0006. Their rates are 0.908–1.000 of the GT oracle's, and calibration costs 9.5–60.3 ms. The geometric-mean rate ratio to fixed 100 is 1.111×, or 1.193× over the ten cells where fixed 100 also meets the target. Table 7.7 shows the complete comparison. Against fixed 64, full-pool selection is faster in six cells, equal in two and slower in four: its main advantage is the observed coverage of all twelve quality targets.

These results support full-pool calibration as a retrospective, quality-first working point for this workload family. $S = 128$ is the lower-calibration-cost alternative evaluated below. The binomial resolution discussion in section 6.2 explains the importance of query clustering; it does not turn the full-pool result into a 95% guarantee at $10^{-3}$ GT loss.

### 7.5.3 Lower-cost sampling and its quality risk

Table 7.8 reports the $S = 128$ result. The median selected budget matches the oracle budget in ten of twelve cells; it differs on arXiv at 128 probes and OpenAI-3072 at

**Table 7.8:** Held-out quality at $S = 128$. Rule $\alpha$ is the median across 64 draws; oracle $\alpha$ uses held-out labels. $\overline{R}_{\text{rule}}$ is reconstructed mean recall. "Losses" counts draws with recall loss $> 10^{-3}$ relative to the best tested held-out recall; $L_{95}$ is the logged lower-order 95th-percentile loss estimate. $R_{100}$ is fixed-budget recall.

| Dataset | Probe | $\alpha$: rule/oracle | $R_{100}$ | $\overline{R}_{\text{rule}}$ | Losses | $L_{95}$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Vogue | 128 | 64 / 64 | 0.9680 | 0.9677 | 5/64 | 0.0022 |
| arXiv | 128 | 100 / 200 | 0.9748 | 0.9751 | 40/64 | 0.0024 |
| OpenAI-1536 | 128 | 8 / 8 | 0.9280 | 0.9279 | 4/64 | 0.0000 |
| OpenAI-3072 | 128 | 4 / 4 | 0.9252 | 0.9252 | 0/64 | 0.0000 |
| BGE | 128 | 32 / 32 | 0.9198 | 0.9190 | 1/64 | 0.0008 |
| Stella | 128 | 16 / 16 | 0.9892 | 0.9884 | 6/64 | 0.0030 |
| Vogue | 512 | 64 / 64 | 0.9916 | 0.9915 | 2/64 | 0.0002 |
| arXiv | 512 | 200 / 200 | 0.9878 | 0.9885 | 32/64 | 0.0016 |
| OpenAI-1536 | 512 | 8 / 8 | 0.9740 | 0.9738 | 4/64 | 0.0000 |
| OpenAI-3072 | 512 | 4 / 8 | 0.9704 | 0.9702 | 0/64 | 0.0002 |
| BGE | 512 | 64 / 64 | 0.9670 | 0.9661 | 24/64 | 0.0014 |
| Stella | 512 | 16 / 16 | 0.9954 | 0.9945 | 7/64 | 0.0030 |

512. The selected budgets span 4–200, indicating substantial workload dependence. However, a median budget and a mean recall describe different aspects of the draw population. They need not correspond to the performance of one arm. In addition, mean recall in the table is reconstructed from the printed best recall minus printed mean loss, so its four-decimal precision is approximate.

The important counterexample is arXiv. At 128 probes, 40/64 draws lose more than $10^{-3}$ recall even though mean loss is only 0.0009; at 512 probes, 32/64 draws cross the threshold. BGE at 512 probes has 24/64 threshold crossings and a 95th-percentile loss of 0.0014. Stella has fewer crossings but a 95th-percentile loss of 0.0030 at both probe depths. Thus mean quality, violation frequency and tail magnitude must be read together. OpenAI-3072 has no observed threshold crossings in these draws, which supports a favourable result on this pool, not a zero-risk statement about unseen queries.

The percentile convention also matters for this small sample of draws. The harness reports the sorted loss at zero-based index $\lfloor 0.95(64-1) \rfloor = 59$, rather than interpolating between order statistics. Consequently, four nonzero tail losses can coexist with a printed $L_{95} = 0$, as on OpenAI-1536. The table preserves this logged statistic and the exact crossing count; zero in that column does not mean every draw has zero loss.

Figure 7.5 shows the effect of sample size. A larger sample usually makes selection more conservative, but also tightens the normalized allowance $1/(10S)$. Same-sample

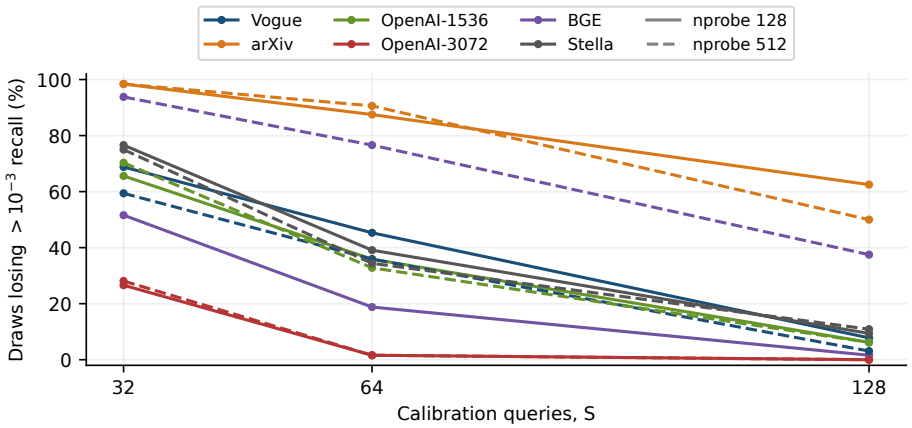



**Figure 7.5:** Held-out risk across sample sizes. The vertical axis is the percentage of calibration draws losing more than $10^{-3}$ held-out recall relative to the best tested budget. Increasing $S$ also tightens the allowed slot-disagreement fraction because equation (7.1) keeps threshold one.

enumeration agrees with bisection in all 2,304 draws ($12 \times 3 \times 64$), while taking 1.75–2.01 times as long in the printed logs.

The measured default performs exact primary top-$c$ and final selection over all retained scores; the lossy `K_LOCAL=4` path is opt-in via `JHQ_EXACT_TOPCK=0`. Corollary 6.2 establishes monotone reference agreement for the common-key grouped configuration, covering 2,176 of the 2,304 draws. The remaining 128 OpenAI-3072 draws at $S = 128$ use distance-only cutoff ties and still agree with enumeration empirically. Calibration-to-evaluation path changes in eight cells concern budget transfer, separately from within-draw search correctness.

A fixed budget is also imperfect. Table 7.9 evaluates all eight fixed choices against the diagnostic quality target. Fixed $\alpha = 100$ qualifies in ten of twelve cells; $\alpha = 200$ qualifies in all twelve but can sacrifice substantial throughput. Full-pool calibration is not identical to the oracle either: on Vogue it selects 100 at both probe depths while the oracle selects 64. Agreement-based selection and fastest quality-constrained selection solve different problems, even with a larger calibration sample. Full-pool calibration costs 9.5–60.3 ms. In these twelve cells $\alpha = 200$ attains the best measured recall and therefore serves as a high-budget coverage control; its 12/12 qualification is not an independent quality guarantee. The short fixed-arm timings have apparent small-budget inversions. Supplementary alternating repetitions resolve the cited OpenAI inversion as timing variation and establish a low-budget plateau (section 7.5.5). A minimum accepted budget remains a quality decision, rather than a guarantee of the fastest measured arm.

**Table 7.9:** Fixed-budget controls over twelve held-out cells. Qualifying means within $10^{-3}$ of the best tested recall at printed precision. Worst recall loss uses all cells; QPS deficit uses only cells where that arm qualifies. A dash means no qualifying cells.

| $\alpha$ | Qualifying cells | Worst recall loss | Max qualifying QPS deficit |
|---|---|---|---|
| 2 | 0/12 | 0.3100 | – |
| 4 | 2/12 | 0.1774 | 2.3% |
| 8 | 4/12 | 0.0930 | 2.1% |
| 16 | 6/12 | 0.0408 | 4.4% |
| 32 | 7/12 | 0.0170 | 9.1% |
| 64 | 10/12 | 0.0050 | 26.6% |
| 100 | 10/12 | 0.0016 | 40.9% |
| 200 | 12/12 | 0.0000 | 57.1% |

### 7.5.4 Estimated throughput and calibration economics

Unlike E1, this family times each fixed arm with a warm-up and three search calls. The rule's reported QPS is then the arithmetic mean of the already measured QPS values of its 64 selected arms. It is not a new timing of a service repeatedly calibrating and executing the policy. At $S = 128$, this selected-arm estimate improves over fixed $\alpha = 100$ in ten cells, by 1.028–1.691×. On arXiv the ratios are 0.908 and 0.917: mean recall improves, but throughput falls. Those cells have no throughput payback.

The stronger $\alpha = 64$ comparison reduces the aggregate gain: mean selected-arm QPS wins in 9/12 cells, with geometric-mean ratio 1.054× and range 0.821–1.367×. It is nearly unchanged on Vogue and improves only 0.6% on BGE at 512 probes; OpenAI gains range from 1.052 to 1.367×. Both fixed 64 and fixed 100 qualify in 10/12 cells, failing the two arXiv cells. The useful property of calibration is matching heterogeneous refinement demands, rather than uniformly beating an already sensible fixed budget.

ArXiv's threshold crossings are relative to the best tested held-out recall, not relative to the default configuration. Fixed 100 already loses 0.0012 and 0.0016 recall at probes 128 and 512, while the sampled mean loss is 0.0009 in both cells. Mean quality therefore improves over the default despite some draws exceeding the oracle-relative target.

Calibration costs 3.9–21.3 ms in these logs. This includes reference search and agreement checks, with any included search setup inside the measured calls, but excludes gathering sample vectors into the input buffer. For an equal-sized subsequent batch, define

$$B^* = \frac{T_{\text{cal}}}{T_{100} - T_{\text{rule}}}, \qquad T_{\text{rule}} < T_{100}. \tag{7.2}$$

**Table 7.10:** Calibration economics, $S = 128$. Rates are kQPS and rule rate is mean selected-arm QPS. Ratios compare with fixed 100 and fixed 64. The "Batches" column gives payback relative to fixed 100 using 500 queries, or 499 for Stella; "Never" denotes no throughput payback. The quality column separately marks whether fixed 100 meets the held-out loss target.

| Dataset | Probe | $Q_{100}$ | $\overline{Q}_{\text{rule}}$ | vs 100 | vs 64 | Cal. ms | Batches | Fixed 100 quality |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Vogue | 128 | 202.9 | 224.4 | 1.106 | 1.004 | 4.0 | 17.0 | Pass |
| arXiv | 128 | 207.9 | 188.8 | 0.908 | 0.821 | 4.2 | Never | Fail |
| OpenAI-1536 | 128 | 167.5 | 268.5 | 1.603 | 1.367 | 3.9 | 3.5 | Pass |
| OpenAI-3072 | 128 | 85.7 | 145.0 | 1.691 | 1.230 | 5.7 | 2.4 | Pass |
| BGE | 128 | 116.2 | 131.2 | 1.130 | 1.051 | 6.5 | 13.2 | Pass |
| Stella | 128 | 95.7 | 110.3 | 1.153 | 1.087 | 7.5 | 10.8 | Pass |
| Vogue | 512 | 100.1 | 102.9 | 1.028 | 0.996 | 7.5 | 55.4 | Pass |
| arXiv | 512 | 83.1 | 76.2 | 0.917 | 0.870 | 9.7 | Never | Fail |
| OpenAI-1536 | 512 | 86.6 | 115.0 | 1.327 | 1.268 | 8.8 | 6.2 | Pass |
| OpenAI-3072 | 512 | 42.8 | 52.1 | 1.219 | 1.052 | 13.1 | 6.2 | Pass |
| BGE | 512 | 49.2 | 51.1 | 1.039 | 1.006 | 15.8 | 41.2 | Pass |
| Stella | 512 | 34.6 | 36.0 | 1.041 | 1.028 | 21.3 | 37.1 | Pass |

Using $T_{\text{rule}} \approx n/\overline{Q}_{\text{rule}}$ gives the estimates in table 7.10: 2.4–55.4 subsequent held-out-sized batches against fixed 100 in favourable cells. Against fixed 64, the corresponding range is 5.7–404.3 batches in nine favourable cells; Vogue at 512 probes has no throughput payback. The two arXiv controls also miss the quality target, so their timing comparisons are diagnostics rather than comparisons at matched quality. At the control rates, the largest positive $S = 128$ break-even estimates correspond to 0.54 s versus fixed 100 and 2.72 s versus fixed 64 (about 27.7K and 202.2K queries). Full-pool positive cases reach at most 1.52/2.25 s and 64.9K/78.7K queries against those controls, using their own calibration costs. The short modelled horizons favour reuse on long stable jobs; Figure 7.6 retains the actual held-out counts.

The calculation is optimistic. In general, $1/\mathbb{E}[Q] \leq \mathbb{E}[1/Q]$, so inverting mean QPS understates mean execution time when calibration draws choose arms with different rates. Sample gathering, future query drift and recalibration overhead would further affect amortization. A policy reused for a long stationary workload can benefit; a short job or a changing query population may not. The present experiment measures neither drift detection nor a production recalibration schedule.

For historical comparison, the earlier scalar-refinement implementation (v57) reported 1.054–2.773× gains over fixed 100 in 10/12 cells and 5.2–30.8 ms calibration. The newer lane-refined pipeline's smaller gains are consistent with less removable refinement time. The runs share the budget protocol and grid, but this cross-campaign comparison does not isolate refinement as the sole cause of the change.

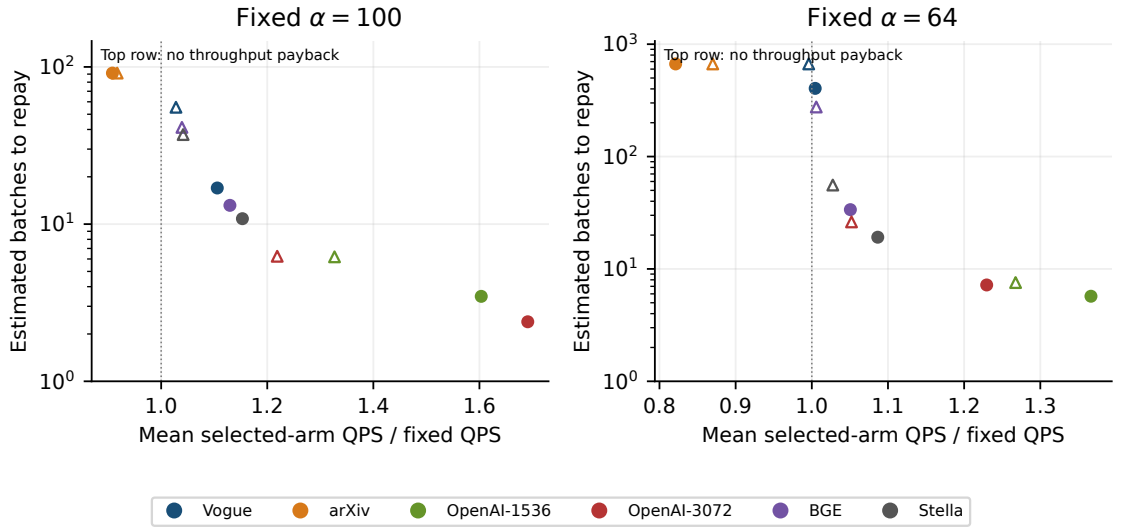



**Figure 7.6:** Estimated calibration payback relative to fixed budgets 100 and 64. Filled circles denote 128 probes and open triangles 512 probes. Top-row points have no throughput payback. Estimates invert mean selected-arm QPS and use 500 queries, or 499 for Stella.

### 7.5.5 Complete decision traces and finite-pool risk

The supplementary harness preserves the original grid, trained state, query split and seeded draws, adding complete records. All twelve fixed-arm recalls reproduce at the archived precision; full-pool choices, sampled median choices and crossing counts reproduce. Timing changes the GT oracle's fastest arm in two near-tied cells, illustrating that this diagnostic also depends on measured speed.

All 2,304 sampled disagreement curves are monotone and their selected budgets match enumeration. The twelve full-pool curves also pass both checks. Moreover, summing full-pool per-query counts over each recorded sample's actual IDs reproduces all 18,432 grid counts. This is stronger than checking the selected budget alone, and supports using equation (6.9) for these observations despite the scan-path changes. It checks aggregate counts on the traced subsets, rather than per-query invariance on every possible subset. Table 7.11 reports the observed tail sizes.

**Table 7.11:** Maximum held-out recall loss over the 64 draws at each sample size, relative to the best tested arm. All twelve FULL selections match enumeration. Maxima complement the earlier means, p95 and crossing rates.

| Dataset | Probes | FULL $\alpha$ | Max $L_{32}$ | Max $L_{64}$ | Max $L_{128}$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Vogue | 128 | 100 | 0.0104 | 0.0104 | 0.0022 |
| arXiv | 128 | 200 | 0.0134 | 0.0024 | 0.0024 |
| OpenAI-1536 | 128 | 8 | 0.0018 | 0.0018 | 0.0018 |
| OpenAI-3072 | 128 | 4 | 0.0046 | 0.0046 | 0.0000 |
| BGE | 128 | 64 | 0.0100 | 0.0038 | 0.0038 |
| Stella | 128 | 16 | 0.0174 | 0.0030 | 0.0030 |
| Vogue | 512 | 100 | 0.0112 | 0.0030 | 0.0030 |
| arXiv | 512 | 200 | 0.0170 | 0.0050 | 0.0050 |
| OpenAI-1536 | 512 | 8 | 0.0272 | 0.0026 | 0.0026 |
| OpenAI-3072 | 512 | 4 | 0.0072 | 0.0072 | 0.0002 |
| BGE | 512 | 64 | 0.0294 | 0.0046 | 0.0046 |
| Stella | 512 | 16 | 0.0182 | 0.0030 | 0.0030 |

At $S = 128$, maxima reach 0.0050 for arXiv/512 and 0.0046 for BGE/512; at $S = 32$ the largest is 0.0294. A low mean loss therefore coexists with occasional materially worse chosen budgets. FULL's maximum across the twelve cells remains 0.0006.

For arXiv/128, the finite-pool model predicts crossing probabilities 0.965, 0.875 and 0.620 at $S = 32, 64, 128$, against 0.984, 0.875 and 0.625 observed (figure 7.7). Acceptance uses only reference outputs; translating its selection probabilities into GT-loss crossings uses the fixed-arm held-out quality map. The calculation is therefore an offline risk explanation, not a label-free GT guarantee. Across the 36 comparisons, the largest absolute gap is 0.144 for BGE/512 at $S = 128$ (0.519 predicted, 0.375 observed). The fixed-pool calculation isolates sampling risk without fitting a population model to held-out recall gaps.

Ten alternating remeasurements also remove the apparent small-budget speed inversion. OpenAI-3072/128 gives 142.3/142.7 kQPS at $\alpha = 4/2$, versus 145.0/128.7 in the original short timing. BGE/128 and Vogue/512 likewise approach a plateau. This supports treating the archived inversions as timing variation; it does not imply monotone runtime for all budgets or resource thresholds.

### 7.5.6 Direct calibration-plus-reuse measurement

Four cells directly execute fixed 64, fixed 100, sampled $S = 128$ and FULL policies, rotating policy order over five rounds. Each calibrated round gathers its sample,

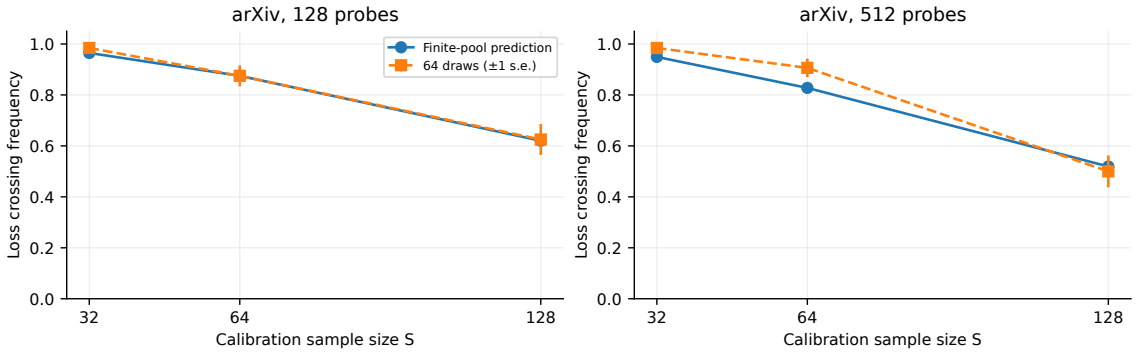



**Figure 7.7:** Finite-pool prediction and observed arXiv loss crossings. Bars show one estimated standard error over 64 independently drawn subsets conditional on the fixed pool, not uncertainty over future workloads.

calibrates once, explicitly installs the chosen multiplier, then times 500 consecutive held-out batches. The first batch includes any graph recapture. The same held-out pool is replayed, rather than sampling new traffic. Index construction, prior warm-up and the separately timed schedule calibration are outside this boundary. Table 7.12 reports the cumulative measurements.

**Table 7.12:** Direct total milliseconds for 500 reuse batches, averaged over five rounds, including budget calibration for sampled and FULL policies. Each batch has 500 queries. Quality is discussed with the timing results.

| Dataset/probes | Fixed 100 | Fixed 64 | Rule $S = 128$ | FULL |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| arXiv/128 | 1224 | 1102 | 1291 | 1680 |
| OpenAI-1536/128 | 1491 | 1264 | 852 | 860 |
| OpenAI-3072/128 | 2757 | 2160 | 1769 | 1783 |
| BGE/512 | 5185 | 5018 | 4921 | 5062 |

On OpenAI-3072/128, the sampled policy selects 4 in every round and reduces total time from 2,757 to 1,769 ms against fixed 100, about 36%, at the same measured recall 0.9252. FULL selects the same budget and takes 1,783 ms including its larger calibration cost. On OpenAI-1536/128, FULL takes 860 versus 1,491 ms at the same recall 0.9280; the sampled policy averages 852 ms and 0.9276 recall.

The steady-rate fit to the sampled stream gives break-even counts of 3.6/5.5 batches against fixed 100/64 on OpenAI-1536, and 3.5/8.9 on OpenAI-3072. These fractional values fit directly timed calibration and steady batches; they are not directly observed fractional crossings. Figure 7.8 instead plots measured cumulative totals, including first-batch setup. The first positive mean cumulative savings occur at 4/6 batches on OpenAI-1536 and 4/9 on OpenAI-3072 against fixed 100/64. BGE/512 has a smaller sampled saving, 4,921 versus 5,185 ms against fixed 100,

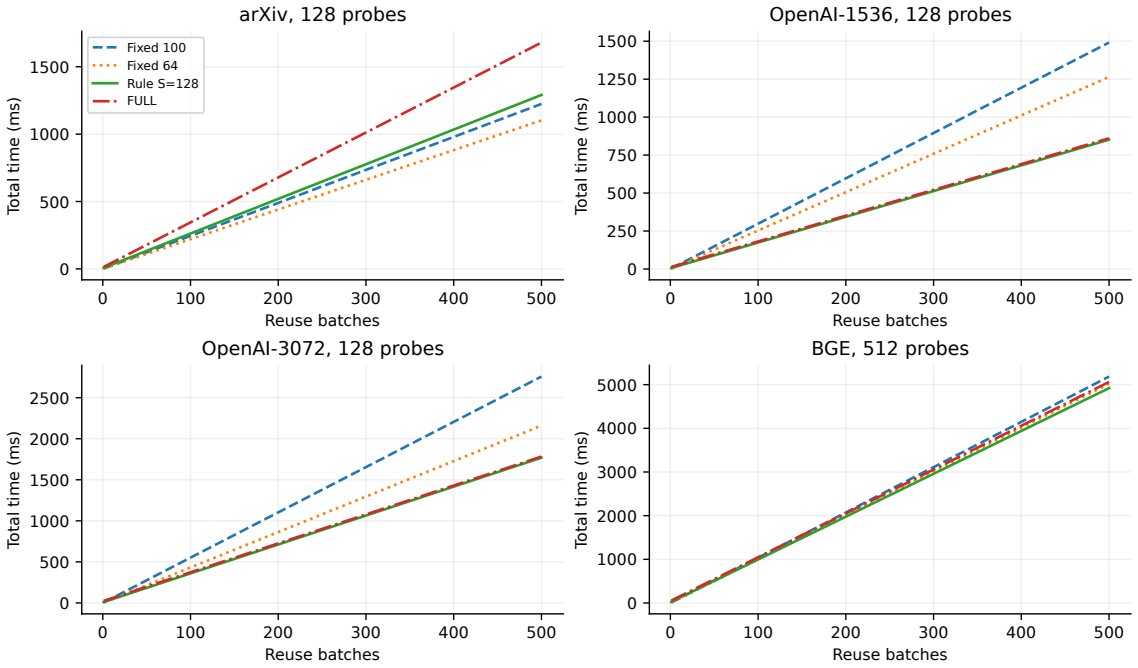



**Figure 7.8:** Direct mean cumulative time, including budget calibration and first-batch setup. Each curve replays one fixed held-out query pool. Policies can have different recall; timings alone are not a quality-matched ranking. Dataset/probe settings match table 7.12.

but mean recall 0.9658 versus 0.9670; its FULL policy restores 0.9664 at 5,062 ms. ArXiv's FULL policy selects 200 for higher quality and is slower than fixed 100/64, both of which miss the quality target. Thus timing and quality jointly determine whether calibration is worthwhile. The measurements support reuse economics without requiring the old fitted payback values to match exactly in every cell.

## 7.6 Batch Regimes, G Scheduling and Workload Skew

This section answers the performance-regime part of RQ2: when additional scan groups supply useful parallelism, and when their extra work dominates.

### 7.6.1 Parallelism versus repeated selection work

The scan experiments reveal two execution regimes. With one block per query, batch 8 exposes only eight blocks on a 170-SM device. Candidate partitioning increases the available block parallelism. In the independent-bound grouped-scan experiment, eight groups improve end-to-end throughput by 2.06–2.76× at batch 8. Profiling

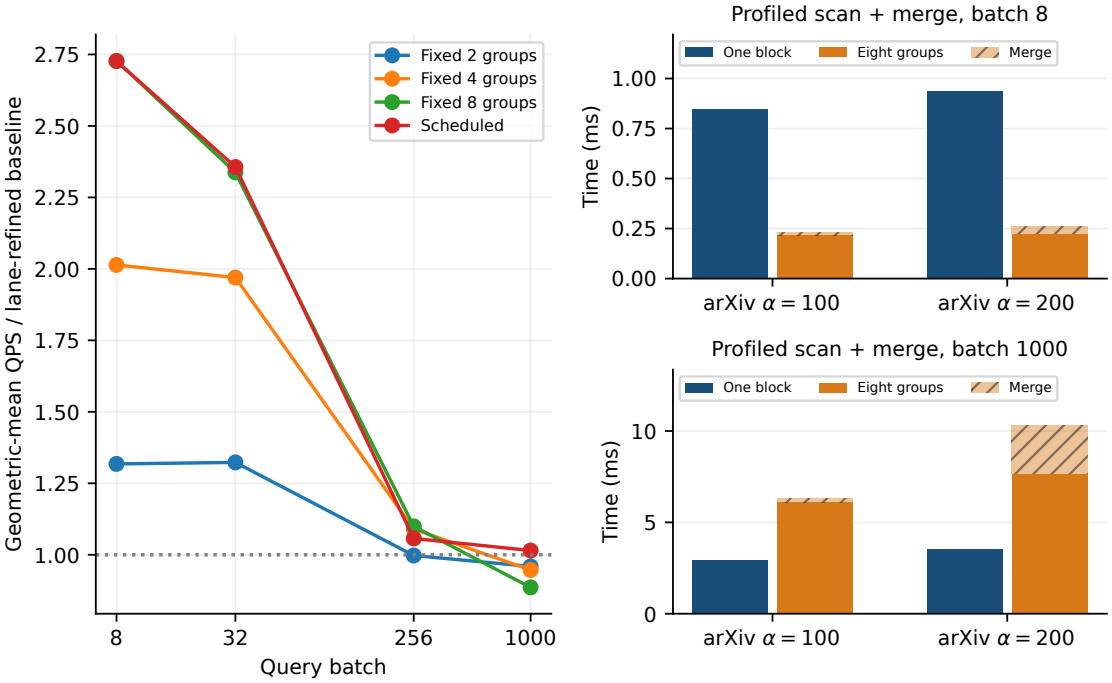



**Figure 7.9:** Execution regimes. Left: fixed shared-bound group counts and scheduled execution relative to the lane-refined one-block baseline (13 cells at small batches, 11 at batch 1,000). Right: paired scan and merge profiles at batches 8 and 1,000 for arXiv budgets 100 and 200. Hatching denotes merge time. The right panels use the independent-bound scan experiment; they explain a cost, not the scheduler's entire speedup.

supports a stage-level explanation: arXiv's scan falls from about 849 to 216 $\mu$s, Vogue's from 1,059 to 246 $\mu$s, and OpenAI-3072's from 728 to 155 $\mu$s. The additional merges cost approximately 16.7, 9.1 and 3.7 $\mu$s, respectively. The net reduction is large even after paying for merging.

At batch 1,000 there are already enough independent queries to expose many blocks. Additional groups repeat table staging, local-buffer admission and sorting, and produce extra merge traffic. The independent-bound grouped path can fall to about 0.46× its one-block baseline on arXiv at $\alpha = 200$. The full-batch profiles show scan increasing from 2,922 to 6,079 $\mu$s at $\alpha = 100$ and from 3,530 to 7,652 $\mu$s at $\alpha = 200$, with an additional 2,624 $\mu$s merge in the latter case. This opposing result is central to the design: parallel decomposition solves insufficient concurrency, but incurs work that can dominate once concurrency is adequate. Shared bounds reduce that extra work but do not eliminate the regime change.

**Table 7.13:** Integrated execution gains over v61 L16. Entries are geometric means of per-cell median paired speedups from five rounds. "Held out" excludes the four configurations used to set the rule; it means held-out configurations, not the budget experiment's held-out query split.

| Batch | Cells | $g_s = 2$ | $g_s = 4$ | $g_s = 8$ | Scheduled | Held out |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 8 | 13 | 1.318 | 2.014 | 2.728 | 2.727 | 2.930 |
| 32 | 13 | 1.323 | 1.970 | 2.337 | 2.356 | 2.560 |
| 256 | 13 | 0.997 | 1.090 | 1.099 | 1.057 | 1.041 |
| 1000 | 11 | 0.959 | 0.947 | 0.886 | 1.015 | 1.012 |

### 7.6.2 A fixed rule evaluated on further configurations

The integrated batch scheduler (v65) chooses a scan-group count using batch size, block size and a workload-skew estimate. Its fill rule relates the potential resident threads to a fixed 0.6 fraction of the device's thread capacity. Its skew rule requires at least four groups when the coefficient of variation of candidates per query is at least 0.3. The larger suggested group count is used, with the one-group case mapped to the original one-block scan. The skew statistic is estimated once from 512 database vectors used as pseudoqueries, not from ground-truth labels or the evaluated query pool. The constants were chosen on four workload configurations before the additional configurations were measured.

Table 7.13 recomputes the results from the raw timing arrays. The scheduled geometric-mean gains are 2.727×, 2.356×, 1.057× and 1.015× at batches 8, 32, 256 and 1,000. There are thirteen configurations at the first three batch sizes, including an additional high-budget arXiv case, but only eleven at batch 1,000: Stella's 999-query pool cannot provide a complete 1,000-query batch. The held-out subsets contain nine and seven configurations, respectively. A plot connecting these means summarizes regimes rather than a perfectly balanced repeated-measures population.

Fixed eight-group execution matches the scheduled mean closely at batch 8 but falls to 0.886× at batch 1,000. Scheduling largely retains the small-batch gain while avoiding that full-batch loss. It is nevertheless a heuristic, not an oracle. At batch 256 its worst ratio of best fixed throughput to scheduled throughput is 1.217, on a BGE configuration. Candidate-count CV does not capture every cost of list traversal, selection or merging. This failure identifies a limitation of the chosen feature rather than evidence that execution scheduling is unnecessary.

Vogue illustrates both the value and limits of the skew feature. Its E1 candidate-count CV ranges from 0.338 to 0.622 as probes change, forcing four groups at batch

1,000. The integrated path/one-block ratio ranges from 0.895 to 1.175. It loses at $(n_{\text{probe}}, \alpha) = (16, 16)$, $(16, 64)$ and $(32, 64)$, with ratios 0.955, 0.895 and 0.955. Candidate-count dispersion alone does not encode absolute per-query work; the rule can add overhead to these low-probe cases while enabling Vogue's 0.97 cross-system lead in table 7.3. This complements the BGE batch-256 regret: balancing work and paying for decomposition are distinct scheduling decisions.

Finally, correctness is checked independently of timing. Across 250 variant/configuration comparisons and 234,320 query comparisons, the integrated campaign reports no non-tie primary-selection differences and no different final identifier sets. Final order can differ at ties; the entire campaign should not be described as universally bit-identical. The throughput results concern sequential, synchronous submissions and do not establish tail latency under an open-loop arrival process.

## 7.7 Cold Construction, Resident Memory and Tested Scale

RQ1 is assessed through cold construction, resident memory and completed large-dataset searches; the E1 memory comparison also informs RQ4.

### 7.7.1 Cold builds and the lifecycle boundary

The principal search sweeps reuse trained-state caches. Loading that state and adding vectors is not a cold build. Separate logs explicitly train with an empty trained-state cache and then encode/add the database; table 7.14 reports their recorded training and add times. The supplementary repetitions use the same empty-cache construction boundary; table 7.14 now reports the medians of three normal runs per dataset. Table 7.15 preserves their range, the broader startup interval and the sampled device peak. Vogue's training is 298–303 ms, so its normal total is about 0.56 s; the archived 1.33 s total is an unusually slow single observation. Stella's normal totals are 10.54–10.65 s, close to the historical 10.40 s record.

The train/add timers start after index-object construction and sample preparation. Host QR construction of the rotation and constructor cuBLAS warm-up are therefore outside these totals. Cold here refers to learned index state. The input loader can reuse memory-mapped FP32 data, and the reported train-plus-add interval does not include reading the original exported files from storage. The scheduler's pseudoquery

**Table 7.14:** Cold JHQ construction and separately measured resident memory. Train/add are component medians of three supplementary normal builds; Total is the median paired sum. Memory comes from v71's two-group, 128-probe, $\alpha = 100$ runs and includes context and workspace. "Residual" is the modelled residual-code share of the measured used total, not the fraction read per query.

| Dataset | Train s | Add s | Total s | Used GiB | Raw GiB | Residual |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Vogue | 0.30 | 0.26 | 0.56 | 1.47 | 2.67 | 45.4% |
| arXiv | 0.48 | 0.51 | 0.99 | 2.58 | 6.45 | 62.5% |
| OpenAI-1536 | 0.61 | 0.38 | 1.00 | 2.39 | 5.72 | 59.7% |
| OpenAI-3072 | 1.16 | 0.67 | 1.82 | 4.14 | 11.43 | 69.0% |
| BGE | 3.56 | 3.65 | 7.20 | 11.93 | 38.50 | 80.7% |
| Stella | 3.55 | 6.99 | 10.55 | 20.44 | 67.81 | 82.9% |

calibration is performed after add and is outside that total. A deployment lifecycle would also account for data preparation, transfer where excluded by a given API, calibration, serialization and subsequent query time. The recorded totals are useful construction measurements within their boundary, not a complete end-to-end ingestion service cost.

The comparison figure reports alternative construction configurations alongside these cold builds. Its method-specific ranges are not confidence intervals over equivalent repeated builds. Training samples, index parameters and representations differ. JHQ now uses three normal independent cold builds, with input pages warm; other methods retain their historical configuration ranges. For RaBitQ, the recorded build function is separated from serialization/deserialization, although the benchmark requires that round trip before search. Omitting that extra step is appropriate only when clearly labelling the bar as build-function time; it does not measure time until the first usable search.

On Stella, successful isolated CAGRA int8 builds take approximately 74.55 and 82.45 s including dataset quantization, depending on graph degree; the measured IVF-PQ build median is 86.59 s across its three configurations. JHQ's 10.54–10.65 s repeated interval is substantially shorter under the reported boundaries, but does not establish a universally fastest builder or equal downstream recall. Construction speed, searchable quality and resident cost are separate deployment dimensions.

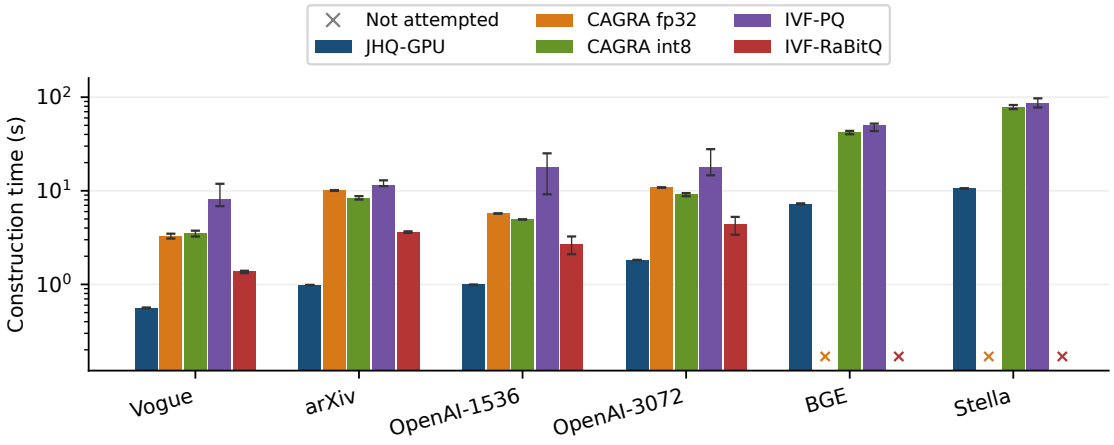



**Figure 7.10:** Recorded construction costs, with CAGRA int8 included. JHQ is the median and range of three supplementary normal cold builds with warm input pages; other bars are medians across successful measured index configurations, with minimum–maximum whiskers. Int8 includes dataset quantization; RaBitQ excludes the required serialization round trip. Missing large-dataset bars denote unattempted configurations, not measured build failures. The vertical axis is logarithmic.

**Table 7.15:** Supplementary empty-cache construction. Train+add and Start give ranges over three normal warm-input runs; First read is this session's first-read startup observation. Start ends at add completion, before schedule calibration/search. Peak is the maximum 20 ms device sample over the normal runs, including context. Recall spans five independent builds at fixed 128-probe operating points, including the phase diagnostic.

| Dataset | Train+add (s) | Start (s) | First read (s) | Peak (GiB) | Recall range |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Vogue | 0.558–0.566 | 2.0–2.1 | 4.9 | 4.11 | 0.9636–0.9644 |
| arXiv | 0.984–0.987 | 3.1–3.2 | 9.1 | 7.83 | 0.9757–0.9769 |
| OpenAI-1536 | 0.986–0.996 | 4.1–4.3 | 10.0 | 7.66 | 0.9313–0.9317 |
| OpenAI-3072 | 1.809–1.830 | 7.1–7.2 | 17.0 | 11.39 | 0.9266–0.9268 |
| BGE | 7.172–7.341 | 13.6–15.9 | 51.4 | 26.08 | 0.9174–0.9178 |
| Stella | 10.543–10.653 | 18.2–18.6 | 129.9 | 22.58 | 0.9887–0.9890 |

The broader startup boundary is material: Stella takes 18.2–18.6 s with warm input pages and 129.9 s on its session-first read. The phase diagnostic synchronises stages and changes the pipeline to one buffer, so its timing is excluded from normal-build ranges. Twenty-millisecond device samples observe 26.08 GiB for BGE near add entry and 22.58 GiB for Stella during repack. BGE's three assignment-product buffers total 12 GiB; they belong to the early pipeline lifetime, not to the later 23.05 GiB gather payload (equation (4.12)). These results show why resident memory alone understates construction capacity.

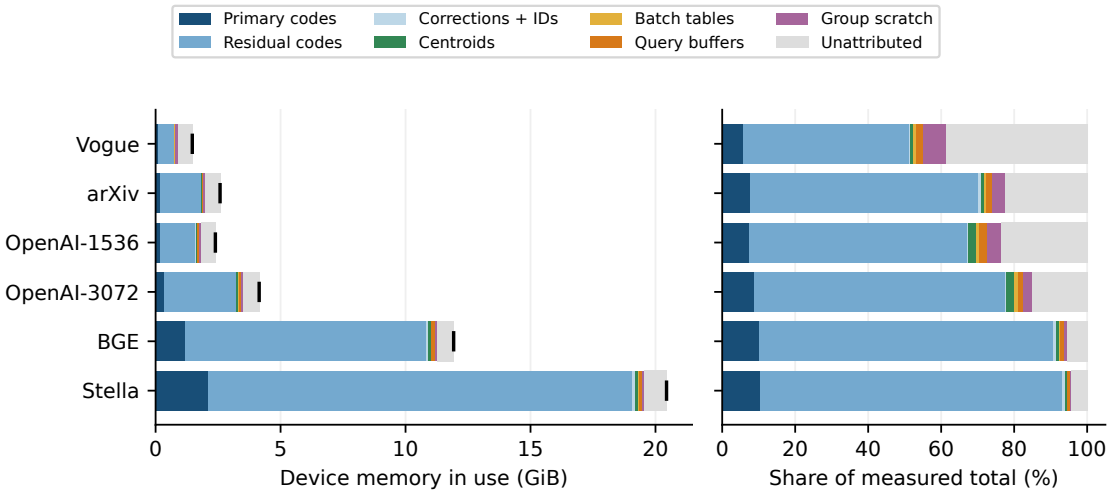



**Figure 7.11:** Resident-memory decomposition at two-group tables, 128 probes and $\alpha = 100$. Component sizes are modelled, markers are measured used totals, and hatching is the unattributed remainder. The totals include context and workspace. Separate construction samples are in table 7.15; these resident markers are not peaks.

### 7.7.2 Resident allocation and where compression helps

Figure 7.11 decomposes resident memory. Its markers are device memory in use at the recorded measurement, not index-only allocations. The stacked components model primary and residual codes, correction factors and identifiers, centroids, per-batch tables, candidate buffers and list-group scratch. The remaining measured allocation stays explicitly unattributed; it may include runtime context, allocator effects and allocations omitted by the model. Assigning that remainder to residual codes would overstate the representation cost.

Residual codes dominate the large datasets: approximately 80.7% of BGE's 11.93 GiB and 82.9% of Stella's 20.44 GiB used totals. The corresponding raw FP32 vector arrays alone would require 38.50 and 67.81 GiB. JHQ therefore enables the tested resident search on one card by retaining a compressed hierarchy. Lowering $\alpha$ reduces residual codes accessed and scored per query, but leaves the stored residual array allocated. Similarly, Cartesian LUT factorization reduces query-specific table storage, not the database's residual-code precision.

Workspace also matters. The reported list-group scratch is approximately 93.8 MiB in these $\alpha = 100$ measurements, reserved for a batch capacity of 1,024 and up to eight groups even when the selected execution uses the one-block path. A smaller actual group count therefore does not imply that the allocation shrank proportionally. Conversely, these resident samples do not capture temporary con-

**Table 7.16:** E1 allocation ranges. JHQ is process total minus a 507.2 MiB context estimate, including query workspace; both CAGRA columns are index allocations measured during build. Ranges cover the parameter sweep.

| Dataset | JHQ net process GiB | CAGRA fp32 index GiB | CAGRA int8 index GiB |
|---|---|---|---|
| Vogue | 0.90–1.01 | 2.89–2.91 | 0.89–0.91 |
| arXiv | 2.01–2.19 | 6.84–6.98 | 2.01–2.15 |
| OpenAI-1536 | 1.79–2.33 | 5.95–5.97 | 1.67–1.68 |
| OpenAI-3072 | 3.54–3.82 | 11.67–11.68 | 3.10–3.11 |

struction peaks. The baseline harness also initializes some search memory pools after its index-memory measurement, so an after-build index delta cannot be used as a complete peak process-memory budget across methods.

The E1 measurements provide a separate cross-system view in table 7.16. Subtracting the baseline-measured 507.2 MiB context from JHQ's process total gives approximately 0.29–0.39 of CAGRA fp32's index allocation. JHQ's figure includes workspace, whereas CAGRA's is the build-time index delta. These are parameter-sweep ranges, not memory-matched recall points or a comparison of equal peak budgets. The CAGRA int8 allocations in the same table are of a similar order to JHQ's: compression relative to fp32 is shared by competing designs. The component model in table 4.2 explains this comparison.

### 7.7.3 Large-dataset feasibility and competitive regions

BGE contains 10,091,524 vectors and Stella 17,776,615, both with 1,024 dimensions and 32,768 IVF lists. Stella's queries are sampled from the corpus; its result therefore characterizes that benchmark rather than an independently collected external-query distribution. Figure 7.12 includes successful CAGRA int8 and IVF-PQ measurements. Full-precision CAGRA, RaBitQ configurations and FP32 brute force were not attempted in the large-scale comparison when their computed storage requirements exceeded the available device capacity. Those omissions are planned feasibility exclusions, not observed out-of-memory errors or measured recall failures.

Successful isolated reruns show that CAGRA int8 fits Stella in the tested configurations. On BGE, int8 is approximately 1.35–2.96× faster at the sampled common targets 0.88/0.90/0.92/0.94/0.95. At its measured maximum recall 0.9579, JHQ's interpolated QPS is 1.086× int8's. Thus the advantage changes direction near the high-recall end. The maximum tested recalls are 0.9579/0.9783 for int8, 0.9663/0.9952 for JHQ and 0.9525/0.9896 for PQ on BGE/Stella.

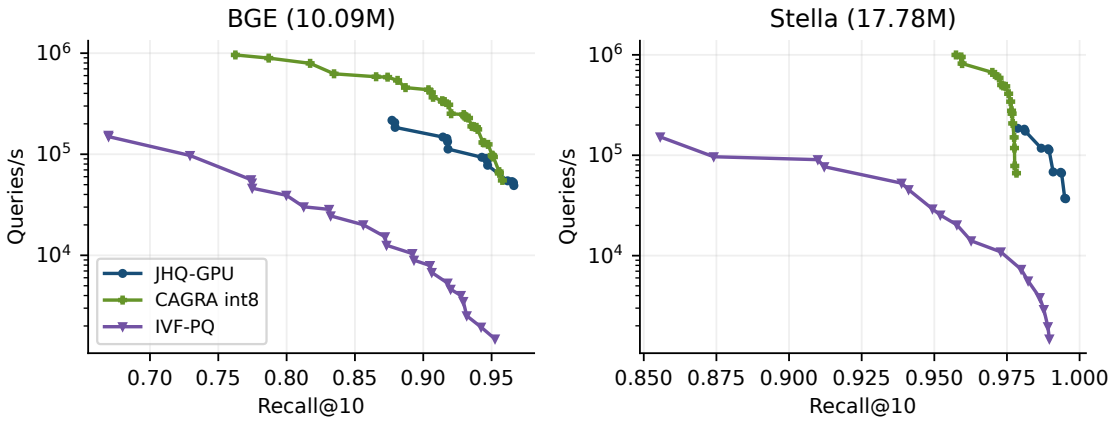



**Figure 7.12:** Large-dataset host-to-host frontiers, including the successful isolated CAGRA int8 reruns. BGE uses 1,000 queries and Stella 999. An endpoint is the end of the tested grid, not an intrinsic recall limit.

On Stella, one concrete high-end comparison is 185.4 kQPS at recall 0.978679 for JHQ versus 66.3 kQPS at 0.978278 for int8, a 2.80× rate ratio with slightly different recall. This is an explicit pair of measured points, not a uniform matched-recall gain: much of JHQ's higher-recall region has no int8 coverage, and JHQ's highest-recall points trade throughput for quality. Corrected-run exclusions and harness diagnostics are recorded in Appendix A.

The result is evidence of tested scale and useful high-recall operating regions, rather than arbitrary-size scalability. The largest completed search uses 17.78 million vectors on one GPU; there is no multi-GPU experiment, no scaling curve holding data distribution fixed and only sampled construction peaks, rather than an allocation-exact proof near the card's capacity. Stella's searches use its actual 999-query pool.

## 7.8 Numerical Robustness, Anomalies and Recall Attribution

The robustness checks qualify the RQ2 exactness claims, the RQ3 risk assessment and the small cross-system margins in RQ4.

### 7.8.1 Quality resolution and repeated execution

With $k = 10$ and 1,000 queries, one recovered neighbour changes aggregate Recall@10 by $10^{-4}$; with 500 held-out queries the resolution is $2 \times 10^{-4}$. Stella's 499-query split

has a slightly coarser resolution. This discretization is not an uncertainty interval, but it helps interpret the small differences reported above. A fourth-decimal change may represent only one or two result slots, while a small mean loss can still hide several queries with substantially changed answers.

Repeated calls and repeated index builds answer different questions. E1 retains 369 baseline repeat-call identifier flags, including tie-order changes; these points remain in the frontiers. The 401-count convention and cross-protocol checks are separated in section A.2.

Five-round ranges describe timing within a fixed build. A separate frontier-slope calculation quantifies sensitivity to a horizontal recall shift: continuous log-QPS segments adjacent to 0.97 imply about 1.01–3.17% rate change per $10^{-3}$ recall, before applying the near-target snapping convention. The supplementary five-build recall ranges are 0.0008 for Vogue, 0.0012 for arXiv, 0.0004 for OpenAI-1536 and 0.0002 for OpenAI-3072 at fixed operating points. Applied purely as horizontal sensitivity scales to the local slopes, these imply changes of order a few percent, rather than the larger OpenAI fp32-CAGRA margin. The experiment does not repeat whole frontiers or baseline builds; it therefore supports local stability assessment, not a universal bound on matched ratios. The precision intervention in section 7.2.3 directly establishes that the OpenAI advantage survives removal of TF32 under its stated cached-model boundary. ArXiv and the LUT near ties retain their narrower interpretation.

Across each dataset's RaBitQ configurations, the median five-round range divided by median QPS is 3.79%, 3.34%, 2.87% and 5.25% for Vogue, arXiv, OpenAI-1536 and OpenAI-3072. These descriptive spreads are comparable in scale to the small Vogue advantage, rather than confidence intervals for its matched ratio. Raw call traces also contain long calls, including occasional 30–60 ms observations in otherwise faster configurations. As a sensitivity check, recomputing QPS as $10^6/\,\text{median(call latency in ms)}$ for a 1,000-query call reduces the influence of long calls. At recall 0.97, the resulting JHQ/RaBitQ ratios are 1.063, 0.995, 1.118 and 1.100. The three favourable directions and arXiv near parity remain, so the result is not solely a consequence of long calls.

### 7.8.2 Exactness is attached to a particular stage

Several distinct claims must remain separate. Cartesian factorization preserves the represented score algebraically. Packed loads preserve the logical code values. Complete-key local retention and merging recover the exact primary top-$c$ of the

visited candidates. The shared bound preserves that selection target. The computed-score probe primitive passes its synthetic and real-input equivalence checks. None of these establishes exact nearest-neighbour answers in the original vector space.

Lane reductions can alter rounding; primary cutoff ties can change which survivor is refined. Final selection is exact over all retained refined scores with ID-based tie breaking; any remaining error against raw-space neighbours can enter before that final selection or through the represented scores. The archived Vogue cross-version discrepancy shows why a pipeline-wide identity claim requires its own check. Similarly, the FP16 routing experiment demonstrates that an almost unchanged mean recall is insufficient evidence of exact probe equivalence. The main correctness conclusions are therefore stated at the stage and input coverage actually tested.

The archived reconstruction pilot measures the remaining gap to full-probe reconstructed scoring. Across seven workload–budget arms of 128 queries each, scoring all probed candidates in FP64 improves recall over GPU outputs at selected budgets by 0–0.002344. For arXiv at 128 probes, $\alpha = 200$ matches the full-IVF reconstructed answer set on all 128 queries. At 100, the recall is 0.9734375 versus 0.9750 for full-IVF scoring: an additional 0.0015625 budget deficit beside the joint routing/reconstruction deficit of 0.0250 (section 6.2). These are pilot-specific aggregate differences; the seven arms include two budgets on one dataset–probe workload. FP64 reconstructed scoring also differs from the GPU arithmetic, so the pilot does not isolate a pure budget effect in every arm. Separating routing from representation requires additional stage-wise GT coverage.

### 7.8.3 Scope of the research findings

Table 7.17 closes the evidence chain for RQ1–RQ4. The results favour a small set of representation-aware execution modes and workload-specific refinement effort, with independent evidence for correctness, speed and quality.

**Table 7.17:** Answers to the four research questions, supported by this chapter.

| RQ | Evidence | Answer | Boundary |
|---|---|---|---|
| RQ1 | Cold build; resident components; large searches | 17.78M vectors on one GPU; 20.44 GiB; repeated train+add 10.54–10.65 s | Sampled peak 22.58 GiB; no multi-GPU scaling |
| RQ2 | Paired LUT, refinement, scan, bound and probe tests | Exact tested primary selection; scheduling 2.727× at batch 8 | Ties and numerical paths; full-batch gains much smaller |
| RQ3 | Disjoint queries; fixed 64/100; full pool; oracle; enumeration | Full pool meets 12/12 quality targets; maximum loss 0.0006 | Retrospective working point; $S = 128$ has up to 40/64 loss crossings; net cost directly measured on four cells |
| RQ4 | Six-method E1 sweeps; matched recall; memory | Three leads and arXiv near parity at 0.97; Vogue's lead uses grouped scanning; allocation below fp32 CAGRA and comparable to int8 | OpenAI E1 uses TF32; FP32 retains smaller leads; batch 1,000 only; int8 wins at low recall; no cross-system small-batch comparison |

The claims apply to squared-L2 top-10 search, the recorded query pools and the tested RTX 5090 environment. Cross-device behaviour, changing queries, online updates and open-loop service latency remain untested. These boundaries accompany the results rather than replacing their positive findings.

Chapter 8

# Discussion, Limitations and Future Research

The measurements favour a particular combination of structured codes, selective refinement and workload-dependent execution. Their wider value lies in explaining when an apparently cheaper operation becomes a faster search. This chapter develops three interpretations, examines two designs that did not justify general adoption, and turns the remaining limitations into testable research questions. The interpretations retain the distinction between measured effects, explanations and proposed extensions established in section 3.6.

## 8.1 Three Cross-Layer Insights

### 8.1.1 A useful representation exposes a useful unit of reuse

The Cartesian codebook permits an exact coordinate decomposition of each primary table into two 16-entry tables. The newer sweep favours that choice in 22/24 cells, while four- and eight-way splits store the same 16 entries per subspace and perform different numbers of lookups (figure 7.3). The representation therefore makes a compact scorer possible, but table size alone fails to determine its best implementation. The relevant reusable unit is the query-specific coordinate group: its distances are computed once and reused across candidates.

Shared-memory feasibility explains an important resource transition. Full tables exceed the available space after scan scratch in the evaluated configurations; two-group tables fit. Beyond that transition, more lookups and accumulation steps compete with further state reduction. Packed words likewise change instruction and addressing work while preserving logical code bytes. These observations support joint consideration of storage, instructions and reuse. They do not distinguish cache, bank, register and issue effects without counters. The two exceptional LUT cells and the Mailman case below are useful counterexamples to a universal smallest-table

rule. Keeping two groups as the default follows the measured trade-off; it does not identify a device-independent optimum.

The opportunity is narrower than arbitrary PQ: the product here exists *inside* each primary subcodebook. A learned PQ subspace generally contains coupled centroids, so splitting the label bits does not split its distance. Conversely, changing a codebook to improve reconstruction can remove this execution advantage. A representation should therefore be assessed by the attainable recall–cost frontier of its scorer and residual hierarchy, alongside reconstruction error. This connects the mathematical compatibility check in Chapter 5 to the end-to-end question in Chapter 7.

### 8.1.2 Useful parallelism is bounded by duplicated state and selection

Integrated scheduling improves geometric-mean throughput by 2.727× at batch 8 and only 1.015× at batch 1,000 against the lane-refinement reference (figure 7.9). Splitting one query across blocks provides work when a batch exposes too little query-level parallelism. Each extra group also brings local buffers, repeated query/table staging and merging. When the original grid already supplies enough blocks, these costs can consume the benefit. This interpretation explains the batch trend without treating maximum occupancy as the objective.

Load skew supplies a separate reason for grouping. At E1's full batch, only Vogue takes the grouped route, with candidate-count CV 0.338–0.622. Its matched-recall ratio to RaBitQ at 0.97 changes from 0.933 for one block to 1.059 for the scheduled path (table 7.3). The paired runs therefore connect execution design to a competitive operating region. They measure the combined scheduling, retention, bound and merge path; isolating the shared bound requires its own ablation. The schedule also loses at some shallow-probe Vogue settings, and its regret reaches 1.217 on BGE at batch 256. CV captures imbalance, but omits absolute work and the cost of staging and merging.

A practical consequence is to retain a query-centric path and choose grouping from both available parallelism and expected work per query. Candidate count, survivor capacity and local-buffer cost are plausible inputs for a richer decision. A fitted selector would need held-out workloads and its own calibration-cost accounting; the present observations do not validate one. The existing heuristic is valuable precisely because its gains and failure cells can be checked separately.

### 8.1.3 Execution speed changes the value of avoiding refinement

Budget reduction removes residual reads, arithmetic and final selection, while routing and broad primary-score production remain. Its potential saving depends on the fraction of latency occupied by those removable operations. Faster lane-cooperative refinement can consequently reduce the reward for lowering the survivor budget. Faster primary scanning can have the opposite effect on refinement's relative share. Neither transformation changes the quality consequence of discarding a particular candidate.

This is a cost-model implication, rather than a causal explanation for every historical/newer budget difference. The ADC manuscript's older calibration times and speedups belong to different execution records. Comparing those summaries with the newer v69 measurements changes several conditions simultaneously. A causal test would replay identical budget decisions and candidate sets while changing only the refinement kernel. Likewise, selected-arm QPS is measured independently of calibration; net service savings require enough reuse; direct four-cell traces now measure that boundary (section 6.5).

The newer FULL results establish a useful observed quality-first working point: all twelve cells meet the tested $10^{-3}$ relative-loss target. Smaller samples reduce calibration cost but sometimes accept harmful budgets. The independent-slot resolution calculation motivates a sample scale near 500, while its stronger independence assumption and the conditional ordering assumptions remain explicit; supplementary FULL enumeration agrees in all twelve cells. The engineering decision is to spend calibration effort according to a workload's quality requirement and expected reuse. Optimising the selector alone, or reporting only a favourable selected-arm mean, leaves that decision incomplete.

## 8.2 Two Deep Negative-Result Case Studies

### 8.2.1 Mailman-style shared sums: arithmetic reuse meets scatter cost

The sign-code form of primary distance suggests reusing sums across candidates that share bit patterns. The Mailman algorithm supplies the general finite-alphabet matrix–vector idea [20]. The archived pilot tests GPU implementations on frozen

Vogue, arXiv and OpenAI-3072 candidate streams, at 128 probes and batches 8/1,000. Its baseline reproduces the packed two-table scoring loop. Atomic bucket accumulation, private histograms and group widths 4/6/8 are alternatives within the experiment; the mathematical score and input codes remain fixed.

The fastest alternative in each of the six cells achieves only 0.187–0.581 of baseline scoring throughput (figure 8.1). The phase profiles place most instrumented cycles in bucket accumulation. Biased list-local patterns create repeated bucket destinations; private histograms avoid atomics at the cost of larger state and shared-memory read–modify–write work. Reducing group width and avoiding dominant buckets improves particular variants, but none reaches the baseline. This supports a stopping decision for these implementations and inputs. It does not establish that all finite-alphabet reuse is ineffective: the winning two-table baseline already reuses coordinate sums in a different direction.

The pilot writes primary scores rather than returning final neighbours. Its FP32/FP64 comparisons expose near-cutoff numerical differences, not final-pipeline equivalence. With measured scorer speed ratio $s$ and an estimated replaceable latency fraction $f$, the optimistic replacement model is $1/[(1-f)+f/s]$. Its predicted slowdown is a model, since integration was stopped before an end-to-end run. An auxiliary lossless dictionary study also stopped at structural statistics: its limited byte/work savings did not justify a GPU implementation. Neither route contributes a measured system point to the main frontiers.

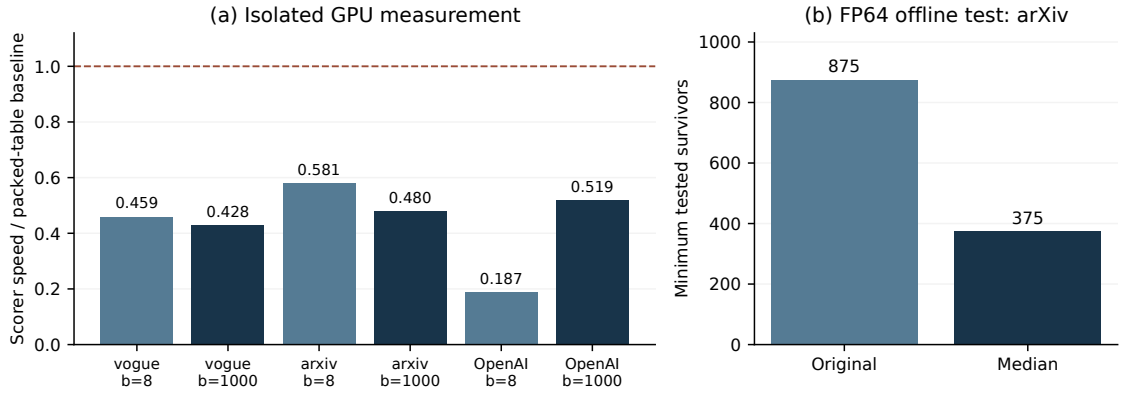



**Figure 8.1:** Two distinct evidence boundaries. Left: best measured Mailman scorer / packed-table scorer speed on an RTX 5090, with Vogue, arXiv and OpenAI-3072 at two batches and 128 probes; all ratios are below one. Right: minimum survivor counts meeting the original JHQ recall target on arXiv's 400-query FP64 offline test split. The candidate reduction is not a GPU speedup. Both panels are regenerated from archived records by the thesis audit script.

### 8.2.2 Rank-oriented coding: a local gain is not a general replacement

The rank-oriented study asks whether changing one-bit thresholds or scoring can retain useful neighbours with fewer survivors at the same nominal code budget. Its main comparisons replay exported candidates in FP64, with 400 calibration, 200 validation and 400 final-test queries. It examines likelihood weighting, median thresholds, learned ranking losses, linear-MMSE decoding and list-dependent thresholds. Different objectives expose different failure modes: reducing reconstruction or inner-product MSE can worsen the order of the few nearest candidates; changing primary levels also changes the residual reference point.

On arXiv's test split, median thresholds reduce the minimum tested survivor count meeting the original target from 875 to 375. That success does not generalise to the other two workloads under the same strict criterion. The shared-rotation Gaussian intuition also leaves real corpus bias intact: rotating a mean vector preserves its norm. Centered coding can address some of this mismatch, but its reconstructed-score ceiling must be evaluated alongside primary ranking. The stopped study therefore supports a workload-specific representation improvement, rather than a new generally rank-optimal quantiser.

The later median-only GPU follow-up is separate evidence. It imports the changed thresholds, levels and retrained residuals into the same search pipeline, then compares independently swept budgets at measured recall thresholds. At arXiv's original $\alpha = 100$ target it yields ratios of approximately 1.40 at batch 8 and 1.21 at batch 1,000. Vogue's tested median frontier stops at 0.9630, below the original 0.9644 working point; OpenAI-3072 is essentially tied. These results revise a blanket "never GPU-tested" description, while preserving the decision against a universal replacement. The follow-up uses its own index states, query pool and three-round protocol; its rates are not inserted into E1.

## 8.3 Threats to Internal and External Validity

Internal validity is strongest for same-process paired interventions and weakest where versions, trained states or interfaces change together. Table 8.1 identifies the possible reversal for each main interpretation. The main safeguards are the shared inputs, explicit score contracts, retained timing arrays and versioned ledgers of Chapter 3. Repeated calls estimate conditional timing variation; they do not estimate the

distribution over independently retrained indexes. Five supplementary builds now quantify recall variation at fixed operating points, not the distribution of entire retrained frontiers. Precision sensitivity also changes add/query arithmetic under a common cached model.

**Table 8.1:** Threats that can reverse or narrow a conclusion.

| Claim at risk | Alternative or reversal | Control and remaining test |
|---|---|---|
| Execution gain | Changed scores, ties or index state explain an apparent speedup | Paired state and output checks; independent complete-score reference and arithmetic diagnostics remain pending |
| Budget quality | Finite-pool sampling or drift hides damaging queries | Disjoint GT evaluation, full traces, subset-sum checks and FULL enumeration; future-query and arbitrary-subset invariance remain untested |
| Competitive margin | Grid density, call tails or API overhead changes the ordering | Both recall estimators, retained slow calls and int8 baseline; TF32/FP32 sensitivity; small-batch and cross-device comparisons unmeasured |
| Capacity/build claim | Transient allocations exceed a resident sample | Phase bytes, repeated empty-cache builds and 20 ms device peaks; sub-interval allocations and full retrained frontiers remain unmeasured |

External validity is limited by one GPU, squared-L2 top-10 search, six prepared embedding datasets and E1's full-batch comparison. Query removal by position does not certify the absence of near-duplicate embeddings. The exports are not a relevance-labelled retrieval benchmark. Database updates, concurrent traffic, deployment latency objectives and changing query populations are untested. The index is resident in compressed form; the result supplies no billion-scale or multi-device capacity evidence. These limitations identify the experiments needed before transferring an observed operating region to a deployment.

## 8.4 Testable Research Directions

### 8.4.1 Risk-controlled agreement with a reuse-aware objective

A next policy could minimise calibration plus expected reuse time while certifying a query-level *reference-agreement* loss, using valid selection-aware confidence bounds. The inputs would be matched-regime per-query disagreement curves and a fixed reference; variables would include sample size and survivor budget. An absolute GT target additionally needs independent labelled validation or assumptions linking the reference to GT. Stationarity, query-level sampling and a common score/order contract must be explicit; a drift trigger would invalidate and renew the certificate.

The first experiment should compare the existing fixed-sample rules, rank-curve reuse and a cost-aware policy on held-out pools, recording total time and tail agreement loss. The archived sequential controller already failed to beat fixed sampling in an older four-cell replay because extra search launches consumed sample savings. Repeating sequential testing alone is therefore insufficient. The new question is whether reusable intermediate information and a quality certificate jointly improve *total* cost. Failure means violating the stated risk limit or saving no time against the quality-matched fixed-sample control.

### 8.4.2 Capacity-aware residual placement

The resident residual array dominates large-index storage. A complementary study could keep primary codes resident and cache residual blocks under an explicit device-memory cap, using host memory for misses. Holding codes, routing, survivor sets and refined arithmetic fixed would isolate placement from representation quality. The minimum experiment measures cache hits, transfer bytes, overlap, tail latency and throughput while varying memory cap, batch and query locality. A result is useful only if it expands feasible capacity with an acceptable total-time frontier; a slower cache at an already feasible resident size is not sufficient. This is an unimplemented storage extension, distinct from the existing residual-bound pilot and from lowering $\alpha$, which leaves the full array allocated.

## 8.5 Conditional Deployment Recommendation

JHQ-GPU merits evaluation when a compressed resident hierarchy fits the device, batches provide useful parallel work, and the required recall lies within its measured competitive region. The recorded FULL policy is the quality-first calibration starting point, followed by validation on the deployment's own queries and direct reuse timing. At lower recall, int8 CAGRA is a strong alternative; at some higher targets, IVF-RaBitQ wins. Applications requiring small-request latency, updates or a population recall guarantee need additional evidence. The deployment choice should compare quality, total time and memory together under the actual service workload.

Chapter 9

# Conclusion

JHQ-GPU demonstrates how a structured quantised hierarchy can be translated into a useful GPU search pipeline, and why its execution and refinement effort must be evaluated together. The four research questions now have concrete, bounded answers.

## 9.1 Answers to the Four Research Questions

**RQ1: Construction and capacity.** GPU training, batched encoding, IVF placement and packed arrays produce a searchable resident hierarchy. The largest tested database contains 17.78 million vectors at 20.44 GiB resident device memory; the corresponding supplementary train-plus-add range is 10.54–10.65 s (section 7.7). Its sampled construction peak is 22.58 GiB, while BGE reaches 26.08 GiB at add entry. Repeated independent builds and startup intervals establish the measured capacity boundary more fully.

**RQ2: Correct and efficient execution.** The inherited Cartesian code admits exact real-arithmetic table factorisation, and complete-key retention/merge and shared-bound arguments explain the grouped path's selection conditions. Two-group tables lead in 22/24 measured cells. Integrated scheduling achieves 2.727× geometric-mean throughput at batch 8 but only 1.015× at batch 1,000 against the lane-refinement reference (sections 7.3 and 7.6). Thus useful parallelism depends on batch and work distribution. Finite output checks complement the proofs; arithmetic, tie and memory assumptions remain explicit.

**RQ3: Refinement budget and quality.** Unlabelled reference agreement selects workload-level survivor effort without a learned predictor. FULL calibration meets the tested relative recall-loss target in 12/12 cells, with maximum observed loss 0.0006. At $S = 128$, one cell instead has 40/64 threshold crossings (section 7.5). The reference-based analysis explains conditional budget search, not a population GT guarantee. Ten FULL cells still lack a general complete-key nestedness guarantee; nevertheless

all twelve FULL finite-grid choices match enumeration. Direct calibration-plus-reuse measurements on four cells support savings on suitable workloads and retain the quality/time tradeoff on difficult ones.

**RQ4: Competitive operating regions.** At recall 0.97, the interpolated full-batch E1 comparison places JHQ first in three datasets and near parity with IVF-RaBitQ on arXiv (section 7.2). Vogue's lead depends on the grouped path. The OpenAI E1 runs use TF32; a same-session FP32 sensitivity still exceeds archived RaBitQ by 7.9–8.6% and CAGRA fp32 by 1.63–1.68× at that target. CAGRA int8 wins in lower-recall regions, and IVF-RaBitQ wins at some higher targets. The result supports a useful operating region on the measured device and grid, alongside separately reported memory use. It supplies no cross-system small-batch or cross-device ranking.

## 9.2 Closing Principle and Outlook

The resulting principle is to co-evaluate representation, execution and effort under a stated quality objective. A smaller table can add work; more groups can duplicate it; less refinement can sacrifice the neighbours that matter. The negative designs show why mathematical reuse and lower reconstruction error need not improve the search frontier. The next step is to test whether reusable calibration information can support valid risk control at lower total cost, and whether explicit residual placement can extend capacity without unacceptable tail latency (section 8.4). These are hypotheses grounded in the measured limits, rather than capabilities already supplied by the present system.

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Appendix A

# Reproducibility and Experiment Manifest

## A.1 Source and Build Environment

Chapter 7 is an offline analysis of archived measurements in the sibling `JHQ_GPU` repository. The analysis checkout is recorded in `data/ch7/audit.json`; this is distinct from each experimental run's source head. Table A.1 maps component names to implementations, recorded provenance and executable names. A run-head commit identifies source visible to a run, not a cryptographic identity of its binary. The archives do not supply a complete collection of executable SHA-256 hashes or immutable trained-state hashes. Missing identities are left explicit rather than reconstructed from the current checkout.

Chapter 4's source and construction-record audit is recorded separately in `data/ch4/audit.json`. It distinguishes the inspected source, modelled bytes, archived train/add intervals and resident samples. In particular, object construction, host QR and constructor library warm-up precede the reported train/add timers.

The principal environment is RTX 5090, driver 595.71.05 and CUDA 13.0; E1 uses cuVS 26.08.01. Release JHQ targets compute_80 PTX, JIT-compiled on the device. Native-library baselines and C++/Python interface boundaries differ. E1 improves comparability by reusing resources, preallocating outputs, using pinned input staging and timing int8 query quantization. JHQ and baseline output buffers still have different host memory types. These details limit interpretations of small margins.

The adaptive call budget uses a warm-up interval containing the first call. In the Python baseline harness that interval also includes initial result conversion and validation before the decision; it is not a pure steady-state latency measurement. The 274 reduced-call points therefore include a RaBitQ point above 507 kQPS. Actual calls and five round arrays remain in the JSONL records. The default exact-selection setting was also inspected at the budget run's historical source head, not merely in the current checkout: `JHQ_EXACT_TOPCK=0` opts into the old lossy primary-retention

**Table A.1:** Component and run provenance. "Report" distinguishes a version stated in an experiment report from a raw run-header commit. The exact E1 build state is not inferred from a baseline's metadata.

| Component | Recorded source evidence | Executable or harness | Run/state source |
|---|---|---|---|
| E1 final pipeline | Environment logs include `a31c22d`; extensions have their own metadata | `demo_jhq_v69_batch`; `bench_cuvs.py`; `bench_rabitq_sweep` | E1 `RAW_RESULTS/`; shared trained-state cache |
| Lane refinement (v61) | Raw header `b37efa4` | `demo_jhq_v61_ab` | `warp_refine/raw/run.log`; `arms6_cache` |
| Grouped scan (v62) | Report: `862543a`; run script `e0d0518` | `demo_jhq_v62_batch` | `pipeline_v62/raw/`; recorded compiler flags |
| Shared bound (v63) | Implementation and build flags archived; no run-head claim inferred here | `demo_jhq_v63_batch` | `pipeline_campaign/exp2/v63_raw/` |
| Batch scheduling (v65) | Raw header `d425ab8` | `demo_jhq_v65_batch` | `exp47/raw/run.log`; `arms6_cache` |
| Radix probe (v69) | Comparative runs and source archived; binary SHA not recorded | `demo_jhq_v65_batch`, `demo_jhq_v69_batch` | `practical_opt/v69_run.sh`; `v69_results/dumps.sha256` |
| Budget / table sweep | Raw header `d5e1526` | `demo_jhq_v69_budget_arms`; `demo_jhq_v71_gN_batch`, $N \in \{1, 2, 4, 8\}$ | `adc_v69/RAW/`, `RAW_LUT/`; `arms6_cache` |
| Large int8 rerun | Stella degree-64 metadata `ad433a4` | `bench_cuvs.py` | `adc_v69/RAW_BIG/`; isolated processes |
| Historical budget | Raw header `bf31b41` (v57 family) | `demo_jhq_budget_arms.cu` harness | `paper_adc2026/data/budget_arms.log` |

implementation. Final selection scans all retained refined scores and breaks ties by database ID.

## A.2 E1 Measurement Details and Review Diagnostics

E1 normally times 24 calls per round. The baseline harness reduces this count when a warm-up interval exceeds its per-call threshold; 274 points use fewer calls, including some fast steady-state points. Reported QPS is the median of five round throughputs, each based on total queries divided by elapsed time, rather than the reciprocal of median individual latency. Device-only baseline timing is auxiliary: JHQ has no equivalent device-query API for the main comparison.

The parser's 369 false repeat-call identifier flags comprise 170 RaBitQ, 80 IVF-PQ, 68 CAGRA int8, 50 CAGRA fp32 and one brute-force point. They can include tie-order changes, without implying different ID sets or invalid outputs; no point is discarded solely for the flag. The raw records retain first/last recall and set/order diagnostics. JHQ does not populate the same flag. The earlier count of 401 is the union of these 369 flags and 367 B-versus-A mismatches, with 32 adding only the latter. Cross-protocol disagreement is distinct from repeat-call nondeterminism.

The second-review audit is `scripts/audit_ch7_round2.py`; its input identities and calculations are in `data/ch7/round2-audit.json`. It reconstructs the paired Vogue one-block frontier, counts actual scan paths and computes continuous local frontier slopes. A single cold/cache recall comparison is a sensitivity scale, not an empirical retraining distribution. The later vector-row check supports alignment of all query rows and a 10,299-row base sample (section A.6); original entity-ID mappings remain absent.

A binary paired sign test counts the signs of paired differences [22]. Under hypothetical independent fair signs, the one-sided tail for at least 22 positives out of 24 is $1.7941 \times 10^{-5}$; the two-sided value is twice that. Here 22/24 instead counts wins among four LUT arms. The explicit two-arm comparison gives 23/24, and probe configurations also share datasets and indexes. The chapter therefore reports the paired counts and per-dataset means rather than adopting that nominal significance test. Likewise compute_80 PTX is translated into native target code by the driver [28]; without a matched compilation ablation the sign of any throughput effect remains unmeasured.

## A.3 Budget Harness Contract and Diagnostic Coverage

Chapter 6's policy and review audits are reproducible with `scripts/audit_ch6.py`; `data/ch6/audit.json` distinguishes source-derived scan paths, statistical illustrations and archived measurements. The budget harness's fallback grid string starts at 100, although its header comment lists 200. The campaign script explicitly sets the eight-point grid beginning at 200, so its recorded reference is unaffected. Full-pool calibration is one call per cell; selected-arm rates reuse the previously timed fixed arms.

The harness partitions query indices by parity: 500 even-indexed queries calibrate and 500 odd-indexed queries evaluate, or 499 for Stella. There are 64 draws for each $S = 32, 64, 128$. Partial seeded shuffling samples without replacement using `rand() % remaining`; the analytic finite-pool formula models uniform subsets. The initial warm-up traverses the entire query file, including held-out queries, but its outputs and GT do not enter the agreement decision. Scan-schedule calibration uses separate database pseudoqueries.

Each fixed arm receives one warm-up and three host-to-host timed calls. Calibration gathers the selected vectors before starting its timer, then runs a reference and candidate searches with graph capture bypassed. The host agreement comparison costs $O(Sk^2)$ per tested budget; sample gathering is $O(Sd)$ and reference-ID storage is $O(Sk)$. The timer includes search-call setup and host comparisons, while sample gathering and separate scan calibration are excluded. The logged percentile uses zero-based sorted index $\lfloor 0.95(m-1) \rfloor$, with $m = 64$.

The helper returns a grid index, leaving the index at the last tested multiplier. A caller must invoke `set_alpha(A[index])` before future searches; selected-arm benchmark results instead use lookup. Enumeration repeats the reference plus all seven other budgets, so both timers include a fresh reference. In the original campaign it is requested only for the subsampled calls: the FULL call omits `enum_out`. Thus the 2,304 matched sample decisions exclude the twelve FULL decisions. At $S = 500$, two Vogue cells use four groups and ten cells use the distance-only path. Matched calibration/evaluation paths remove a transfer difference, but do not by themselves supply a common cutoff order. The supplementary harness adds and passes all twelve FULL enumeration checks (section A.6).

Finite-pool prediction requires more than a single 500-query score dump. For each intended $S$, the per-query disagreement counts must be invariant to subset membership and position under that execution regime. A FULL $g_{\text{scan}} = 0$ dump cannot establish counts for grouped subsamples. Under these conditions and monotone acceptance, arXiv's recorded fixed-arm quality map makes selecting an unacceptable arm equivalent to accepting 100: 200 is its only qualifying budget. This mapping uses held-out quality labels; acceptance counts alone do not predict unknown GT loss. The original archived log lacks per-query curves and per-draw choices; the supplementary traces supply them and reproduce all sampled grid counts from full-pool per-query subset sums. This finite check does not establish per-query invariance on arbitrary subsets.

## A.4 Data and Trained States

The six database shapes and actual query counts are stated in table 3.2. The comparisons use the same exported vectors and squared-L2 ground truth per dataset. The budget split uses even query indices for calibration and odd indices for evaluation; Stella has 500/499 queries. Search sweeps load the recorded `arms6_cache` trained states, whereas cold-build records explicitly start without trained state. The chapter's file ledger hashes analysis inputs, not the full underlying vector files or every cache object; it does not certify unrecorded data or binary identities.

For the table-grouping sweep, `evidence/ch5/v71/` supplies selected source extracted from the recorded run head `d5e1526`, its harness, build definitions, run parameters and original records. Its manifest hashes 96 timed JSON records, four gate-check JSON records, their text outputs and build/progress logs, together with the selected source. Figure 7.3 is derived from the timed records using `scripts/build_ch7.py`. This review bundle closes the local source-to-result inspection path; it supplies neither measured binary identity nor the datasets and trained states needed for GPU reproduction.

The Vogue probe comparison stores matching SHA-256 hashes for the one-group, batch-8 probe/primary dumps, covering all 1,000 queries. Its baseline identity run reports recall 0.9642; the same baseline binary's two subsequent timing runs report 0.9644. The dump controls a specific routing/screening boundary. It does not store a complete cross-process residual-code, query-rotation or score trace and therefore does not identify the numerical root cause downstream.

Two exclusions affect the scale evidence. Initial large-baseline builds retained an earlier index through a closure; successful isolated reruns supersede those attempts, including Stella CAGRA int8. Separately, Stella's 999-query pool causes the full-batch harness to skip batch 1,000. Top-level corrected large-search records use batch 999; superseded skipped-search files supply no throughput points. Cold-build logs are used for train/add time even where their search list is empty.

## A.5 Result-to-Figure Mapping

Table A.2 maps the empirical figures to their measurement families. The Chapter 7 empirical plots and main numeric tables are generated by `scripts/build_ch7.py`; the additional path table is generated by `scripts/audit_ch7_round2.py`. `data/ch7/sources.csv` gives consumed input paths relative to `JHQ_GPU` and their hashes.

**Table A.2:** Chapter 7 result-to-figure mapping. Paths below are relative to `JHQ_GPU`; detailed file identities are in the hash ledger.

| Figure | Raw source |
|---|---|
| 7.1 | `experiments/comp8800_poster_e1/RAW_RESULTS/`; `analyze.py` frontier and interpolation definitions |
| 7.3 | `experiments/adc_v69/RAW_LUT/v71_g*.json` |
| 7.4 | `paper_adc2026/data/layout6.log`; `experiments/warp_refine/raw/ab/` and `raw/summary.json` |
| 7.5, 7.6 | `experiments/adc_v69/RAW/budget_v69.log`; actual 500/499 query counts |
| 7.9 | `experiments/pipeline_campaign/exp47/raw/bench/`; `experiments/pipeline_v62/raw/perf/stages_summary.json` |
| 7.10 | E1 and `adc_v69/RAW_BIG/` cold-build logs; baseline index records, with int8 dataset quantization |
| 7.11 | `adc_v69/RAW_LUT/v71_g2_*_np128.json`; modelled component sizes in the chapter analysis script |
| 7.12 | `experiments/adc_v69/RAW_BIG/` corrected top-level records |

Historical v57 and newer budget comparisons retain separate versions and timing protocols. The memory decomposition combines measured totals with an explicit component model; its unaccounted remainder remains visible.

To regenerate the report, run `make ch7-data` and then `make pdf`. The optional Chinese reading copy uses `make pdf-zh`; its table translator reuses numeric data from the English tables. Regeneration is an offline consistency check, not a new GPU measurement. The original vectors, trained states, matching GPU software environment and executable build would be needed for an independent benchmark rerun.

## A.6 Supplementary Evidence of 28 October

The supplementary records are under `JHQ_GPU/experiments/thesis_evidence/`. Running `scripts/audit_supplement.py` recomputes the figures and bilingual tables, with a ledger at `data/supplement/audit.json`. Its input ledger hashes raw records, analysis/run scripts, exported PTX and toolkit SASS, and the relevant source. Original E1 and ADC campaigns retain their own records. The supplementary campaign uses RTX 5090, driver 595.71.05 and CUDA 13.0; cross-session baseline comparisons are explicitly labelled.

**Construction and representation.** A1 uses an empty trained-state cache per run: first read, three normal warm-input repetitions, and a synchronised phase diagnostic, for each of six datasets. Process-start timestamps end at the printed

add completion; schedule calibration and the first search follow. Device memory is sampled every 20 ms, with a 20 ms allowance at the output boundary. It is device used memory including context, not an allocation-exact process trace. The phase run forces one pipeline buffer and synchronisation, so its times and peak remain separate. Five-build recall is measured at each dataset's fixed 128-probe point, not over five complete frontiers. C1 structurally checks four complete databases and recodes 200K/100K/20K/100K rows for Vogue/arXiv/OpenAI-3072/Stella. Norm checks apply FP64 to the stored matrix, not to a dump of actual GPU rotation outputs.

**Machine-code identity.** The inspected v69 executable has SHA-256 (line break for display):

```
5371616ed99ab2b2dd323688eb3cf7a2
3dafb9f3f6a3904cf44475f65cf63ceb
```

A2 extracts its `sm_80` PTX and reassembles it with toolkit 13.0.88 `ptxas` for `sm_120`. The bound read is `LDG.E.64.STRONG.SYS`; publication is `REDG.E.MIN.64.STRONG.GPU`. This validates the extracted PTX contract and corroborates it with toolkit machine code. The driver JIT's actual loaded SASS is not archived.

**Row correspondence and precision.** A3 checks every query and a stride-97 base sample by truncating and renormalising the wider OpenAI embedding; it is vector correspondence, not an original entity-ID export. D alternates v69/v72 order by probe setting, using the original E1 grid and five timing rounds per configuration. Both variants reuse the TF32-trained cache. The FP32 switch affects add/query GEMMs; the experiment does not retrain FP32 models or remeasure E1 baselines. Source patches are archived as local commits `d924b30`, `b445c96`, `51d5502`, with server counterparts documented in the experiment report; patch correspondence is distinct from executable identity.

**Budget trace and direct timing.** B preserves the original `srand(12345)` sampling sequence for 2,304 draw records and adds twelve FULL enumerations. Its JSONL records contain sample IDs, complete disagreement curves, selected arms, losses, full-pool per-query counts and direct execution traces. All 18,432 sampled grid counts equal sums of the full-pool counts over the recorded sample IDs; this is an aggregate check on measured subsets. The 36 finite-pool predictions need no GT

for acceptance; the conversion to GT-loss crossing probability uses the held-out fixed-arm quality map. Direct reuse timing instead uses a separate `mt19937(20261028)` sequence, five rounds with rotated policy order, and 500 repetitions of the same held-out batch. It includes sample gathering, calibration, explicit budget installation and first-batch graph setup. Earlier construction, schedule calibration and warm-up are excluded. Fractional break-even values fit measured calibration and steady batches; cumulative totals provide the direct observation. First schedule calibration calls take 6.00–27.77 ms, separate from 0.81–7.04 ms pseudoquery gathering; five repeated calls give medians of 2.72–18.13 ms.

Strict CPU primary top-$c$ validation (C2) and the controlled Vogue cross-process diagnosis (C3) were not performed. Remaining work and the partially closed contracts are tracked in `assessment/ch7-pending-experiments.txt`.

Appendix B

# Supplementary Results and Correctness Checks

## B.1 Complete Parameter Grids

**TO WRITE:** List method-specific tuning grids, invalid or unavailable settings, and reasons for unattempted configurations.

## B.2 Correctness and Numerical Checks

**TO WRITE:** Include reference comparisons for encoding, LUT factorisation, primary selection, probe selection, and refinement. Separate numerical, algorithmic, and memory-safety evidence.

## B.3 Additional Results and Negative Designs

**TO WRITE:** Include secondary results with evidence status: integrated system, isolated GPU measurement, offline replay, analytical estimate, or untested idea.

Appendix C

# Contributions and Tool-Use Record

This record distinguishes documented project provenance from a personal authorship attestation. The signed declaration and detailed allocation of individual research tasks require the author's confirmation in the course's required form. Repository authorship and manuscript author order alone do not establish who independently performed every design or verification.

## C.1 Contribution Record

| Work component | Documented attribution | Supporting record / confirmation status |
|---|---|---|
| Inherited method | JHQ by Jiabao Han, Mengxuan Zhang and Goce Trajcevski; square rotation, analytical primary representation and residual hierarchy | Original JHQ paper [15]; not claimed as this project's invention |
| Project and supervision | Rui Luo is the COMP8800 project presenter and thesis author; Dr Mengxuan Zhang is the named supervisor | Project poster and thesis metadata establish these roles |
| Shared manuscript | Rui Luo and Mengxuan Zhang are named coauthors of the ADC project manuscript | Local manuscript source [21]; publication/acceptance status is not inferred |

| Work component | Documented attribution | Supporting record / confirmation status |
|---|---|---|
| GPU design, implementation, experiments and analysis | Technical project scope is identified in table 1.1; personal allocation among researchers and assisted work remains to be confirmed by the author | Source, experiment and analysis ledgers establish artifact provenance; they are not a substitute for a personal contribution statement |

## C.2 Generative-AI Assistance

The thesis preparation used generative-AI assistance. These entries record activities evidenced in the writing conversation and repository artifacts; they do not assert that a human has approved every generated passage or independently repeated each experiment.

| Tool / record | Purpose and scope | Review evidence and remaining responsibility |
|---|---|---|
| OpenAI Codex; thesis revision, October 2026 | Drafting and revising English and Chinese chapters, mathematical explanations, LaTeX diagrams and analysis scripts; reading source/archives and compiling PDFs | Chapter audit files record automated source/numeric checks. The current synthesis added no GPU run. Final human review and adoption remain the author's responsibility |
| User-supplied GPT and Claude review comments | Suggested corrections, scope checks and additional experiments during chapter revision | Retained responses in `assessment/` explain which suggestions were accepted, corrected or left pending; comments were checked against source and records rather than accepted as measurements |

| Tool / record | Purpose and scope | Review evidence and remaining responsibility |
|---|---|---|
| ADC manuscript's own disclosure | The joint manuscript contains a separate disclosure concerning Claude and ChatGPT assistance with implementation, harness, figures and drafting | That manuscript statement identifies its own scope; it does not automatically certify the thesis's personal task allocation or human verification |

The retained writing conversation and chapter evidence notes identify the requests and review process. A complete export of prompts, any additional tools used by the author, and the final course-specific disclosure should be reconciled before submission. The thesis author is responsible for understanding the methods, checking adopted material and confirming the final declaration. No signature or claim of sole unaided authorship is generated here.

Appendix D

# Template Examples — Draft Only

This appendix demonstrates the available formatting. It is omitted when `\draftthesisfalse` is selected in `config/metadata.tex`.

## D.1 Citations and Cross-References

Use `\citet{jhq}` for a narrative citation: Han et al. [15]. Use `\citep{pq,cagra}` for a parenthetical citation [16, 29]. Examples: figure D.1, table D.1, and equation (D.1). The bibliography entries are copied from the existing ADC source; review their metadata before submission.

## D.2 A Source-Native Diagram

## D.3 Tables

## D.4 Equations and Proofs

$$D(\alpha) = \sum_{q \in Q_s} \left[ k - \left| R_\alpha(q) \cap R_{\max}(q) \right| \right]. \tag{D.1}$$

The environments `definition`, `lemma`, `proposition`, and `proof` are available. For example:

**Definition D.1** (Strict total ranking key)**.** A ranking key specifies how to order unequal scores and how to break ties.

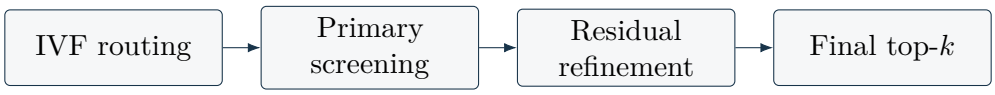



**Figure D.1:** Formatting example: a schematic query path. Replace or extend it with the verified execution boundaries of the implementation.

**Table D.1:** Example manifest fields. This table contains no experimental results.

| Field | What to record |
|---|---|
| Source | Immutable commit and build configuration |
| Index | Trained-state identity and input hashes |
| Timing | Host-to-host or device-resident boundary |
| Quality | Metric, ground truth, and held-out split |
| Evidence | Raw log and analysis-script path |

**Table D.2:** Pseudocode layout example.

| Line | Operation |
|---|---|
| 1 | Read the input and validate the stated preconditions. |
| 2 | Compute the intermediate result. |
| 3 | Return the output and specify its semantics. |

## D.5 Pseudocode and Code

The table below gives a package-light pseudocode layout; replace its contents with the actual method and keep correctness premises in the surrounding text.

**Listing D.1:** Code-listing format example.

```
// Use only short excerpts that help explain a design.
// Keep full implementations in the reproducibility artifact.
void search();
```